

The Legacies: Our Heritage and My Responsibility

The Twenty-Ninth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1979

Final Report

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York City
April 22-28**



Copyright © 1979 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.

Mail address: Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10017

Conference drawings in this issue by Dick Herdegen

Blank Page

Contents

	Page		Page
Regional Map of U.S. and Canada	2	Workshops Gauge the Climate Within A.A.	
Packed Schedule and Lively Debate		Communications within the A.A. Fellowship	25
Mark the 29th Conference	5	Group autonomy and A.A. unity	25
"The Legacies: <i>Our Heritage and My Responsibility</i> "		Reports on Area Service Highlights	26
(keynote)	5		
Groups and Members—Spring 1979	6	Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board,	
From Apprehension to "a Spiritual Feeling" (welcome)	6	and Trustees' Committees	
Delegates Meet "Off the Record" (delegates' meeting)	6	General Service Board	30
Important Questions Keep Recurring (sharing session)	7	A.A. World Services, Inc.	30
Conference Sidelights	7	Archives	31
Unity and Service Make Recovery Possible (closing talk)	7	Conference	31
Was the Conference "Fun"? (closing brunch)	8	Cooperation with the Professional Community	32
"We do not represent areas or regions"	8	Correctional Facilities	33
"Something happens beyond ourselves"	9	Finance	33
"You are all stars; you bring light"	9	General Service Sharing Session	33
Big ideas fade; hope flourishes	9	Group Services Coordinator	34
"My name came out of the hat"	9	International	34
Discussions Cover a Wide Range of A.A. Life		International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums	35
(presentations/discussions, special reports, workshops)		Internationalists, Loners, LIMs	36
1980 International Convention		Literature	36
A look ahead at "The Joy of Living"	10	Nominating	37
The Archives		Overseas, World Service Meeting, Spanish Correspondence	37
To give A.A. "a sense of its own past"	10	Public Information	38
Today's "junk" could be tomorrow's treasure	11	Staff Coordinator	39
Sharing the "continuing process" that is A.A.	11	Treatment Facilities	40
The Story of A.A. Literature Distributed by G.S.O.		Reports From the A.A. Grapevine	40
Literature and film respond to A.A. needs	12		
"Trust is vital"	12	Questions Call Forth Well-Considered Answers	
Too much? Too specialized?	13	(Ask-It Basket)	41
A.A. Around the World		Recommendations Offered on 68 Points (Advisory Actions)	
A World Service Meeting delegate reports	13	Floor Actions	45
"There are no strangers in A.A."	14	Agenda	46
How Do Roundups, Jamborees, Cruises, Rallies, etc.,		Cooperation with the Professional Community	46
Fit Into A.A. Traditions?		Correctional Facilities	46
Tradition breaks can be avoided	14	Finance	47
"Mindful of the <i>spirit</i> of our Traditions"	15	Grapevine	47
"A tremendous learning experience"	15	1980 International Convention	47
The Grapevine		Literature	47
Our magazine helps individual sobriety	16	Policy/Admissions	48
The Grapevine—not a luxury, but a necessity	16	Public Information	48
A new staff faces new challenges	16	Report and Charter	49
A & P (Alcohol and Pills) Groups		Treatment Facilities	49
Is language behind this old A.A. problem?	17	Committee on Trustees	49
Do differences or similarities count more?	17	Financial Data	
Changing patterns call for changing customs	18	Income Statement: General Service Office	50
One area recommends longer study	18	Income Statement: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	51
The Role of the General Service Trustees and		Combined Balance Sheet: G.S.O. and Grapevine	52
How They are Elected		1979 G.S.O. and Grapevine Budgets	53
New election procedure suggested	19	1978 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area	54
"Apply it to yourselves"	19	1978 Total Contributions—by State/Province	55
Sponsoring Needs of Potential Members		Rosters	
Coming to A.A. From Treatment Facilities		1979 Conference Committees	56
Area and district efforts bring results	20	New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons	56
Facilities vary—patients have much in common	20	1979 Trustees' Committees	57
Easing the transition from center to A.A.	21	1979 Conference Members	
The Three Legacies—Our Responsibilities to the Future		Trustees (General Service Board)	58
Recovery: Gratitude helps us stay sober	21	A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine directors,	
Finding "a new dimension" in the program	22	G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs	60
"A constant process of learning"	22	Area delegates	60
Unity: Many Concepts guide us	22	Literature Distributed—1978	63
Progress, rather than perfection	23		
Unity at all levels and among all levels	23	Grapevine Circulation—Geographical Breakdown	63
Service: What about those beribboned badges?	24		
"Opportunity without parallel"	24		
"We blend all Three Legacies together"	24		

ELECTORAL MAP OF U.S. & CANADA



For reports on proposed and approved changes of region and on election of regional trustees, see: p. 34, trustees' Nominating Committee, item 7; p. 41, Floor Actions 2,3,4; p. 46, Conference Committee on Trustees, items 6,7.

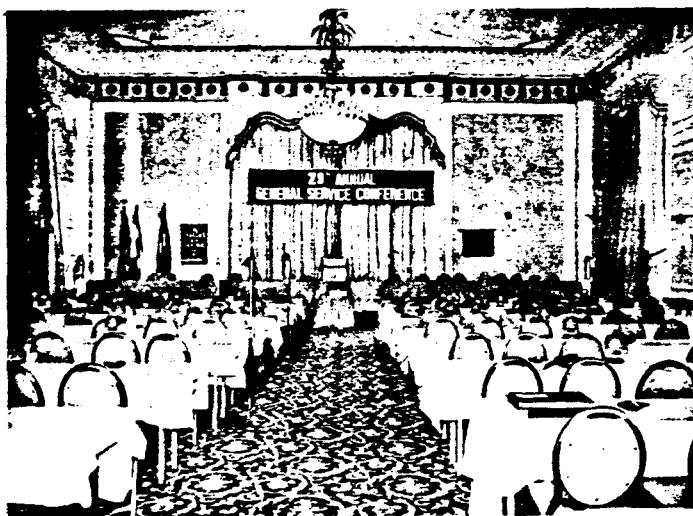


Packed Schedule and Lively Debate Mark the 29th Conference

Opening day

Chairing for the first time the annual General Service Conference meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous (U.S./Canada), non-alcoholic Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., chairperson of our General Service Board, formally gaveled the 29th gathering to order Monday morning, April 22, 1979, in the Terrace Room of New York's Hotel Roosevelt.

In preparation, Panel 29 delegates had attended orientation meetings the day before, and had joined with about 250 other Conference members and board guests for the opening dinner Sunday night. Trustee Jerry Danzig, New York, led that evening's A.A. meeting, at which speakers were: Vincina McCarthy, General Service Office (G.S.O.) staff member; delegate Ruth Peterson (Northern Illinois); Sarah Pierce, G.S.O. staff; delegate



Pierre Prenoveau (Southwestern Quebec); Lucy Warner, associate editor of the Grapevine; and Marvin Wilson, delegate from Montana.

After Monday's roll call and various introductions by Milton, Bob Pearson, G.S.O. manager, and Retha Gresham, Grapevine managing editor, the 91 area delegates and 41 other Conference members (G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, trustees, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine corporate directors) heard the keynote and welcoming talks. Soon thereafter, Milton began Conference business with the report of the board for 1978 (p. 30). The first day, Phyllis Masback, G.S.O. staff member who was Conference secretary, and Bob also reviewed the week's agenda and Conference mechanics.

After more reports (all summarized herein) that afternoon, delegates went into their first committee meetings; participated in a presentation/discussion on the A.A. archives (p. 10); heard the first segment of Reports on Area Service Highlights (p. 26); viewed the new A.A. film, "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View," before a discussion of it moderated by Al Hergott (Saskatchewan), Conference Literature Committee chairperson; and listened to the first Ask-It Basket (p. 41) questions and answers, presided over by delegate chairperson Ed Edwards (Maryland) and Pacific U.S. regional trustee George Dorsey.

And the agenda never got any lighter on subsequent days!

Keynote

'The Legacies: Our Heritage and My Responsibility'

I have participated in six Conferences, two as delegate and four as trustee. I still recall the keynote speech at my first. Trustee Jack Meagher delivered a moving appeal to speak out—to participate. Then as now, the theme had to do with responsibility.

Our theme focuses on our heritage, the Three Legacies. I think of them as a heritage of freedom: freedom from fear, misery, pain—yes, even various deaths. A freedom of choice I never had as a drinking alcoholic. The first Legacy is the passport to sobriety. The Second insures our healthy growth as a fellowship. The Third outlines a structure within which we can serve with minimal controversy. It is our responsibility to preserve this heritage.

We are sober because others before us fulfilled their responsibility. The least we can do is to hand on—intact—what was given to us. Your full participation during this week is vital to A.A.'s



future. This Conference is charged with the maintenance of our world service—the "whole" to which each of us belongs.

If we have done our homework, we know what our assignments are this week. We have studied the background material; we have, I hope, read "The A.A. Service Manual" again, and if we were really diligent (praise be), we read the Concepts. You

should also know how your area feels about topics on the agenda. But we should remember that "delegates do not go to the Conference to logroll benefits for their respective areas. They go primarily to render a service to world A.A., to insure that A.A. continues to function as a whole." I urge you to take an active part. Do not hesitate to express yourself. If you feel timid, use the Ask-It Basket.

Once, a holy man asked the Lord if he could see what heaven and hell are like. The Lord led him to two doors. He opened the first door, and the holy man looked in. There was a very large, round table. On the table was a large pot of stew. But in the midst of that plenty, the people sitting around the table were thin and sickly. He saw that the spoons they held had very long handles, longer than a person's arm, so it was impossible to get the food back to one's mouth. The Lord said, "You have seen hell."

In the next room were the same round table, the same pot of stew. The people held the same long-handled spoons, but were well nourished. They were laughing and talking. "I don't understand," said the holy man.

"It is very simple," said the Lord. "It requires but one skill. You see, they have learned to feed each other."

Let us this week feed each other, share our strength, hope and experiences so that those yet to come will see, when they open the door, a room full of healthy, animated people who have found the joy of living.

John Waterfield, Northeast U.S. regional trustee

Groups and members — spring 1979

	Groups	Members
United States	18,926	356,383
Canada	3,157	53,601
Overseas	8,737	149,336
Treatment facilities	1,285	30,788
Correctional facilities	1,136	36,306
Lone Members		435
Internationalists		607
Totals	33,241	627,456

Including nonreported members, it is estimated that there are more than 1,000,000 members worldwide.

Welcome

From apprehension to 'a spiritual feeling'

With a deep feeling of inadequacy, I welcome the Panel 29 delegates and those on Panel 28. Because we are A.A. members, "We become old acquaintances at first sight."

We have received reams of information, checked the group conscience in our areas, read the manual, and brushed up on Traditions, Steps, Big Book, "A.A. Comes of Age," all literature, and reports from previous Conferences, and it certainly leads one to be a bit apprehensive!

As the week unfolds, a spiritual feeling that the future of A.A.

rests in our hands takes hold. We have great responsibility to future Conferences and to millions of sick alcoholics yet to come. Bernard B. Smith, then board chairperson, said at the 1953 Conference, "We are charged with an obligation that stems from our Twelfth Step, that the spiritual message of A.A. can be brought for all time to all those who need it and are capable of receiving it. We in A.A. want to insure that the spiritual base of A.A. never is destroyed by lust for power, fame, money, or prestige. We must guarantee that there will never be a government in Alcoholics Anonymous."

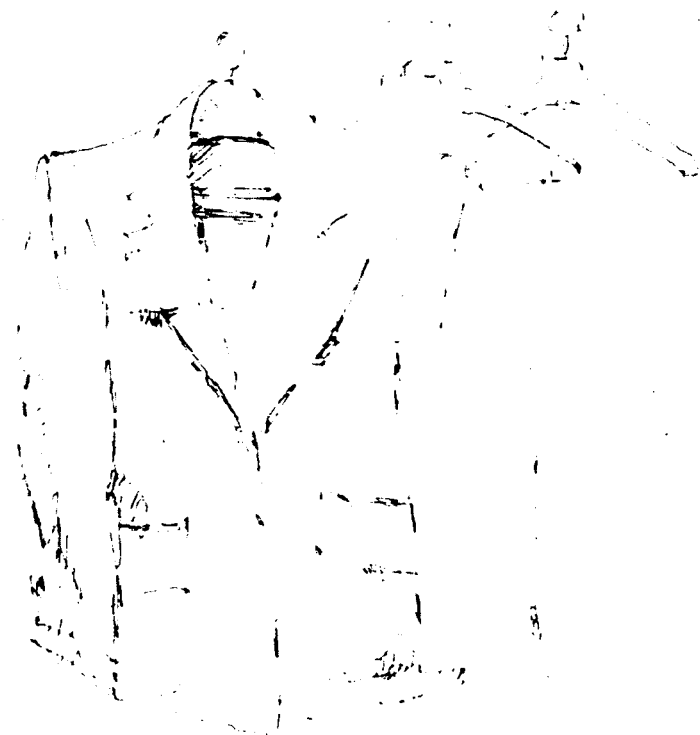
Ed Edwards (Maryland), delegate chairperson

Delegates' meeting

Delegates meet 'off the record'

- Area delegates met for dinner and discussion Tuesday evening, with Ed Edwards (Maryland) presiding. Bob Gadoury (Rhode Island) made a presentation entitled "How One Area Solved the Communication Problem."

Since no other Conference members are in the room for this annual get-together of area delegates, its proceedings are



not a part of the "official" Conference records. At Thursday's sharing session (see following article), the possibility of record-keeping at this meeting was discussed, but no change in the customary procedure was recommended.

Bob Bisanz (Southern Minnesota) was elected delegate chairperson, to take office immediately upon the close of the 1979 Conference meeting.

Important questions keep recurring

Six subjects were discussed at Thursday evening's plenary session, when any question could be raised.

Conference-approved literature—Most time was spent on the suggestion that every single piece of material distributed by G.S.O. should be Conference-approved. The logistics would be enormously complicated, it was pointed out. So, finally, it was agreed that a subcommittee of delegates, trustees, and staff members should study this topic and report back to the 1980 Conference—a proposal formally approved as Floor Action 4 (p. 45). In fact, the question has been reviewed in some form at all 29 Conference meetings.

Group names/directory listing—A recommendation that no group with a name considered "divisive" be listed in A.A. directories was withdrawn after long discussion. (See also Floor Action 1, p. 45.) Several members observed that this, too, has been a topic of Conference discussion for at least six years.

Canadian contributions—These should be shown in Canadian dollars, or the exchange rate clearly explained, it was agreed. This was the subject of a 1963 Conference action.

Hardcover/staples—Hardcover and stapled books are not allowed in many prisons, one delegate noted. But other delegates reported they have rebound A.A. books by sewing or by using plastic or cloth adhesive. Such information has been given to earlier Conferences.

Reprint permissions—Rights granted by A.A.W.S., Inc., to reprint any A.A. material should all be revoked, and all such future requests denied, one delegate reported as a recommendation from his assembly. Legal problems are involved, however, and one director said he "began to feel extremely uncomfortable about withholding our spiritual principles from people who need them." This, too, has been a focus of Conference attention in many prior years, but no action was taken.

The fact that so many topics carry over from year to year is *not* evidence that successive Conferences "keep inventing the wheel," one staff member said. In a changing world, many aspects of A.A. service need fresh looks and reevaluation; and besides, no Conference is bound by actions of any preceding Conference, it was noted.

Conference sidelights

Delegates this year had a range of sobriety from six to 29 years; the average was 12½. Average age was 54, ranging from 35 to 79. . . .

Shopping forays, sightseeing, music, theater, and other treats were provided for delegates' spouses by a volunteer committee of New York area A.A. and Al-Anon members, headed by Muriel Tierney of A.A.'s Lenox Hill Group. Local A.A.'s and Al-Anons also staffed a hospitality room for these guests. . . .

Displays pictured on several pages in this report were among the 20 set up at the rear of the Terrace Room, where they



Dennis Manders (nonalcoholic), G.S.O. controller, has been actively involved in all Conferences, 1951-1979. ("Dr. Jack" Norris has also been present at all; Nell Wing, at all till she became our archivist.)

attracted attention when Conference members took coffee breaks. Some of the boards were created by Mary Nichols of the New York Intergroup staff. . . .

Whenever Conference members did not all eat lunch or dinner together in the Oval Room, many informal meetings were held over meals. The Conference 1980 International Convention Committee, General Service Board, A.A.W.S. directors, and Grapevine Corporate Board all held working dinner meetings. The Conference P.I. and C.P.C. Committees met jointly Tuesday for lunch; Wednesday, regional trustees lunched with their delegates for informal sharing.

Closing talk

Unity and Service make Recovery possible

Until I came to work at G.S.O. in 1965, I knew almost nothing about Unity and Service, even though I had been receiving the benefits of these Legacies abundantly for eight years. At some early point in my G.S.O. work, I came to realize I had been the beneficiary of Unity and Service even before Recovery began. Someone on the other end of the intergroup telephone offered A.A. Service when I needed help so desperately; someone said "Hello" when I arrived at that first A.A. meeting; someone had set up the chairs and made the coffee; someone had displayed the literature, and someone, somewhere, had produced it; someone led the beginners meeting that subsequently turned my life around; and most of all, the group was there, carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers—me, on this occasion. Unity and Service in action.

I saw and heard enough that night that I didn't drink for one day, and I came back. Recovery had begun. I'm still coming back, and Recovery has continued, because all *three* Legacies were showered upon me at that very first meeting.

If we are *trusted* servants, it seems to me we should also be *trusting*—trusting our Higher Power, our program, our Legacies, one another. Without trust, there would have been no healing, no Recovery. Trusting people like you at my first meeting was the beginning for me: I trusted that you had been where I was,

and if A.A. had worked for you, it could work for me. I soon began to trust my group, then A.A. principles. When I came to G.S.O., I began to trust my colleagues and my boss; I trusted the Traditions and the structure—the board, the Conference—the collective group conscience of A.A. as a whole. It no longer mattered whether I trusted myself or not; I didn't even have to ask the question any longer. I had put myself in better hands—those of the Higher Power, my A.A. friends, my A.A. group, my A.A. service colleagues, and A.A. as a whole, because of trust.

If these elements had been rigid or had bound me in a strait-jacket, I would not be here today. I wouldn't even be sober. Our pioneers knew themselves and us—we need room, flexibility, freedom under the benign discipline of our Legacies.

This Conference is made up of trusted servants who fill a variety of roles, though we all have the same purpose—to protect, enhance, and fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose. Delegates, trustees, directors, and staff bring the experience and perspective of different roles to share with one another as equals—as members of a fellowship. Our views may sometimes vary, because our job functions vary. Ultimately, this adds to the richness of the Conference experience. There have been times when the opposite seemed true—disagreement became so abrasive, it sowed mistrust among us. Arriving at a good group conscience can be a rough free-for-all. It can be so tough that sometimes the group conscience doesn't have a chance. We have to wait. When it finally does emerge, we know it was worth the effort.

All of us really know that each of us is dedicated to what is best for A.A. as we see it, and no one here wants to see any A.A. principle or Tradition even chipped or bent—not to mention broken. Bill said and wrote repeatedly that the whole A.A. program is susceptible to a wide variety of interpretation, and the Traditions especially are full of gray areas. Differences of opinion abound and probably always will.

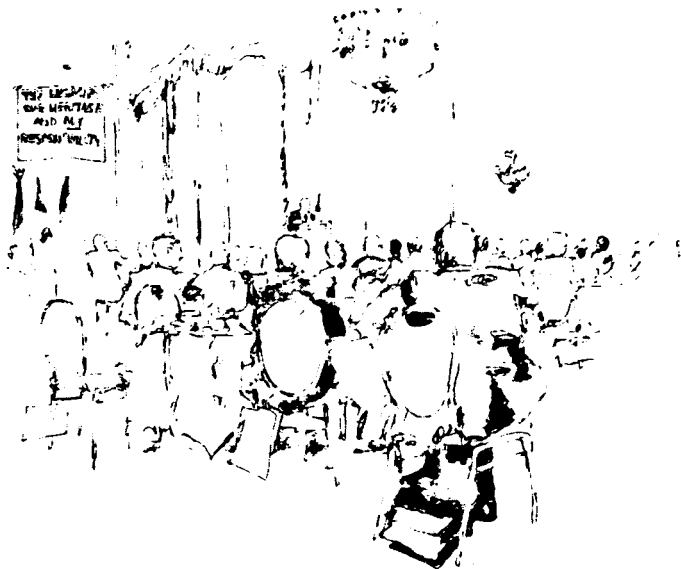
In our own ways, we have all absorbed the great body of A.A. literature, and most of us are sure our interpretation is the right one. History is replete with accounts of holy (and unholy) wars fought by people who believed they had the monopoly on truth. Recovery for me began when I was able to listen, so I could learn from the experience of others. The gift of trust made that possible. I hope we still hold that gift of trust, and can continue to listen and learn and change and grow as individuals and as a fellowship.

I believe we should strive for excellence—not the good, but the best. We should strive for understanding and compassion—not just for the newcomer, but for one another—trusted servants all. Our entire program is to be embraced with love, joy, and freedom, not imposed with inhibition and rigidity. We have learned from the past, and I believe that our Three Legacies, which share that experience, will continue to inform our group conscience so that, day by day, we can face our future with confidence, with trust.

This Fellowship has been for me like the sun—lighting up every corner of my life. I am overwhelmed by the rewards. Personal joys it has brought to me and my family are without number, and the great adventures that I have enjoyed through these 14 years and 14 Conferences of sharing and learning and enjoying sobriety through love and service with all of you are treasures without price. I will soon return to the joys I first knew—of be-

ing just a member of my own group, and what more could I ask?

Cora Louise Belford, G.S.O. staff



Closing brunch

Was the Conference 'fun'?

As usual, the brunch that closed the Conference Saturday morning was a tearful but enjoyable occasion, when retiring trustees made their final Conference talks and various G.S.O. personnel were thanked for their work behind the scenes.

As Conference chairperson, Milton Maxwell presided. He, Bob Pearson, Ed Edwards, and Bob Bisanz all spoke of the "miracle" of the group conscience. Bob B. said he had been asked, "Are you having any fun?" "This is too heavy to be fun," he declared. "There is joy, but not really enjoyment."

Bob Pearson singled out for special thanks nonalcoholic G.S.O. employees Elizabeth Garcia, Dotty McGinity, Adeline Wilmot, Donna Berkowitz, and Abby Notterman, plus staff members Phyllis Masback and Cora Louise Belford.

The Early Bird (Conference) issue of *Box 4-5-9* was at every plate, and after an ample breakfast, the retiring trustees made their farewell remarks, highlighted here.

'We do not represent areas or regions'

"I've discovered that being a delegate, or delegate chairman (which I was in 1963), or even a trustee in A.A. is no big deal! Being allowed to become a member of an A.A. group is as big as we drunks will ever get.

"I was the only one in my group with a car, so that's how I became G.S.R. Being the only one with a service manual, I became the area chairman. Naturally, I saw I was the obvious choice to be our delegate. But that was obvious only to me, not to anyone else. So they elected someone else. I'm happy to re-

call that I had even forgotten I was to be nominated as a trustee four years ago—and here I am.

"I get concerned about the idea that we 'represent' some constituency at the Conference. We do not represent areas or regions. Areas and regions contribute to A.A. money and people. Those of us here are just contributions of people—made to A.A. as a whole. We represent A.A. as a whole.

"I have also learned there is not much point in my being so darned wise in A.A. Nobody pays any attention, anyway.

"The most important thing we can do at the Conference, in my opinion, is continuously take the Tenth and Eleventh Steps. Otherwise, we shortchange ourselves, and we shortchange A.A.

"I am not concerned now about what happens to me. I'm going back to my group and carry the message."

Mac Cheater, trustee-at-large—Canada

'Something happens beyond ourselves'

Chuck began the second part of what he called "The Chuck and Mac Show" with: "I don't know about rotation. I've been considering a palace coup."

He recalled the psychiatrist who said to him, "Never mind about your drinking. What about your sex life?" Chuck said to himself, he admitted, "What sex life?"

Having started his A.A. service on the Grapevine Editorial Board ten years ago, he said, "My deepest debt of gratitude is to Jack Morley and Paula Carpenter." He then offered, in a gently humorous vein, compliments to staff members.

"Here at the Conference, as at a Regional Forum," he said, "something happens beyond ourselves. My question is: How do we adapt to a changing world without squandering our inheritance?"

Charles (Chuck) Hanson, general service trustee

'You are all stars; you bring light'

"Rotation," said retiring board treasurer Arthur Miles, "is a step into humility. . . . And I'm quoting that from Box 4-5-9."

Referring to the fact that nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees serve three three-year terms, but A.A. members (Class B) only one four-year term, Art said, "I wonder if it is time we thought about putting A's and B's on an equal footing.

"What makes A.A. so wonderful is your love for each other, and for those out there still with the problem. You are *all* stars; you bring light. . . . I have one complaint: I have found A.A. addictive, and I know I shall not be able to resist calling Dennis [Manders, controller, G.S.O.] and asking, 'Are we doing better yet at broadening the base of group support?'"

"Old treasurers never die. They just lose interest."

Arthur Miles, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee

Big ideas fade; hope flourishes

"I never got any official letter or notice of my election as a trustee. But one day, Dennis called me to say there was a room for me in Denver for the Convention. Actually, I felt I really began to fit in when I went on the Archives Committee.

"As a delegate, I came with big ideas and hope. I went home without big ideas, but I still have the hope. One of my first area committee meetings was described by a member as 'a chamber-of-commerce fight to see which Oklahoma city would be the capital of A.A.'! But I had made a decision at my very first A.A. meeting to do everything I was told. I'm glad I did.

"We come of age—as members or A.A. units—when we become truly self-supporting, I think. We survived because first, we had no place else to go, and second, we cared for each other.

"Just carry the message, or we'll lose it. I guess that is what I've been trying to do for 32 years."

Mike Rainbolt, Southwest U.S. regional trustee

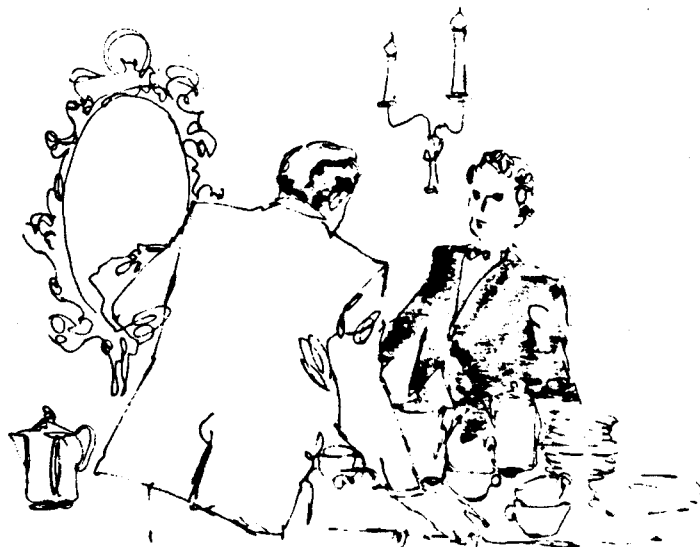
'My name came out of the hat'

"In 1974, my doctor said I had six months to live. This month, I am 70 years old.

"When I first came to A.A., I didn't even wonder where our literature came from. Certainly, I never expected I would some day be a delegate, much less a trustee. And that was the opinion of 99% of the members I knew, too! I was a basket case in the election—my name came out of the hat.

"As a drinking alcoholic, I was always rotating, anyhow, so what is new about today? What is the brass ring we expect to grab in A.A.? *Some* group will have a place for me, I know. If they don't, I'll start my own group!"

John Waterfield, Northeast U.S. regional trustee



Discussions Cover a Wide Range of A.A. Life

**COME
CELEBRATE
SOBRIETY!**
INTERNATIONAL A.A. CONVENTION
45TH ANNIVERSARY "THE JOY OF LIVING"



NEW ORLEANS JULY 3-6 1980

1980 International Convention

With the 1980 International Convention only about 14 months away, special Convention reports drew rapt attention Monday morning. Betty Liddle, G.S.O. staff member who has this assignment, introduced Cecil Corrigan, who gave a condensed version of the trustee committee report (see p. 35) and then Bill Geer, Conference committee chairperson.

A look ahead at 'The Joy of Living'

In Louisiana, we receive inquiries from all over the world about our 1980 International Convention in New Orleans. So our own enthusiasm mounts.

New Orleans, the city that care forgot, has many attractions, such as our French Quarter, the home of Dixieland jazz, and many fantastic places to dine that can't be beat anywhere. Our Superdome is the eighth wonder of the world. Imagination cannot capture its vastness. Many A.A. functions can be held at the same time under one roof, including some 6,000 lunches and 6,000 dinners per day. A list of restaurants to suit all pocketbooks will be available—everything from a hot dog from a Bourbon Street cart to leisurely, candlelit patio dining, jazz brunches, and Southern-style dinners in plantation homes, as well as brunches in our world-renowned, lovely old French Quarter restaurants.

You will want to see our many museums, art centers, and antique shops, or maybe take a guided tour, which includes riverboat cruises, plantation homes, and Garden District.

In the same way the Conference is planned each year—and you know the extent of *that* preparation—G.S.O. seems to be thoroughly anticipating every contingency in order to make the Convention in New Orleans run smoothly, so each of us can get the most out of this tremendous undertaking.

We look forward to greeting you at a fabulous Mardi Gras extravaganza Thursday evening, July 3, with a parade of floats, followed by two dances, the Crawfish Crawl for the young and the Mardi Gras Ball for the young at heart. Dances will be flavored at intervals with New Orleans Dixieland jazz.

Many of you may join us on the banks of the Mississippi to welcome members arriving from St. Louis by riverboat.

Louisiana needs you to complete the picture of the true meaning of "The Joy of Living," theme of our 1980 Convention. See you in New Orleans!

Bill Geer (Louisiana), chairperson, Conference Committee on the 1980 International Convention

Floor Action on the Convention: 2 (p. 45)
Advisory Actions: p. 47

The archives

The A.A. archives were the subject of the first Conference presentation/discussion, led by Mike Rainbolt, Southwest U.S. regional trustee. It was deemed appropriate for the archives to occupy this spot on the agenda, Monday afternoon, because of a noticeable increase in interest in A.A.'s beginnings and early history among Fellowship members.

To give A.A. 'a sense of its own past'

Since our theme this year is "Our Heritage," it is entirely appropriate that the first presentation is on the archives.

In the early days, Bill W. spoke often of the need for archives, but nothing was done about it. In 1972, a former trustee suggested the time had come to start. Nell Wing was named to organize this new service. With the aid of a professional librarian, she began to read letters and historical material.

There is a wealth of material about Bill and his activities, but we found very little about Dr. Bob. Now, much information has been obtained about Dr. Bob and his early work in the Fellowship, and this will be available to us all soon.

The trustees' Archives Committee was established by the board in 1973. The purpose of the archives is to keep the record straight so that myth does not predominate over fact as to A.A. history. The archives give the Fellowship a sense of its own past and the opportunity to study it.

Tom Sharpe, a past trustee from Florida, we asked to chair an archives committee-at-large. He wrote to about 175 early A.A.'s for their recollections and other material. We want to encourage states, provinces, and areas to write their own histories and stimulate oldtimers to do local histories. General service boards overseas are encouraged to do the same.

There is considerable interest in A.A. among sociologists, historians, and other professionals who want to find out what A.A. is and how it started. The committee is conservative in right of access; we have good controls. We hope to remain as open as possible to serious researchers and to allow A.A.'s free access to our historical legacy, while protecting the material itself from damage or loss and assuring the complete privacy of all individuals in keeping with our Traditions.

Many professionals already use the facility, and more requests come from A.A.'s seeking information. Major efforts are under way to protect the documents. Costs of such preservation are high, but we feel they are small compared with the importance of the material being safeguarded.

Mike Rainbolt, chairperson, trustees' Archives Committee

Today's 'junk' could be tomorrow's treasure

Our area has no archives. In becoming acquainted with the archives of the Southern California Area, I realized our lack of interest is merely unawareness.

The purpose of archives is to gather and preserve historical data. We hope it will be used by those interested in A.A. history. Passed on by word of mouth, history can become distorted. Archives are a permanent record of facts.

The Southern California Archives Committee first met in 1977. Included on it are members from general service, institutions committees, and central offices. This committee is responsible for the operation and welfare of the archives. Guidelines have been drawn up. Two custodians are appointed, subject to the approval of the committee. One is a librarian, and his expertise has been of tremendous value.

The collection is housed in the semi-basement of the Los Angeles Central Office, which is paid a nominal rent. Archival material must always be readily accessible to the Fellowship, but not at the residence of an individual. One custodian, a past delegate, is manager of the central office.

In the archival area today, you see a cabinet (housing books, tapes, and supplies) and four files of papers. These are fire-retardant and are kept locked. You can browse among printings of the Big Book, including the first copy to come to California (the 1938 Multilith version) and a copy of the third edition signed by local oldtimers. You can turn the pages of the March 1, 1941, *Saturday Evening Post* (then five cents per copy!), as well as subsequent *Post* articles by Jack Alexander and others. There are group photographs taken during the 1960 International Convention in Long Beach. You can listen to 16 tapes by Bill W. or Ebby T., or approximately 40 by 19 California-based oldtimers. Some of the material has been displayed at local conventions.

Obviously, these archives are not yet ready for heavy information retrieval. Growth has been slow because of lack of money and manpower. Communication with Nell Wing has been of such help, it is hoped some network of archival collectors can be established.

Meantime, all members are urged to develop "sticky fingers." Announcements, flyers, newspaper stories, articles, photos,

letters—such "junk" today could be invaluable tomorrow when A.A.'s try to piece together "what it used to be like."

Goldene Lahann (Mid-Southern California)

Sharing the 'continuing process' that is A.A.

Our holdings can be described under three classifications: (1) archives (correspondence, papers, and records of a business, legal, and financial nature); (2) history, or historical manuscripts, our largest category; (3) memorabilia or artifacts.

The four principal collections are: (1) early Alcoholic Foundation - G.S.O. records (1937-1955); (2) co-founders' letters, papers, tapes; (3) files of earliest A.A. groups (1939-1945); (4) pictures, photographs, awards and citations, artwork, etc.

Other archival material includes: printings of all editions of A.A. books and pamphlets (including the prepublication manuscript and first printing of the Big Book, April 1939, and the first pamphlet); bound copies of *World Directories*, *Conference Reports* and *Digests*, and G.S.O. newsletters; Grapevines; G.S.B. and A.A.W.S. records; films and filmstrips; oral history manuscripts; writings by A.A. members; magazines and other outside publications; history files of states and countries; registers of historical events and dates; 12 large scrapbooks started in 1939, and a current-clipping file cabinet; audiotapes of individuals, group meetings, conferences, and conventions; microfilm reels and reader; three tape machines.

We're engaged in long-term programs: (1) microfilming Bill - Dr. Bob correspondence, early group history and early records of G.S.O. since 1937; (2) oral history—interviews with early members and nonalcoholics (majority are taped, but some prefer to send manuscripts); (3) rehabilitation and restoration of old and deteriorating material; (4) compatible taping—professional outfit retapes early wire recordings, phonograph records, and deteriorating tapes in a standard format, so all can be played on one particular tape machine; (5) acquiring and processing history material from groups, areas, states, provinces, and countries; (6) a retrieval system (cataloging, indexing); (7) audiotapes—preparation of duplicate sets for permanent storage in Somerville, N.J.; (8) aiding researchers. These projects are beyond the normal daily activities, such as answering mail, phone, and staff inquiries and conducting tours.

We want to share with the Fellowship as many historic items as we can. Three are newly available: nine photographs for use by clubs, archival centers, or central offices; facsimile pre-publication manuscript of the Big Book; and a cassette of Bill and Dr. Bob.

Current projects are: restoration of our old scrapbooks (one badly deteriorated, dating back to 1939); creating a separate collection of tapes of Bill W.'s talks; and encouraging development of other archival centers in the U.S., Canada, and other countries. Many are now emerging, perhaps about 15.

We believe all A.A. archive centers will preserve, protect, and make available the true record, so myths do not distort A.A. history. We also hope our archives and others present the whole span of our history. We want visitors to gain new appreciation of A.A.'s beginnings and awareness of its living

continuity. As Bill said, "A.A. is not an achievement, but a continuing process."

Nell Wing, archivist

The story of A.A. literature distributed by G.S.O.

How does the A.A. literature distributed by G.S.O. come into being? What is special about it? To answer those questions, three Conference members offered a presentation/discussion Tuesday morning, moderated by Jane Story (Southern New Jersey), member of the Conference Literature Committee.

Literature and film respond to A.A. needs

The trustees' Literature Committee, established in 1951 at the request of the First General Service Conference, emphasized initially that it was concerned only with literature to be presented to the Conference for approval. Its central concerns were: (1) suggested policies for A.A. publications; (2) anticipated functions of A.A. literature; (3) effectiveness of current literature; (4) needs for various types of publications expressed by A.A. groups and their representatives.

The committee originally suggested that A.A. literature had five major objectives: (1) to present an accurate picture of A.A. to the alcoholic who still drinks; (2) to represent A.A. to the general public, including the alcoholic's relatives, friends, employers, and medical and spiritual advisers; (3) to provide for future A.A. growth by documenting, through material on the Traditions, A.A. principles, practices, and experiences; (4) to encourage members' continuing interest and participation; (5) to provide essential communication between G.S.O. and the groups.

Since 1951, the trustees' Literature Committee has asked for and been given approval of the General Service Board for the preparation of many of our pamphlets that are now in widespread use throughout the Fellowship.

In 1977, it was recommended that a subcommittee be established to explore the possible need of audiovisual material for A.A. The majority of respondents to a questionnaire indicated that there was such a need, and the Audiovisual Subcommittee was asked to explore the possibility of producing a film that would capture the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous and yet preserve anonymity. Filmmakers were selected to produce test film footage, which was presented at the 1978 Conference to indicate the character of the proposed documentary on A.A.

The subcommittee and the Literature Committee feel the completed film is of such quality that it may be used in many areas, such as closed A.A. meetings, open meetings, public information meetings, and institution meetings.

The Literature Committee, like the other trustees' committees, is always anxious to have suggestions from the membership. All suggestions and recommendations are given careful consideration at meetings of this committee, where the group conscience prevails and substantial unanimity is reached before decisions are made.

As a matter of interest: When the Literature Committee starts

working on a new pamphlet, it takes approximately two years for the pamphlet to become a reality.

Don Nicolson, chairperson, trustees' Literature Committee

'Trust is vital'

We have two classifications of printed matter at G.S.O.: (1) Conference-approved literature; (2) service material, further divided into Guidelines and informational matter.

Conference-approved literature carries the emblem of the triangle within a circle, containing "A.A." and "General Service Conference," and the words "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature." Such a publication represents the broadest possible consensus of A.A. thinking. It has been carefully prepared under close scrutiny of trustees' and Conference committees before going to the Conference for approval.

Service material does not go through this elaborate process. G.S.O. prepares it in such forms as pamphlets, leaflets, flyers, one-page informational pieces, and even lists. Its purpose is simply to provide information serving the Fellowship. Much of it is initiated by a trustee or Conference committee. For example, "Self-Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan" was prepared on recommendation of the Conference Finance Committee. Many informational pieces develop in response to a need expressed by the Fellowship. "A.A. at a Glance," for instance, resulted from a need expressed by an area public information committee. Service material such as our Guidelines reflects shared experience collected from the Fellowship.

Pamphlets are initiated when need is shown—usually from within A.A., sometimes from friends outside. G.S.O. received requests from within A.A. and from outside agencies for a pamphlet for older alcoholics, and the trustees' Literature Committee formed a subcommittee to work on it.

The 1952 Conference approved our retaining professional writers on a fee basis, a policy still followed. Perhaps not every writer has been an A.A., but no one at G.S.O. can remember an exception. On occasion, staff members write pamphlets or service material as part of their assignments, with no additional fee. Manuscripts are circulated to the staff and the appropriate committees. Their comments and suggestions are then incorporated into the manuscript. In that way, the material reflects the sharing of many, rather than an individual point of view.

How does literature become Conference-approved? After reviewing the material, a Conference committee recommends approval to the Conference as a whole. If the Conference accepts the committee's recommendation, the material is then considered Conference-approved.

Decision to publish new material or revise existing pieces is made when need arises. When significant revisions are made, they should go through the appropriate committee, and changes should be reported to the Fellowship through appropriate channels. A decision must always be made on whether a revision is significant enough to warrant committees' attention. Many pieces are only slightly altered as they are reprinted—figures updated, sentences clarified, or information added. If every modification was placed on a committee agenda,

meetings would be too cumbersome for effective operation. Our Tenth Concept states, "Every service responsibility should be matched by an equal service authority..." When an error is made in judging the significance of a change, you have an obligation to question the revision. You have the tools to effect change. I am sure all members of the G.S.O. staff strive to serve you well, and I hope you will be charitable when we make mistakes. Trust is vital for our working together.

Lois Fisher, literature coordinator

Too much? Too specialized?

Literature has been one of our most effective recovery tools, as well as a source of income that has made it possible to provide services to A.A. groups. Since 85% of our literature is sold to groups, the groups, in a sense, support A.A.W.S., Inc., which does our publishing and turns over excess funds to support general services. Literature would be free or of minimal cost if group contributions supported G.S.O. But we publish more and more, and groups buy the old as well as the new, thus leaving less in the group treasury for contributions. So the more groups buy, the less they can contribute.

Do we have too much literature? Each of the trustee committees may develop recovery pamphlets or service material. Are we getting away from simplicity, heading toward too much complexity? Are we becoming too technical and losing the spiritual essence of what we are all about? Research in my area shows inconsistencies and contradictions between new and revised pamphlets and older literature. This can lead to confusion. The P.I. and C.P.C. Committees appear to be developing the most new pamphlets lately. Could the energy channeled into P.I. be better used within the Fellowship?

Is our recovery literature becoming too specialized? More and more of our pamphlets are directed toward people with problems other than alcoholism, or toward specific segments of society. Didn't we all think we were unique? We have pamphlets for the young, the inmate, those in the armed services, and soon, the elderly. Do these emphasize differences rather than similarities? Is our common bond of alcoholism de-emphasized? Do these pamphlets tend to increase the number of "special problem" and "special interest" groups? Change is inevitable, but it must come about slowly. Our literature must not be a reflection of special groups or differing interests.

In my area, we learned that not all our literature is Conference-approved. This led to questions. What criteria determine whether a pamphlet is Conference-approved? Who makes this decision? If a Tradition is questioned, what A.A. literature is the most reliable source of reference? Is "current practice" (even though it may not be correct, or in line with our basic principles and Traditions) justification for revisions in our literature?

I have been impressed at G.S.O.'s rapidity in responding to group conscience expressed in the Conference. Staff members listen carefully to many opinions. They have a tremendous task and a great responsibility. Ours are equally great. We must be sound in thinking and clear in decisions.

I hope that we shall always be guided by our "ultimate

authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience"; that we measure up to the excellence of our gentle textbook, "Alcoholics Anonymous," speaking the God-inspired language of the heart. I hope the success of A.A. will never spoil us.

*Annette Fiel (Northern Interior California),
Conference Literature Committee*

Floor Action on A.A. literature: 4 (p. 45)

Advisory Actions: p. 47

Also see sharing session (p. 7)

A.A. around the world

Two special reports given on Tuesday afternoon revealed the steadily growing strength of A.A. as a worldwide movement.

A World Service Meeting delegate reports

I came from Finland with some personal observations. We in North America must maintain high quality in our structure and service, since A.A. was founded here. Although A.A. structures in other countries are independent, they look to us for guidance. We have to set a good example when they care to look. This is especially true of our nonalcoholic trustees. Their contributions are invaluable, and we must maintain standards set by people like "Dr. Jack" Norris.

Our own G.S.O. staff did a wonderful job in a strange country. Viekko Kuosmanen, G.S.O. manager in Helsinki, said their help was invaluable. Many people felt Bob Pearson's Sunday message was a real highlight.

More information on staffing and what a general service office does is really needed. Delegates also talked about members' traditional reluctance about money. They thought translations of our "money" pamphlet might help. The expense of the W.S.M. itself was minimal. If you could only have seen the sharing and unity there! While countries have such trouble staying at peace with each other, it was worth any expense to see these international A.A.'s cooperate so well.

Ireland and other countries said that *personal* interpretations of the Traditions must be avoided. They feel that the Traditions must be accepted as they are, that harm can come to A.A. only from within.

Only one country said A.A.'s cannot hold meetings at correctional centers. But inmates are allowed to write to A.A. members, who feel this is a great step.

I was impressed with the relationship the groups have with the press. Many of them have press conferences before major events, using members very familiar with the anonymity Traditions. Mac Cheater said this is done in Canada. I wonder if our U.S. P.I. committees could learn something.

There were strong feelings about A.A. Conference-approved literature's being sold in central offices. I am always disturbed to see more non-A.A. literature than Conference-approved sold in such settings. In some countries, lack of access to our own literature may explain this.

Sponsorship for young people seems to be a concern.

A great new development is the clearinghouse in London for the European countries. The unity this displays is obviously needed for growth in years ahead. It will enable us to be present, and strong, when untold millions come to A.A. to be given their life in years ahead.

Virginia Hallman, W.S.M. delegate (U.S./Canada)

‘There are no strangers in A.A.’

What does it mean to us here today when we say A.A. exists in 92 countries? It means any one of us can find a friend almost anywhere in the world. It means people everywhere have the same problems and find the same answers. A.A. works, the world over. Differing cultures shift the emphasis a little here and there, and length of experience in A.A. affects where we are in our growth toward maturity; but the progress and process are amazingly similar.

In September 1978, I reported on the 1977 survey of A.A. membership at the International Congress on Alcohol and Drug Dependence held in Warsaw, Poland. A.A. is thought well of in Poland, but they need more contact with our literature. This was suggested by what people said and didn't say about A.A. We hope that more of our literature in English and in other languages can be made available to them.

You have heard reports of the World Service Meeting in Helsinki. [See foregoing report and p. 38.]

In New Zealand in February of this year, we were invited by the National Society on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence to participate in a postgraduate seminar on alcoholism at the Auckland Medical College, and were asked to talk with management and labor unions in Wellington about programs for alcoholic workers and to speak at the National Society's Summer School on Alcohol Studies at Massey University in Palmerston North.

We also attended the annual A.A. Convention at Massey. The chairman of the board of New Zealand took us to an A.A.

meeting in Whangarei. At large A.A. gatherings in Auckland and Christchurch, I talked about the early days. At a big meeting in Dunedin, an A.A. and an Al-Anon were on the program. At a meeting in Wellington, there were many who were young and new in A.A.

We saw Rotorua, the center of Maori culture. The Maoris and the Polynesians are New Zealand's minority, with many of the same problems we have with our minorities—much alcoholism with little acceptance of A.A. among them.

New Zealand A.A. is similar to A.A. here—but a little more like England in its uneasiness about the spiritual aspect of recovery. New Zealand members have many of the problems we have with physicians and psychologists who give lip service to A.A. but do not really understand; yet many in New Zealand have come into A.A. after hospitalization. One of our strongest supporters, a delegate to the W.S.M. in Helsinki, is a psychiatrist and director of a mental hospital in Auckland.

There are no strangers in A.A. We have friends everywhere.

*John L. Norris, M.D., chairperson emeritus,
General Service Board*

How do roundups, jamborees, cruises, rallies, etc., fit into A.A. Traditions?

The varied types of A.A. get-together were the stimulating topic Tuesday afternoon of a presentation/discussion moderated by delegate Frank Stewart (South Carolina).

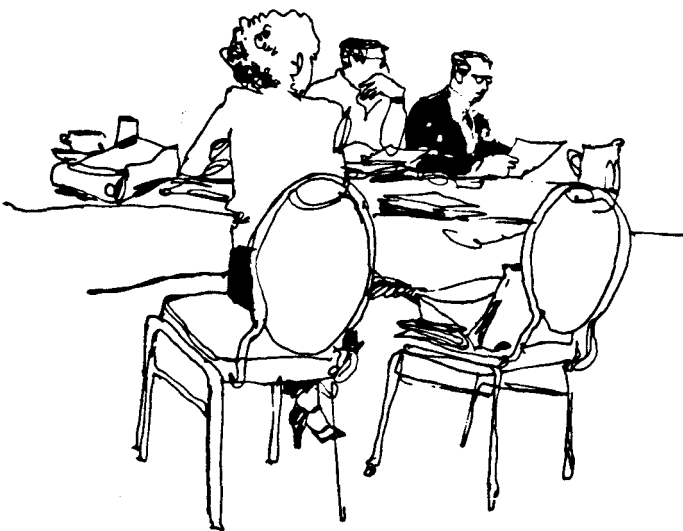
Tradition breaks can be avoided

Being given a “loving invitation” to speak on this subject doesn't really amaze me. The fact that I have never attended any roundups, jamborees, cruises, or rallies, etc., doesn't seem to make any difference!

Are these various A.A. get-togethers in conflict with our Twelve Traditions? I suppose it has happened somewhere, sometime, as is possible whenever two or more A.A.'s get into any joint endeavor. However, the possibility of Tradition breaks doesn't mean they *have* to happen. One of our responsibilities is to encourage application of our Traditions. As we encourage reading and discussion of our Traditions and Concepts at regular meetings, assemblies, conferences, and jamborees, and make them a part of every A.A. assemblage, I'm sure better understanding of the spiritual principles will grow, and we will eliminate the possibility of Tradition breaks.

Whenever I hear of a Tradition break, I always feel somehow responsible. What could I have done to prevent this? If a break is caused by a lack of understanding, possibly I could have prevented it by encouraging more discussion on the Traditions.

In Alaska, I have a nickname, “The Unity Guy,” and I'm proud of it. Our Second Legacy, Unity, needs more effort. Recovery has the Big Book, and Service has “The A.A. Service Manual.” Unity has the Traditions, you, me, and the other A.A. members. My strongest feelings of Unity occur when I'm with you.



So if these affairs can be operated without Tradition breaks (and I believe they can) and can contribute to A.A. Unity, I will welcome such affairs to Alaska when they become available. I'm no different from thousands of other A.A.'s. I never miss an opportunity to congregate with my own kind, whether it's for meetings, assemblies, or social functions.

I believe these opportunities for sharing and caring with each other are good for me, for my group, for my area, and for A.A. as a whole.

Dick Juelson (Alaska)

'Mindful of the spirit of our Traditions'

A roundup, in my definition, is a gathering of people. In our area, all functions would fit into the category of roundup, so I limit my presentation to roundups. A.A. Guidelines on Conferences and Conventions state that such a gathering is really "just a darned good A.A. meeting blown up big . . . fellowship, laughter, warmth, and understanding." How can anyone argue with that?

Roundups cost money. We have to rent space, and if we have a banquet, this will also cost. If we invite speakers from a distance, their expenses have to be covered. So we charge a registration fee. Some members feel that money and spirituality don't mix, that we are breaking Traditions. If Ebby had not been willing to spend a nickel to call Bill, we would probably not have A.A. as we know it today.

Planning such an event, the group or intergroup appoints a committee, with half the members rotated yearly. This helps keep us within the spirit of A.A. Committee members have to be prudent, charging a fair price for value offered, so the event will not accumulate a large surplus or run into a deficit. In most cases, a small profit is realized; it is used to set up a prudent reserve for the next roundup and to help support the local central office or G.S.O. Let's look at our Traditions.

- 1 Our common welfare should be enhanced by these gatherings, which should promote growth and understanding in A.A.
- 2 Our ultimate authority is a loving God expressed through our group conscience in selecting a committee to work for us.
- 3 A.A. membership should not depend on money. At most roundups, no member who wishes to attend is denied admittance because of lack of funds. The committee usually provides tickets to members in treatment facilities and rehabs who could not otherwise afford to attend. Also, many members purchase an extra ticket and leave it with the committee to be used in these circumstances—anonymous, of course.
- 4 "Each group should be autonomous except in matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole." As a roundup is a group affair, it normally would not affect other groups.
- 5 "Each group has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." I believe the organizing should be left to the committee, so that a group's primary purpose does not become organizing a roundup.
- 6 The committee should be responsible for administration, so that problems of money will be kept outside the group and will not "divert us from our primary spiritual aim."
- 7 "The A.A. groups themselves ought to be fully supported by the voluntary contributions of their own members." Surplus funds, beyond a prudent reserve, should be used for other than

group requirements — for our central offices, literature for hospitals and institutions, and G.S.O. We should beware of the public solicitation of funds.

In my opinion, Traditions Eight, Nine, and Ten are not involved, except that a rotating committee responsible to the groups it serves is the best method of handling a roundup. Our Traditions of anonymity should be strictly adhered to. If we are ever mindful of the *spirit* of all Traditions, I believe these A.A. functions can contribute much to A.A. as a whole.

Helen Harmon (Manitoba)

'A tremendous learning experience'

The first banquet I went to was an anniversary. I was sober about a month, still rummy. But I will never forget all those happy, sober people. Tickets were \$3.00. For the meeting? No. For the dinner. Since then, I have been to many conferences, conventions, roundups. I wish I could attend more.

How do they fit into the A.A. picture with our Traditions? I find no conflict at all. A.A. groups pay rent to hold meetings. A.A. individuals help pay that rent. As A.A. individuals, we also help pay rent on places to hold roundups, rallies, conventions, etc. At many, the package includes rooms and meals. But the fees are for services and products received—not for the A.A. meetings.

Tradition One: Large gatherings broaden friendship and bring unity across group, district, and area lines.

Tradition Two: In planning and operating such gatherings, I have found, G.S.R.'s choose the people to be in charge.

Tradition Three: Meetings at these gatherings are open to anyone. Paying the registration fee is paying our own way, for renting facilities. Other fees are for meals and/or rooms.

Tradition Four: These gatherings affect many A.A. groups and A.A. as a whole. Unity, sharing, and love there are great.

Tradition Five: We have one purpose at these functions—the growth of A.A. I was in St. Louis in 1955. One night, several of us took a taxi to a club. The driver said, "This buttermilk convention of yours is quite something." Then he added—and I can hear it today—"It's a real treat to carry people who know what they want to do and where they want to go." We carried the A.A. message to this man.

Tradition Six: People selected by G.S.R.'s make money decisions, and disposition of surplus is worked out. No problem.

Tradition Seven: Here again, fees are for goods and services received, not for A.A. meetings.

One other aspect of these activities is their social impact. I never learned to dance, play cards, or fish. I drank. Sober, I like now to be around sober people. My social life involves other A.A. members mostly. I have learned to laugh once again. Planned properly, these activities can be a tremendous learning experience. I heartily recommend them.

Mark Peterson (Maine)

The Grapevine representative (GvR) plan, given new life by area delegates since 1977, received chief credit for the A.A. magazine's record increase in readers when Conference members heard three Grapevine presentations Wednesday evening. John Ryall, GV director, moderated.

Our magazine helps individual sobriety

During the early days of my sobriety, I spent much time at a club with old copies of the Grapevine. I read for better understanding of my problem and of A.A. The Grapevine answered many questions I was afraid to ask. Stories of recovery gave me hope. My continuing involvement in the Grapevine has shown me its importance in all three of our Legacies.

The 1977 Conference recommended “that delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.” The momentum of this has continued. It was not always this way. In 1952, the Conference suggested a GVr in every group, and not until 1966 was the first area GV committee established, in the state of Washington.

first area G.V. committee established, in the state of Washington.

After the 1977 Conference, my area's first Grapevine chairperson was appointed. We began a united effort to get GV representation on a group level. In 1978, we established our Grapevine Committee. At its meetings, GvRs share problems and successes; upcoming magazine highlights are read so representatives can report them to groups. Recycling back issues for distribution to institutions has become a committee function. GvRs encourage groups to purchase subscriptions for libraries, doctors' offices, rehab centers, schools, and churches. A Grapevine display is shown at our state convention, roundup, and assemblies. Copies of the Bill W. memorial issue are also available.

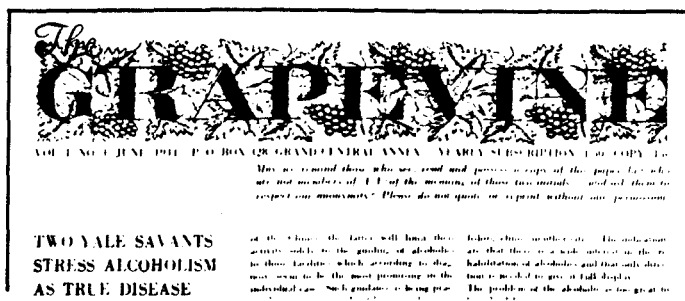
Tangible results of the 1977 Conference action are reported elsewhere. But how can we measure the influence this has had on personal sobriety? I share with you one example.

At a GV workshop at a Regional Forum this year, the chairperson asked how we first encountered the GV. One young man said that, two years previously, he had picked up a copy from a prison guard's desk. In his cell, his first reaction was that it was a lot of rubbish. He became furious and threw it against the wall. Later, he realized the articles were about him. As a result, he joined our Fellowship. He was attending that workshop to learn about becoming a GvR for his group.

**John Maloney (Western Massachusetts),
Conference Grapevine Committee**

The Grapevine—not a luxury, but a necessity

In 1968, I was twelfth-stepped into A.A. The first piece of literature I saw was the A.A. Grapevine. My sponsor-to-be had stuffed several copies into a napkin holder on her kitchen table, and later she gave me the silver-anniversary issue. Now, when the Grapevine office receives letters that say, "The Grapevine arrived just in time," I know they mean it. Many times, when I received my copy in the mail, I would find the answers to my



**TWO YALE SAVANTS
STRESS ALCOHOLISM
AS TRUE DISEASE**

Complete facsimile of the very first Grapevine is now a sale item.

current crisis. The magazine would put me into the atmosphere of a meeting, and I'd find what I needed for living sober. These letters bring us the greatest joy, and remind us of our tremendous responsibility. Ninety-nine percent of our letters tell us, "Keep up the good work." Yet the small number that criticize get most attention. Sometimes, we get an angry letter because we weren't able to use a piece; then we get a second letter, apologizing for the first!

The most exciting event at the GV office is arrival of the latest issue, the result of our combined effort, yours and ours. The next most exciting thing is the new GvR program. Because of GvRs, more members are hearing about this great sobriety tool—the A.A. message reflected in the Grapevine—and more groups are buying bulk subscriptions so members who can't afford a subscription can pick up a copy at the group.

For 35 years, the GV has been carrying the A.A. message of hope all over the world. Bill W. used it as his chief means of communication with the Fellowship. The Twelve Traditions were hammered out in its pages, and A.A. history was recorded there as it happened. We're grateful to Bill, who said, "The Grapevine is not a luxury. To A.A. as a whole, it is a necessity."

Retha Gresham, managing editor

A new staff faces new challenges

As I sat down to prepare this report, my eye fell on the April Grapevine. "Aha!" I cried. "Maybe I can postpone getting to work for a few minutes." One hour later, I was finishing another issue, just as I have been doing every month for the past 13 years. I was refreshed, stimulated, amused, and interested and felt that I had grown just a little in the program in that precious hour. I am totally addicted to the Grapevine and hope I never lose this particular dependence. The Grapevine is A.A.'s world-wide medium of personal sharing. Anyone who does not read it misses a rich portion of A.A. life.

For ten years, I have participated in the Grapevine from the inside, first on the Editorial Board, then on the Corporate Board. I have sat in awe and wonder at the love and dedication that go each month into our magazine.

Jack Morley and Paula Carpenter took the Grapevine from the precipice of financial disaster and rescued it from editorial drift. At that time, the Grapevine needed such loyalty more than anything else. It fell to me to participate in finding successors to Paula and Jack. Retha Gresham comes with a fine business background and administrative talent. A former delegate, she knows and loves the service structure thoroughly. Lucy Warner's

background reads as if she had been preparing for this job all her life. She has an editor's skill and senses the articles that will mean most to the Fellowship. And with Tom Neary, a veteran designer and artist, on the staff, we find the Grapevine in good hands.

Inflation afflicts the Grapevine as it does you and me. Every single month, the costs of paper, printing, and shipment soar. Circulation continues to rise, and our operations income went up 12.2% last year; but expenses went up 16.1%. The full story is in our annual financial report [p. 51]. Our economic situation is sound, but the squeeze is on. No one wants to see the Grapevine suffer in quality because cost pressure erodes our capital, and no one wants the Grapevine priced out of the reach of many members. In four areas, we can work to keep the Grapevine strong.

- 1 Increase circulation. A.A. growth has helped us; so has the GvR program the Conference recommended two years ago.
- 2 Decrease costs. Retha has found several economies and keeps a close watch on the pennies every day.
- 3 Increase sale of other products. "The Best of Bill" and "Best Cartoons From the Grapevine" still enjoy healthy sales; now, we have Victor E. name tags and the facsimile of the first issue; "The Best of the Grapevine" is in preparation.
- 4 Increase the price. This would be a *last* resort. We have had only two price increases in the past 15 years, both modest. All of us are interested in carrying the message to the greatest number of people.

Charles Hanson, chairperson, Grapevine Corporate Board

Advisory Actions on the Grapevine: p. 47

A & P (alcohol and pills) groups

The question of listing "alcohol and pills" groups in the A.A. directories evoked high interest among Conference members Thursday morning. Moderator was Sam Smith, Southeast U.S. regional trustee.

Is language behind this old A.A. problem?

This subject is on your agenda because of two Ask-It Basket questions at the 1978 Conference: "Would G.S.O. list in the directory a group called Young People Cross-Addicted?" and "Could you be sure to get a group conscience on listing a group whose name indicated members have cross addictions?" The resultant show of hands revealed 54 in favor of listing, 26 opposed, and 55 abstaining. Since G.S.O. policy was involved, formal Conference action was required.

Mail received at G.S.O. about drug problems furnishes another reason for Conference consideration. Our 1977 membership study indicates that 18% of all A.A. members consider themselves as having been addicted to another drug in addition to alcohol. The percentage becomes higher among women A.A. members (28%) and young people (43%), two of the fastest-growing components of our Fellowship.

Some dually addicted members may be causing friction in some traditional groups. Alcoholics with pill problems are urged not

to "talk about that" in meetings. So they are left with a feeling of not belonging.

Would listing these groups allow the dually addicted to "self-select" their meetings and ease some of the reported strain? Would referrals of alcoholics with pill problems be smoothed by having such groups available as a visible entry point into the program?

In an effort to find out "what's happening out there now," we mail-polled intergroups, central offices, and answering services and asked whether they would list such a group at this time. In March, 16 indicated they would; 37 would not.

This dilemma is not new. Both Bill and Dr. Bob shared "sedative" experience in their stories. The earliest correspondence in the archives on "Pills and Our Members" is dated August 24, 1947. Dick B., Washington, D.C., wrote Bill that "some older members, both men and women, who apparently had overcome their desire for alcohol have now turned to drugs, in both pill and liquid form." Dick wondered whether "these people have automatically canceled their status as members of A.A. and have to start all over again." Bill's response, September 4, 1947, acknowledged: "... about pills. Yes, they are a problem. In some places, I understand, a real pill jag is counted like a drinking slip. In most, the thing is more or less ignored."

For 31 years, then, these two positions seem to have remained with us virtually unchanged. It is unlikely that any particular action might wed these positions. We can consider allowing dually addicted people to state their interest in their group's title. Doesn't the group name often capture the spirit, character, and beliefs of its members? Could group autonomy extend to name selection? Would many interests be better served thus?

I believe our polarity on this issue is in part a result of not getting clear on language. Special-purpose groups are not truly that. Their *purpose* is common to all A.A. groups: to stay sober and help others to achieve sobriety. It is their *composition* that is special. And isn't that true in a sense for *every* A.A. group? Whether the group is in a small town or large city, composed of office workers or theater people or newspapermen, the composition of each is determined by self-selection, isn't it?

Frank Mauser, administrative assistant, G.S.O.

Do differences or similarities count more?

Generally, Vermont A.A. members recognize that similarities of members—all members—must be stressed rather than differences, so the attention of the alcoholic is focused on the program of recovery. In fact, Vermont has no "special groups." Younger members also addicted to pills have apparently not felt the need to form such groups or hold special meetings.

What impresses a newcomer about A.A.? In an April 1977 Grapevine article, the author stated, "Variety within a group and variety among groups both struck me vividly as characteristic of A.A., from the moment I was sober enough to collect any impressions." The author made the point that "provided we continually renew our deep identification with one another as survivors of a deadly disease, a group can keep fit for its purpose by cultivating respect for widely differing temperaments and talents, openness toward them, real welcome for them."

The writer did not rule out the value of groups for women, young people, medical profession, and so on, because "they can deal with what might otherwise be neglected needs." There has been marked increase in the percentage of cross-addicted members coming into A.A. Pills are, in too many cases, prescribed by unknowing doctors. An alcoholic patient who switches "from his liquid tranquilizer to a solid tranquilizer . . . isn't receiving any treatment for his basic disease," an A.A. member who is also a physician wrote in a 1974 Grapevine.

"Sponsoring your doctor," suggested at the 1976 Conference, might help the uninformed physician.

It would be well to bear in mind: (1) Our Preamble reminds us we have one primary purpose; (2) the A.A. directories are for sharing A.A. information; (3) cross-addicted members are not discouraged from attending special *meetings*, but there are many advantages to becoming a member of a "regular" group.

Barbara Marsh (Vermont)

Changing patterns call for changing customs

The mere mention of drugs, pills, or chemical dependence can set off a two-hour discussion on what A.A. is and is not, who qualifies for membership, and who is an alcoholic and who is not. Because of people referred to us from treatment centers, we run into this situation frequently in our area. They sometimes come to us with attitudes, impressions, and labels we may not use: "chemical-dependent" or "chemical-addicted." In my experience, this issue is more intellectually appealing to discuss than it is, in fact, a problem in practical terms.

As time goes on, we see different patterns in people coming into A.A. — younger people, more women. Other changes are taking place. A recent study of 1,627 patients discharged from a major treatment facility indicated that 96% of them were alcoholic, but 38% of the men and 49% of the women were also dependent on some other drug. A director of another major treatment facility says the largest group being treated there is the 20-to-29 age group, and "pure alcoholism"—booze only—is virtually nonexistent in that group, almost everyone using some other drugs, too. If this pattern continues, we should not be surprised if this brings about different needs in our meetings.

Our current literature is clear: Dually dependent people are welcome and qualify for A.A. membership if they have a desire to stop drinking. But should alcoholics who also have pill problems have A & P groups? If the members qualify for A.A. and hold meetings for the purpose of sobriety (and abstinence from pills), theirs would be A.A. meetings and should be listed in the directory.

I think there is a place for specialty groups, and they do a lot of good. In my opinion, they are not the best. Our Fellowship and its unity will always be best served by meetings about alcoholism only, with the only requirement for attending that meeting a desire to stop drinking.

But I hope we would not censure a group because of its name. The purpose of an A & P group is to help the still-suffering alcoholic who also has a pill problem. Our own pamphlet "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse" states, "Sincere A.A. members who may be developing a pill or drug problem will do well to

start by seeking out fellow members who have won their own release from drugs as well as from alcohol. In many cases, their advice and encouragement are enough."

Many younger members, both in sobriety and in years, necessarily come to us with the orientation of the facility that referred them to us. This is natural and correct; it is all they know prior to the A.A. experience. After a time, they become seasoned regulars and blend in very well. Many new members know nothing of the Traditions, as many of us did not. Let us not set a standard that we ourselves did not meet. Let us attract them to the unity and singleness of purpose that they see in *our* lives and actions, not in our criticism of *theirs*.

In Toronto in 1965, our co-founder Bill said, "Let us remember the newcomers' individual liberty to believe anything; let us accord respect and love to each of them as they try to make their way to the light; let us always try to be inclusive rather than exclusive."

Robert Bisanz (Southern Minnesota)

One area recommends longer study

We do not have such groups in our area. However, some members in discussion meetings give long pill histories, barely touching on alcohol. Some think that dually addicted members should form such groups; others, that we should stick to our primary purpose. Several of us have found that "Problems Other Than Alcohol," "The A.A. Group," Ask-It Basket questions, and previous Conference Advisory Actions are helpful.

In "Problems Other Than Alcohol," Bill writes: "Now there are certain things that A.A. cannot do for anybody, regardless of what our several desires or sympathies may be. Our first duty, as a society, is to insure our own survival. . . . An A.A. group, as such, cannot take on *all* the personal problems of . . . the whole world. Sobriety—freedom from alcohol—through the teaching and practice of the Twelve Steps is the sole purpose of an A.A. group. Groups have repeatedly tried other activities, and they have always failed. It has also been learned that *there is no possible way to make nonalcoholics into A.A. members*. If we don't stick to these principles, we shall almost surely collapse. And if we collapse, we cannot help anyone."



"The A.A. Group" shows the difference between a group and a meeting. It speaks of dual addiction at the *meeting* level, not in relation to the *group*.

The 1972 Conference moved that dual-addiction groups not be listed in the directories, and that G.S.O. prepare a clear-cut statement on what A.A. is and what it is not. We now have this same question in 1979, so there is a problem. Does listing "alcohol and pills" groups pose a gray area of our Fourth Tradition ("Each group should be autonomous except in matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole")?

I'm sure none of us wishes to deny recovery to anyone with similar problems. But, as Bill said, "Our first duty, as a society, is to insure our own survival."

My area feels more time should be given to observe the effect of this problem on A.A. as a whole before we make any decision on the listing of "alcohol and pills" groups.

Bob Gadoury (Rhode Island)

Floor Action related to the foregoing topic: 1 (p. 45)

The role of the general service trustees and how they are elected

Thursday evening, Conference members gave earnest consideration to differing viewpoints on this topic, and their reactions afterward indicated no trend favoring a change in procedure.

New election procedure suggested

Explaining Concept VI, Bill said, "We shall need to review and perhaps amend . . . methods of choosing trustees. . . . The future may reveal flaws. . . . New conditions may require considerable alterations." For this reason, Bill said, our service charter can be amended by the Conference.

In that spirit, the Arizona assembly passed a resolution recommending that the "election of general service trustees be modified so as to provide for election of all six . . . from the Fellowship of the North American continent as a whole, rather than the present procedure."

This is based on principle, not personalities. We also adopted a resolution expressing confidence in the four present general service trustees. We believe the four "in-town" trustees should be elected from North America by Third Legacy procedures, as the U.S. and Canada trustees-at-large are.

This could be a greater expression of group conscience of the Fellowship. Our first Concept reminds us that: "The final responsibility and the ultimate authority for A.A. world service should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship." Election of these trustees from the entire Fellowship, rather than one particular area, would be in greater accord with this principle. Growth and the danger of our becoming "impersonal" make it all the more important to provide the widest possible participation.

Other developments also indicate this change would be appro-

priate. Presence of paid staff members decreases the need for trustees to act as voluntary office help, so they can carry out their proper functions of policy-making, finance, and personnel decisions, plus others defined by the trustees' bylaws. The original concern of being able to muster the trustees on short notice is alleviated by modes of travel and communication unknown 30 years ago. The Fellowship can afford and is entitled to the broad spectrum of talent in all A.A., otherwise denied the fullest opportunity to be of service.

Bob Morris (Arizona)

'Apply it to yourselves'

For this presentation, I shall rely mostly on "The A.A. Service Manual" and "Twelve Concepts for World Service."

The bylaws of the General Service Board make it clear (manual, p. 92) that all Class B trustees are not alike. They are divided into three categories, with quite different functions. The four general service trustees do not just happen to come from the New York area; they are *specified* to come from the New York area, where G.S.O. and the Grapevine are located, for a particular reason. Through their dual positions as both trustees and directors of the operating boards, they exercise a constant presence in A.A.'s daily operations and even supervision of the paid staffs. Tom Sharpe, past delegate and trustee, says that in his time, they were referred to as the "working trustees."

How are they chosen? The manual (p. 100) says: "The four general service trustees . . . are not elected in the same way as regional trustees. Bill had a sound reason for this, and one that has worked well over the years. These candidates are chosen from among the nontrustee directors of the two corporate boards—A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. They have the time and skills needed for the day-by-day affairs of the two corporate boards and, when elected as trustees, can share with the General Service Board the operations of A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine, thus increasing the awareness of all the trustees on these matters."

The main point follows: "As they are already serving (or have served) on one of the corporate boards, their qualifications are well known to the . . . boards, and it has been the privilege of these boards to propose the name of a candidate to represent them."

Turn this around and apply it to yourselves. You delegates were elected by G.S.R.'s in your area because your "qualifications are well known" to them. Presumably, you were "already serving" on the area committee. What if the Grapevine board came to your assembly and said, "We know better than you who should be delegate. So we passed this resolution that we have the right to elect him." Would your assembly take to this idea?

Members of the A.A.W.S. and GV boards have the right to select who is best qualified to represent *them* on the General Service Board. How can delegates in any area know who is qualified? Are they saying they know more about the two boards' business than the board members do?

In discussing Concept VII, Bill points out that "our present Conference Charter . . . clearly gives the Conference a final and

ultimate authority, but which nevertheless legally preserves the right of the trustees to function freely and adequately, just as any business board of directors must. . . . Experience shows that this balance of powers . . . is thoroughly workable. . . . We believe this balance can be maintained indefinitely because the one [authority] is protected by tradition and the other by law." On p. 37, Bill asks, "How could our trustees function today if they were to become a mere 'committee' or 'department' of the General Service Conference . . . ?"

Is it time now to upset this balance of powers? Apparently, one assembly thinks so. Apparently, one other delegate thinks so. He proposed to change the structure of the Conference, so delegates will have three-fourths of all the votes instead of the present two-thirds. I am saddened by these proposals. Such proposals imply that the delegates need more power. Why? Should they police the trustees and the boards—on the premise, apparently, that delegates have a special monopoly on the best interests of A.A. and that trustees, directors, and staff need to be watched lest they insidiously undermine the Fellowship?

We are all alcoholics, fellow A.A. members together. I fervently believe every one of us *equally* has the interests of our beloved Fellowship at heart.

In Concept VI, Bill says: "Our service charter is capable in most respects of being readily amended by the Conference itself. It ought to be recalled, however, that all of our present arrangements, including the status of A.A.'s trustees, are based on a great amount of experience, which it is the purpose of these writings to describe and make clear. When this is done, we shall not be hampered later on by such a lack of understanding that we could be tempted into hasty or unwise amendments."

Bob Pearson, general manager, G.S.O.

Sponsoring needs of potential members coming to A.A. from treatment facilities

Events having marked effect on local A.A. all over the U.S. and Canada inspired the second presentation/discussion topic on Thursday evening. Ed Small, chairperson of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities, served as moderator.

Area and district efforts bring results

Our area assembly divided our Institutions Committee into two, one on correctional facilities, the other, on treatment facilities. The chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee began working with D.C.M.'s to get a person from each district to serve on the committee.

Clients in a treatment center in my district form dependence on the individuals who contributed to their sobriety. They rely on the alcoholism expertise of those persons, and accept suggestions from them. When A.A. members visit clients undergoing treatment, this alliance can be transferred to the A.A. members. This facilitates the client's introduction to A.A. Treatment facilities in the area cooperate with A.A. groups: Clients are provided transportation to meetings, and A.A. members visit treatment facilities and join in meetings there. Members invite halfway-house residents to join in our noonday "brown-bagger" luncheon A.A. meetings, an excellent way of easing

prospective members into the program. These outings also extend to transportation for shopping trips, job-hunting, and business and social activities.

My district's Treatment Facilities Committee chairperson asked all G.S.R.'s to appoint two people from each group to serve on the committee. The chairperson gave a memorandum to each about what the program entailed, such as: visiting persons in the hospital, clinic, emergency room, detox center, nursing home, or doctor's office; trying to introduce them to A.A. and taking them to meetings; and furnishing temporary sponsors. The chairperson mailed to all doctors, hospital administrators, treatment facility managers, etc., letters describing this committee and its purpose. The appropriate telephone numbers to call for this service were sent to local military base hospitals, Indian hospitals, and the rehab center.

This program has been in effect for only a few months. However, the committee has been contacted by several doctors and centers requesting more information and expressing interest and appreciation.

Thurman Dunn (New Mexico)

Facilities vary—patients have much in common

We must remember the differences among various treatment facilities. Some general hospitals have no special facilities for the alcoholic; normally, our A.A. contact comes through the physician or the family. Some hospitals have a closed, locked psychiatric ward for all types of mental patients, including the alcoholic. Visiting hours are often extremely restricted, admission only by permission of the psychiatrist. Most mental hospitals operate very similarly. Here the importance of our committees on cooperation with the professional community becomes apparent.

Then we have the general hospital with an entire ward devoted to alcoholic treatment. Visits by non-A.A.'s may be restricted, but A.A.'s often may visit at all reasonable hours. Becoming more common are hospitals devoted exclusively to alcoholism treatment. Visits are usually restricted, but rules are bent for A.A.'s. Often, however, the visit must be in a common area, not in patient rooms.

Nursing homes, rest farms, etc., are probably the easiest of all for twelfth-stepping. The rules are few; atmosphere is informal; and A.A.'s generally are welcome.

Rehabilitation centers, etc., are probably midway between the formal institution and the rest farm. There *are* rules and hours of no admission, but the atmosphere is more relaxed than in a hospital.

In all types, A.A. twelfth-steppers are guests and must abide by all rules. Nothing hurts A.A.'s image more than the twelfth-stepper who goes barging in, ignoring rules, personnel, and other patients. The best attitude seems to be a respectful "What may I do to help in your treatment of your patient?"

New people normally come to A.A. with a great deal of misinformation about what A.A. is or isn't. They may know they have a drinking problem, but are not certain they want to stop drinking yet, or completely! They — we — are often under

pressure from home, work, or court. We seldom come voluntarily—in the beginning. In this, we and institutional newcomers are very similar.

What are initial needs? We all need information, empathy, release from pressure, both internal and external, and perhaps most of all, patience, love, and understanding. In any good group, newcomers are made welcome and assigned temporary sponsors to fill these needs. Newcomers may or may not be on medication prescribed by a family doctor. We are told to curb our first impulse, not practice medicine without a license, and concentrate on carrying A.A.'s message.

Are the needs of patients different? I think not. Are there additional needs to be considered? In the case of short-term patients (up to a year or two), no. In the case of longer-term patients, there may be an additional need, that of "deinstitutionalizing." They may have been in an institution so long, they really can't think for themselves. More often than not, they are on medication, Antabuse or otherwise, and are in outpatient therapy or counseling. Here, the patience and understanding of new sponsors may be taxed. I've heard folks say, "I won't talk to you as long as you're on Antabuse!" Some try to be psychiatrist, psychologist, or medicine man.

The poor new people are caught between counselors with whom they have some rapport—and who have recommended A.A.—and some A.A.'s, who now say, "Forget everything they told you; we've got all the answers." We must cooperate and not work at cross purposes with the counselor. Later on, after the new people have started to assimilate and be assimilated by the A.A. program, there is ample time to suggest that A.A. may have answers to their other problems, not just alcoholism.

Buck Bruner (Southern Indiana)

Easing the transition from center to A.A.

Years ago, alcoholics surrendered to their sponsors. There is a great sharing of emotional experience in this moment of birth and hope. At treatment centers built around A.A. principles, patients surrender to the centers. When they are discharged and go to an A.A. meeting, they may or may not feel close to anyone there. The transition can fail if both treatment centers and A.A. do not respect each other and work at transferring this loyalty.

Centers must discourage long-term, total loyalty to themselves. Aftercare groups should be provided, but for only about three months, and requirements for aftercare attendance should be that alcoholics are going to 90 meetings in 90 days. In addition, centers should discourage people by stepping on their fingers if they hang on to the centers too long, and should not give 90-day pins, but should see that this occurs only to a person who has made it in a home group. Earlier, treatment centers should get people to A.A. each evening, encouraging 90 meetings in 90 days and giving them no therapeutic cop-outs from attending A.A.

Where possible, A.A. members should provide meetings in the treatment center and visit patients a week before their discharge. For the transition from treatment center to sponsor, there needs to be a formalized concept developed in A.A.—that of the temporary contact. In New Jersey, 4,000 people a year

are coming out of treatment centers and going to A.A. With these enormous numbers, the old idea of calling up intergroup or picking a sponsor after several weeks simply does not work, in our experience. We have a half-time staff member assigned to obtain temporary sponsors and to see that they are in contact with patients before discharge. Then, we hope, the temporary sponsors will see that the patients are introduced around every night until they get comfortable in meetings.

There is a vast chasm between treatment centers and A.A., into which it is possible for thousands of individuals to drop. Treatment centers have vastly improved in their ability to get individuals committed to the principles of the Twelve Steps and to accepting the need for ongoing help. On A.A.'s part, the role of the temporary contact or temporary sponsor must be thought through and evolved according to the needs of graduates of rehab centers.

*Robert Stuckey, M.D.,
trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities*

Advisory Actions on treatment facilities: p. 49

The Three Legacies—our responsibilities to the future

In harmony with the Conference theme, the final group of presentations, given on Friday afternoon, explored the many aspects of A.A.'s treasured Legacies. All presentations were offered by area delegates; Bill Hopkins (Kansas) moderated.

Recovery

Gratitude helps us stay sober

Recovery is a process, not an event. It is more than not drinking. Certainly, our first step to recovery is the First Step. Since we are powerless over alcohol, what's going to take its place? Given time, our gratitude can keep the cork in the bottle.

In my first six months of A.A. meetings, I sat there very nervous and unrelaxed. Then one night, I noticed there were people in that room other than myself, and the tension left. I believe any time one human being is aware of another, it's a spiritual awakening.

I continue trying to find out what kind of person I am. Ten years ago, nothing was wrong with me except that I drank too much. Even my husband told me that! I am now aware of character defects but have surrendered very few. How can self-pity, anger, and resentment survive when gratitude shows up?

Through recovery, I realized that the person I had harmed most was myself. I am grateful for the A.A. principles I have used to make amends to myself. As a result, amends can be made to others. The Eleventh Step is a reward—we can stop thinking, be conscious of our surroundings, be amused, surprised, or saddened, or just take time for gratitude. Trying to carry out God's will is not easy for me. At times, it causes me discomfort; but the reward is growth, which brings comfort. We land on different plateaus but cannot stay on one too long.

Without honesty, there is no recovery! Today, I am being as

honest as I know how. I will practice the principles of the Steps, using honesty. I renew ability to practice these principles by attending regular A.A. meetings. It is not necessary to get a phone call at three in the morning to carry the message. When I open my mouth (or, at times, shut it!), I carry my message.

“Half measures availed us nothing.” How unsatisfied I am if I do anything halfway. I certainly didn’t drink that way, so why recover that way? We stand at many different turning points during recovery. My first was when elected to service. Not with gratitude did I say yes, but with fear of responsibility. I check the quality of my recovery by my attitude. Why *do* I say yes? (1) I dislike myself for saying no; (2) someone trusts me to get a job done; and (3) I am grateful for A.A.

Nada Butz (North Dakota)

Finding ‘a new dimension’ in the program

My sponsor checked me into a miracle-cure mill, because I was far too important to spend three weeks away from my business. Truth is, neither my family nor my business would have suffered greatly had I been absent for six months. This was the culmination of a seven-year slip after having been sober in A.A. for almost four years. Binges had started for no valid reason, always with certainty that this time would be different. It always was; it was worse. I was in despair, and I hoped only to stay sober enough of the time to feed, clothe, and educate my children.

I returned to A.A. with a vengeance. I swore there would never be a next time. I went to meetings, meetings, meetings. Tucked away in the back of my brain was the horror that it could happen again and probably would. I would rather have been dead. But I desperately needed a new dimension to my program. There was nothing new or exciting about A.A. They still had the same Twelve Steps in the same wrong order. The same drunks were getting up, telling the same stories. I was bored sick, but terrified that I would think my way back into the madhouse I had just clawed my way out of.

One night, a lovely lady A.A. suggested we should elect a G.S.R. I asked, “What does a G.S.R. do?” I was immediately elected by acclamation. Lauretta, my service sponsor (she probably doesn’t know she is), gave me an “A.A. Service Manual” and told me to know what a G.S.R. did before the next assembly.

In service work, I found the dimension that had been missing in my personal program. By giving my time and my dubious talents, I felt for the first time that I was indeed giving as well as receiving. I loved every minute of it then; I love it more now.

As my involvement in service progressed, so did my personal program. I admit that when Lauretta gave me the service manual, I not only read the part about the G.S.R., I went further. And true to form, this egomaniac knew immediately that the service job he really wanted was to be delegate to the Conference. I wasn’t elected by a thumping two-thirds majority on the first ballot. My name came out of the hat. I believe this was God’s way of saying, “Yes, you should be the delegate, but try to do something about your ego.”

I haven’t been sober long enough to become a “bleeding deacon,” but enough to appreciate this wonderful gift and to marvel as I watch recovery unfold in newcomers. To watch despair

disappear from their eyes and be replaced with hope and faith is to witness a miracle.

Bill Killebrew (Tennessee)

‘A constant process of learning’

Until Gabriel blows his horn, I am still a recovering alcoholic. It is difficult for an alcoholic to recover without help. Faith in my Higher Power and the understanding of hundreds of you have made my journey toward recovery pleasant.

One oldtimer who helped me said he had gotten off to a bad start. What he remembered most was the admonition not to take that first drink, so he ordered a double, pushed it aside, and ordered another. Four days later, he came to in Kansas City without the foggiest notion of how he got there. That was his last drunk. From then on, he was a dedicated member.

One day, I asked this oldtimer, “When you go on a Twelfth Step call, how do you know what to say?” His reply was: “I get in a cab, then say a little prayer, ‘Please, God, put some words in my mouth when I get there that might help this guy to want to get sober.’ Whether or not it helps him, I may never know, but it sure helps me to stay sober.”

Another important factor in my recovery was associating with delegates who preceded me. I count them as my personal friends. From their example, I learned about self-respect, tolerance, patience, trust, honesty, humility, gratitude, dedication, and willingness to serve.

Recovery is a constant process of learning about yourself and your disease, and about A.A. and what it can and does do to help you stay sober. I accepted the fact that I am an alcoholic. I can’t change it. So what? I’m lucky. I found what was the matter, and what I could do about it. The great golfer Sam Snead says, “We’re only here a little while. Look around you, take it easy, and don’t forget to smell the flowers.”

Roger Gleason (Nebraska)

Unity

Many Concepts guide us

As newcomers, we first were properly concerned with our personal condition. Growth opportunities came our way, often just when better understanding of ourselves or others was needed. Now, here we are, each with an individual personality, service experience, and a clearing conscience, shaped by preparation for and participation in this Conference.

Who has the vote? “The A.A. Service Manual” notes that “each Conference member has only *one* vote, no matter how many positions he or she may hold on boards or staffs. Historically, voting ratio has never been important . . . along lines of area delegates opposed to other Conference members. But . . . ” (to be safe) “a majority vote of the Conference shall be a *suggestion* to the General Service Board (the trustees), but a two-thirds vote shall be absolutely binding upon the board . . . ”

Who has the voice? As Bill observed in Concept II, “Exactly as



Donna Berkowitz (nonalcoholic), G.S.O. office manager, oversees all behind-the-scenes Conference mechanics, like ordering banners.

THE LEGACIES: OUR HERITAGE AND MY RESPONSIBILITY

Dr. Bob and I earlier had found it necessary to delegate our active authority to the trustees, so have the A.A. groups since found it necessary to delegate these same powers to their General Service Conference . . . a representative cross section of our entire Fellowship."

In "Twelve Concepts," we find: The "Right of Decision" (Concept III) gives service leaders *at all levels* the proper discretion and latitude in performing their tasks; the "Right of Participation" (Concept IV) gives each world servant a voting status commensurate with his or her responsibility; the "Right of Appeal" (Concept V) and "Right of Petition" protect and encourage minority opinions and make certain that grievances can be heard.

Who is in control? Concept XII (Warranties of the Conference) tells us that the "Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition, taking great care that the Conference never becomes the seat of perilous wealth or power; . . . that none of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others; that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; that . . . it [the Conference] shall never perform any acts of government . . ."

Who, then, has the vote, the voice, and the control? The answer is simple: We *all* do in our own time, place, and degree of responsibility.

Bob Tapola (Northwestern Ohio/ Southeastern Michigan)

Progress, rather than perfection

Our Declaration of Unity says: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: to place our common welfare first; to keep our Fellowship united. For on A.A. Unity depend our lives, and the lives of those to come."

I'm going to tell you about A.A. Unity, and sometimes the lack of it, in my own community. My home group came out of *dis-*

unity. A man was causing controversy in a group. Some people felt they could no longer attend a group dominated by him and his particular interpretation of A.A. They reactivated a long-dormant group, and both groups now thrive.

In my group, members in regular attendance include: one former delegate, one current; the local institutions committee chairperson; two former intergroup chairpersons; a former D.C.M.; and two former central office secretaries. We do most things according to Guidelines. But occasionally, we get excited and vote on emotion, rather than information. We use the 60-30-10 Plan. We rotate our G.S.R.'s and intergroup representatives as recommended and allow them time at meetings to make their reports. One thing we do *not* do by the book, but this is a matter of group conscience. Our secretary-treasurer has held that job for seven or eight years. Twice a week, he is there with the door open, literature and hard candy within easy reach, and a smile on his face for every single person who comes through the door to attend "his" group. We know how important this is to his contented sobriety, and he makes good coffee, so everyone is happy!

Our area is plagued by that nemesis, the club. Too often, people come to a group that meets in the club and never know that A.A. doesn't begin and end there. I try to be certain that everyone I speak with is aware that clubs aren't A.A. and vice versa.

We have only two intergroups (central offices). The intergroup and general service structures work together smoothly. One central office secretary is so totally service-oriented that he frequently meshes us when we don't even know we need meshing! Each year, we have a service workshop combined with one of the monthly intergroup dinner meetings. The delegate gives the Conference report at the workshop and speaks at the intergroup meeting. In another city, the intergroup/C.O. serves two districts. I have not personally observed its workings, but minutes of its monthly meetings show intergroup and general service representatives working closely together.

The area has groups with no G.S.R.'s, districts with no committee members, and clubs whose members isolate themselves and their groups from one another. On the other hand, we are blessed with interested, intelligent, and hardworking people who are dedicated to the proposition that, in sobriety and service, "I can't, but we can."

To sum up A.A. Unity in my area in one word, it would have to be "normal." For people who spent a good portion of their lives involved in some *abnormal* behavior, that just may be the nicest word we could ask for!

Jan Williamson (Northwestern Texas)

Unity at all levels and among all levels

Though many of us have to struggle for recovery, A.A.—by the grace of God and the wisdom of those before us—has never yet had to struggle for lost unity. We take this great gift for granted. But in the early days, the great dread of our founders was: "Can we recovered alcoholics hold together?"

I believe you agree the small amount of friction here indicates that our unity is in good shape. The friction of opposing views is exactly how democracy operates. However, on the front line,

in our groups, where we are always pioneering, the Legacy of Unity should be our conscious thought at all times. We get so involved in the struggle for Recovery, we tend to overlook Unity and Service. But the fact is, the Recovery in any area is in direct proportion to the Unity and Service in that area. When we look for the protection of Unity, we look at the Traditions. Just like the Steps, they point to personal defects as the greatest danger to Unity.

To effect the Recovery of millions, we must have Unity at the group level, where it all begins. It must exist between groups and districts, districts and area, and areas and G.S.O. All members must be heard, just as they are in this Conference. We must strive for great liaison between G.S.O., where the heart of A.A. beats, and all the smaller groups. This means sacrifice and Service, the result of which is Unity—the end result of which is Recovery.

Lloyd King (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island)

Service

What about those beribboned badges?

I think one of the most important tools we have at large A.A. gatherings is name badges. I remember faces, but not names. I never heard of Dr. Bob's or Bill's appearing with the title "co-founder" on their badges. But at many conventions, I see badges with ribbons attached saying "delegate," "past delegate," "trustee," "area chairperson," etc. Ribbons designating hospitality or convention committee are helpful. But when we in service wear these ribbons, aren't we saying that we are just a little bit above those not involved in general service work? Does this sound like the action of a humble servant? Like "principles before personalities"?

This Fellowship saved my life. Most people agree A.A. has reached a position where we need not fear outside forces. If A.A. should ever be destroyed, that destruction will come from within. One of the ways this could start is for us to develop a class system. Whether serving as trustee, delegate, or G.S.R., answering the telephone, carrying the message into institutions, working on a convention committee, serving a group as program chairperson, or making the coffee, each is fulfilling our primary purpose—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. There is no such thing as "the most important job in A.A."

Down home, we have an expression that 90% in A.A. are willing—willing to sit back and let the other 10% do the work. Many say they do not want to get involved in service, because it is political. Political entities do have a class system; there are the elite and those whose jobs are not so elite. We in general service should constantly be alert that we not appear to be just a little bit better than the average member. We do not need to create resentments or jealousies. It is hard enough to get new people involved in service.

My egotism is sometimes evident, so I always try to remember two stories in the "Twelve and Twelve." One, in the Second Tradition, defines the "elder statesman" and the "bleeding deacon." The other, in the Fourth Tradition, tells me, "Don't take yourself too damn seriously."

What I am trying to say was best said by Bill about the Twelfth Tradition: "Moved by the spirit of anonymity, we try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members both among fellow alcoholics and before the general public. As we lay aside these very human aspirations, we believe that each of us takes part in the weaving of a protective mantle which covers our whole Society and under which we may work and grow in unity.

"We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have."

Bill Geoghan (Delaware)

'Opportunity without parallel'

I want to explore with you what service work does to and for the individual. No worthy service goes unrewarded. Recognition may come in many forms, directly and indirectly. In the work world, service well rendered is compensated with increased profits. Airlines may offer firmer schedules, courteous personnel, etc., which bring greater patronage and revenues. Recognition is a prize sought by the military person, the philanthropist, or someone involved in community activities. Psychological reward is that which a physician might feel after perfecting a new surgical technique. Perhaps those supporting a cause feel rewarded when converts enroll.

Our service structure allows every person, regardless of social or financial status, color, educational background, or creed, the privilege of serving. But many in A.A. lack an awareness of the benefits derived from fulfilling a service role. Everyone yearns to be appreciated. A.A. sends out the message that Service is indeed appreciated. In A.A. Service, we share in a vibrant, growing entity. We experience a warm feeling knowing that we made a contribution.

It has been said, "Until we develop both the capacity and the desire to serve others, we will never know true happiness." While working in this framework, we begin to capture happiness, serenity, and self-esteem. It is well to reflect on the awesomeness of our privilege. Because we never see the results of some of our work, it is difficult for us to grasp the scope and magnitude of contributions made.

Service in A.A. is opportunity without parallel. Nowhere else on earth will you find rewards so great and effort so enjoyable. The vehicle for action is here. All that is needed is a desire and will to act.

Ken Savaloja (Oregon)

'We blend all Three Legacies together'

There is a lot more to A.A. than just staying sober. One thing is Service—making coffee, setting up tables, cleaning up, and washing dishes. Twelfth Step work and cooperation with your G.S.R., D.C.M., and area officers are also services.

At our area conference, I was the only one there from my group. So I became G.S.R. The D.C.M., I was told, was to go to groups in the district before and after each area conference. We never saw ours. Opening my big mouth, I got the job of D.C.M. If

you do this job, people will get mad at you. I went to meetings and suggested and suggested, even beat the table a few times.

Two years as alternate delegate were years of learning about Service. I am a grateful and humble delegate. It is a demanding but rewarding job. Work makes A.A. grow. That's Service.

One of the best things past delegates can do is continue to go to area and regional functions. And they can take new people to service meetings. We also need Grapevine chairpersons and trustees. We need past delegates' attendance at their own groups—even washing dishes.

Let's not deny our experience as alcoholics. Let's carry our experience and the spirit of A.A. into all our affairs. Let's give of ourselves.

A.A.'s services are designed to do Twelfth Step work and so to insure our lives and growth. Without Service, A.A. will die and so will we.

Some still ask: What is this Third Legacy, anyway? When we spend time and money and ourselves to spread A.A. to the still-suffering alcoholic, we blend all Three Legacies together for the good of us all.

Gene Loomis (Northern Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan)

Workshops gauge the climate within A.A.

Two broad topics vital to A.A. were taken up on Tuesday and Thursday in workshops, for which the body of Conference members was divided into ten small discussion units. Summaries of all sections' deliberations were later reported back to the entire Conference.

Communications within the A.A. Fellowship

There was general agreement that A.A. groups could improve communications with G.S.O.; but G.S.O. communication with groups was praised—especially the new G.S.R. Kits and the filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service." Use of group service numbers and P.O. boxes was especially recommended.

Local communication among groups was reported to be pretty good, especially in rural areas, where no one can pass the buck to a central office for such contacts.

About three-fourths of the delegates have found area and local newsletters good communications tools, they said.

The importance of the district committee member's function was repeatedly mentioned, as were district meetings for general service representatives (G.S.R.'s). Rotation makes vital the continual education of new Third Legacy workers in workshops, sharing sessions, assemblies, and Regional Forums, it was noted. The value of well-planned agendas and of the Grapevine as a communications medium was also stressed.

A pervasive problem is that of groups which do not hear G.S.R. reports, members agreed. The need for more widespread appreciation of A.A.'s Third Legacy was frequently brought up, and

more use of "service sponsors" and the leaflet "Circles of Love and Service" was suggested.

All agreed *Box 4-5-9* is an important A.A. communications tool, and bulk subscriptions and discussion of *Box 4-5-9* articles at A.A. meetings were strongly suggested.

The "60-30-10" leaflet from G.S.O. actually favors central offices (C.O.'s), it was pointed out. Smoother relationship between C.O.'s and area committees are developing in many places, especially where the two units decide to share such activities as work on public information or cooperation with the professional community, many delegates said.

Advisory Actions related to foregoing topic: 21-24 (p. 47)

Group autonomy and A.A. unity

In all workshops, members agreed there is a trend toward diversification of groups, such as young people's and women's, and there are possibilities of both benefit and harm from this development.

Most sections found it difficult to strike a balance between group autonomy and "matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole." Recommended were group inventory, study of Traditions, and effort to make A.A. look attractive.

Holding group business meetings attended by all interested members was suggested, rather than leaving decisions to a steering committee. Keeping members informed and allowing time for a consensus to develop can help, it was said.

One section said that supporting all A.A. services in an area is an indication of A.A. unity. "Principles before personalities" and concentration on our primary purpose also contribute to unity, several suggested.

About autonomy, it was agreed that place, length, and format of a meeting are up to a group. "Freedom from restraint should be recognized for all groups," one section said. Recommended were use of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and reference to past Conference actions.

General group problems were also discussed. In one section, it was reported that poor communications have resulted in poor handling of the influx of new prospects from treatment centers; but in most areas, such referrals are now working fairly smoothly. Groups in one area send cards to facilities inviting patients to attend meetings; in another, entire groups visit facilities. Facilities are given information about various meetings to which prospects can be sent, and inpatients are visited before discharge, several area delegates said. The use of the term "interim contact" (instead of "temporary sponsor") has helped in one place, one delegate said.

There was unanimous agreement that such patients should be made to feel as welcome to A.A. as any other newcomers. (See presentations on this topic, p. 20.)

Floor Action related to foregoing topic: 1 (p. 45)

Advisory Actions: 12, 13 (p. 46), 20 (p. 47), 64 (p. 49)

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alabama/Northwestern Florida: We have 147 groups and 17 districts. By following the guidelines in "The A.A. Service Manual," our assembly has grown from a one-day service meeting to an entire service weekend. Attendance at our area convention doubled last year. Our Institutions, P.I., C.P.C., and Grapevine Committees carry the message—within the Traditions—to local, state, and Federal correctional institutions, hospitals, mental health facilities, schools, churches, radio, TV, and newspapers. We are working on making A.A. meetings available to deaf alcoholics.—*Mickey Boynton*

Arkansas: (1) We started two-day assemblies at a hotel with meeting rooms, restaurant, and sleeping facilities all under the same roof. (2) Using Third Legacy concepts, we have developed area guidelines for our service work. (3) We follow Third Legacy procedure in elections. (4) Our alternate delegate and co-chairperson have specific assembly duties. (5) Our Ask-It Basket panel includes delegate, alternate, and past delegates. (6) We allow time for each D.C.M. and committee chairperson to report. (7) We have a budget for all committees, the assembly, and the delegate.—*Wayne Parks*

British Columbia/Yukon: In our area, C.P.C. and service involvement have improved lately. C.P.C., in cooperation with the Drug and Alcohol Commission, will now have A.A. members at a weekly meeting held by a clinic staff physician. The commission's drop-in centers have A.A. materials. After counseling, clients are encouraged to have eyeball-to-eyeball discussion with A.A.'s. Because of our size, communication is our biggest headache, but service workshops, mini-assemblies, and G.S.R. meetings help. Over 100 attended a recent mini-assembly, and that many were also at a local G.S.R. meeting. This year, International Young People meets in Vancouver.—*Jack Ford*

California (Northern Coastal): We have never had before so many groups participating in service. We reach approximately 950 groups every month by mail. In the last two years, donations to area service have doubled. Many districts hold mini-conferences for discussing the year's Conference agenda topics. Some of our hopes revolve around our P.I. and C.P.C. committees. Recently, we provided a substantial amount of literature to the Northern California Library Association, for distribution.—*Lois M. Jacobson*

California (Southern): One of the first Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S. was Latino Americano of Los Angeles, started in February 1947. Pioneers of Hispanic groups in our area probably thought general service was not for them. Responsible members finally sent a Spanish-speaking liaison to the assembly in 1973. We had 20 Spanish-speaking groups in Los Angeles. Everything went fine until 1976, when, of 40 groups, only a couple had G.S.R.'s. In 1978, they petitioned to split into two districts. Approved by our assembly, this new, Spanish-speaking district began to have weekly meetings attended by 20 or more G.S.R.'s. They now hold weekly district meetings!—*Lucetta De Young*

Colorado: An entirely new state committee was elected at our November 1978 conference. We also have new committee chairpersons for public information, hospital, correctional institutions, and C.P.C. We recently appointed a special state Grapevine chairperson. Redistricting of our area is constantly being considered, as we continue to grow. Our last state convention had over 1,000 in attendance. Participation in institutions work is on the rise. Temporary sponsorship is beginning to

work, and we provide tape recorders and tapes for use by inmates. Issues requiring attention: individual sponsorship, more involvement in service at all levels.—*Dave Buckley*

Connecticut: Growth has caused two problems in our area: (1) lack of information on current status of groups; and (2) inability to communicate effectively through the service structure. We have nine districts with 75 to 100-plus groups each. To help alleviate these problems, we have developed the information/communication committee. The district version of this committee will send new group information and group changes to G.S.O., maintain group information records at the district level, send group information to the area committee, and distribute area meeting schedules once a year. The area committee will maintain records of information sent from districts and be responsible for new addressing equipment and coordinating with district committees.—*John A. Callaghan*

District of Columbia: Last November, it was obvious that redistricting was needed. The alignment of groups within U.S. Postal Service ZIP Code areas was the technique used. In February, we helped our intergroup with its first planning conference. In March, a Group Program Chairpersons Exchange Committee meeting had a very good turnout, and our Sixth Annual G.S.A. Mini-Conference was held. Every past delegate and chairperson in town took part. Six past delegates chaired panels. We have such cooperation with our intergroup association that it is impossible to tell who covered what schools, health fairs, medical conventions, radio or TV programs, and forums without digging into records.—*James J. Cooney Jr.*

Florida (Northern): We have four assemblies a year, and 16 districts serve approximately 200 groups. I believe we are in the top 10% of groups in number of GvRs. The 10- and 20-second TV film spots now distributed nationally originated in our area in 1976-77. We also tried communication with doctors. We got a three-percent return on mail-outs. Our P.I. and Institutions Committees are very active. We have just started a Committee on the Handicapped.—*Lou Mobley*

Florida (Southern): We have one election assembly every two years. Two meetings held just prior to the Conference give G.S.R.'s an opportunity to vote on issues to be discussed in New York. District reports are sent out to every area. Many districts hold district forums, one-day affairs akin to Regional Forums. We hold a gratitude dinner each November, sponsored by A.A. members, as individuals, at \$3.50 to \$4.00 a ticket. The dinner's proceeds are sent to G.S.O. — *Chico Cortez*

Hawaii: In 1955, we had two groups. Membership was then about 30. In 1975, we really got involved in the A.A. service structure. Our hospital and institutions committees are doing an excellent job. Public information has been good. Our Grapevine chairperson and his assistants have increased subscriptions tenfold. My goals for this year are: (1) stressing the importance of qualified G.S.R.'s; (2) having them listed at G.S.O.; (3) contributing surplus funds to an intergroup, G.S.O., and the area committee; and (4) including outer-island groups in our area structure. Hawaii now has more than 100 groups and well over 1,000 members. — *Herb Weatherwax*

Illinois (Chicago): The D.C.M. and area chairperson were called to a meeting by our central office manager, to improve communications. Since I would be attending as an alternate D.C.M., I reread Chapter III of "The A.A. Service Manual" and, at the

meeting, made several references to suggested duties of the D.C.M. Local service arouses interest in general service, and that causes involvement in local service. Chicago hosted the state conference in conjunction with our regional conference. The majority of the 1,700 that attended were from our area.
— *Tom Devereux*

Illinois (Southern): I was elected a group treasurer in 1968 and held that position through 1972. Also, in 1968, I was elected G.S.R. for that same group. Shortly after, I was elected D.C.M. In 1975, I was elected area chairperson for two years. During 1977 and 1978, I was alternate delegate. Effective January 1, 1979, I became delegate. — *Hershell Hood*

Indiana (Northern): We cooperate with several facilities to bring people to A.A. Meetings are held in a local hospital, and patients are transported every night to outside meetings. A meeting is also held in a detoxification unit, to help those picked up by police. Individuals taken to this unit are given a choice between jail and the detox. We have a meeting in the local veterans hospital. We get a lot of teenagers and other young people who feel they cannot identify with older members. We plan to start a teenagers meeting. — *Louise Holsten*

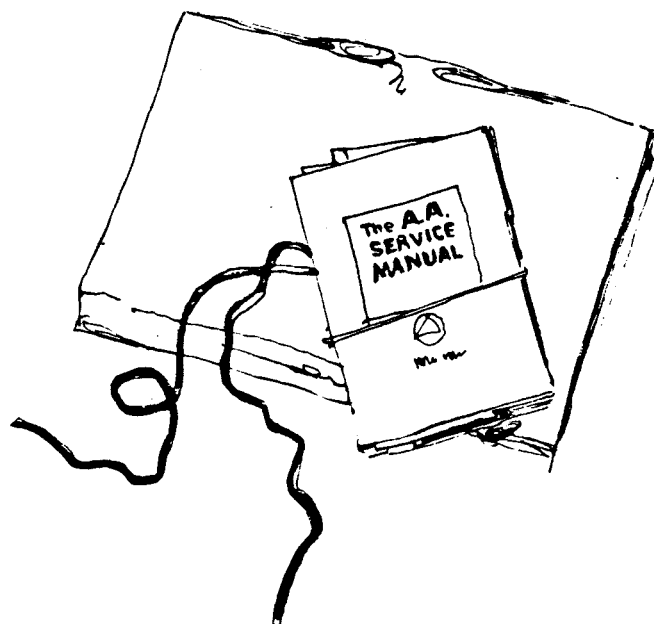
Iowa: We had about 240 groups at year's end, an increase of 186 since 1976. Enthusiasm was instilled by our new P.I.-C.P.C. chairperson, with each district electing a P.I. chairperson and meeting periodically. Increased attendance of D.C.M.'s, alternates, and G.S.R.'s at assembly meetings is encouraging. More women are getting into service. We've had participation from our regional trustee. For not-so-good news: We have met some resistance from correctional facilities regarding outside A.A. members' going to meetings at the facilities. We have drug abusers who are not alcoholics attending closed meetings. We need more Traditions and Third Legacy meetings. — *Dan Byrne*

Louisiana: We now have 193 registered groups, and expect, by 1980, to have over 200 (and about 3,000 members). Since 1970, part of the state has grown from four or five groups, which didn't communicate with one another, to more than 40 groups. Assembly meetings are growing, too. Not one fistfight has taken place in the last four elections. (This is a record.) Our past delegate and chairperson were approached by the state substance-abuse director. People from that department wanted to sit in on our next workshop so they could use some of our program in their intermediate-care centers, and they asked us to participate. We are happy to be hosting the 1980 International Convention. — *Bill Geer*

Massachusetts (Eastern): When I first became involved in service, one of our major concerns was lack of communication between our area committee and the central office. We now have joint committees for public information, institutions, and C.P.C.; central office liaison with the area committee; and an area report at the C.O. meeting. Another concern was lack of G.S.R.'s, so we developed service seminars in the districts for anyone interested. Four formerly inactive districts now hold meetings and send D.C.M.'s to the area committee. Group contributions have picked up. We have started a quarterly newsletter. — *Glenice Sheehan*

Michigan (Central): We have concentrated on P.I., C.P.C., and institutions work this year. Three tapes of the Big Book are used by the Institutions Committee. Area workshops are conducted on Traditions and Concepts. Detroit will host a Region-

al Forum this year. Some of our members are very involved in International Doctors in A.A. We cooperate with treatment centers for dual addiction. Instead of holding conventions in expensive hotels, we now use facilities of community colleges and state-university branches. — *Ken Himes*



Michigan (Southeastern): Our ultimate service highlight will be our second Regional Forum, next month. We held our second delegates' and past delegates' meeting in 1975; it is now an annual event. We are proud of our quarterly state committee meeting in Lansing. For over 20 years, the general service personnel of all three Michigan areas has met every three months. In Detroit, we conduct school talks and work with correctional institutions. We have also presented a "comedy" about the Twelve Traditions 81 times. — *Ken Winegarner*

Minnesota (Southern): We are the 19th most-populated state, but have the fourth-largest A.A. population in the U.S. and Canada. Referrals from treatment (2,500 beds in the state for treatment of alcoholism) account for many new members. Good sponsorship and receptive A.A. groups account for keeping them. Interaction between A.A. and treatment has caused us to look closely at our Traditions and our primary purpose. Knowledgeable A.A. service people are more necessary than ever. — *Bob Bisanz*

Missouri (Eastern): A.A. service has contributed as much to my sobriety as the recovery part of our program. My area has experienced much growth. In public information, progress is being made. For example, during an alkathon New Year's Eve, the news media gave their support, with full cooperation on anonymity. A workshop in one medium-security prison, with the cooperation of officials and Al-Anon members, is now an ongoing project. One of our main concerns is how to give the minority a right to their say. — *Elma F. Stone*

Missouri (Western): The functioning of districts and D.C.M.'s is improving, and we are pleased with how much has been accomplished; but we have a long way to go. We hope to improve

communications throughout the area, and are striving to promote more unity and love. We are stressing the importance of studying "The A.A. Service Manual," for older as well as new members. — *George Van Dyke*

Nevada: Our main population centers, Reno and Las Vegas, are 450 miles apart, but A.A. groups are multiplying. Rural districts cover hundreds of miles, and D.C.M.'s keep in touch with groups by phone and letter. The alternate delegate has started a state service newsletter. We plan to start an area committee and D.C.M. sharing session once a year, changing the site periodically, so all have a chance to attend. Reno A.A.'s hosted the 12th annual Pacific Region Service Assembly. — *Ruth Jagodzinski*

New Jersey (Northern): We have over 600 groups. When I became G.S.R., I found the concept of a strong D.C.M. was forgotten. In June, the chairperson appointed a committee to make recommendations to the assembly on ways to return to the structure suggested in the service manual. I presented to the assembly a list, broken down by county, of groups recorded by our intergroup. A committee will divide the list so each district has the number of groups that could be comfortably covered by a D.C.M. Through our intergroup office, we were able to update group information. — *Herman H. Halm Jr.*

New York (Central): The agenda at our G.S.R. workshop, preceding the assembly, includes: structure, purpose of the G.S.R., making our reports to the group interesting, services available to G.S.R.'s, dealing with group problems, the filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service," and the Twelve Concepts. Very valuable group input is involved in these sessions. At Colgate Rochester Divinity School, each student in one course is taken to A.A. meetings by an A.A. "sponsor." High schools have often asked A.A.'s to talk to health classes. We have GvRs and a literature chairperson. — *Judd Black*

New York (Southeastern): Circulars and invitations to attend a Manhattan service meeting were sent out to G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and any interested members in January. About 100 members attended. The filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service" was shown. A short talk was given by a past delegate; then there were questions and answers. Other discussion focused on responsibilities of G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s and their importance to the group. If we put some effort into service meetings, we will reach the members. — *Jo Kugel*

North Carolina: Assemblies are held regularly, with workshops and sharing sessions, putting emphasis on "The Group—Where It Begins" and "The Traditions — Why It Works." Assemblies now include P.I. sessions, separate but at the same time and location. A Big Book has been placed in each public library, and a "when and where card" in doctors' offices, churches, police stations, and sheriffs' departments. A state GV chairperson has become active. — *W. Neil Dobbins*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Newfoundland is an island with a population of 500,000; to and from Labrador, the only means of transportation is by air; and Nova Scotia is separated from the rest of our area by 100 miles of water. But our annual conferences are well attended. Our trusted servants are active in carrying the message to isolated areas, and public information and institutions work are well looked after. While some of our contributions are not up to par, it is our hope that, as we grow, things will fall into place. — *Leo Kelly*

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): Early in my sobriety, our *Central Office Newsletter* said a woman from "the New York office" was going to tell her story. Impressed by the big picture of A.A. and grateful that I had a role in it, I wanted to learn all I could about service. Two years later, the state conference was held in our city, and Bob Hitchins of G.S.O. gave a very informative talk on service structure, stressing the importance of our Traditions and the Twelve Concepts. We are now redistricting. We have good standing committees, and Grapevine subscriptions have increased greatly. At group meetings and anniversaries, I mention that service work is a big factor in my recovery. — *Anna M. Diggs*

Ohio (Northeastern): When I received help, I was (and am) grateful. It was suggested that I show my gratitude rather than talk about it. I worked in the kitchen and as treasurer, chairperson, and lead. I started a women's group, talked at schools and churches, was a regular speaker at a psychiatric hospital, helped set up a women's volunteer program in the alcoholic unit of a hospital. I was a G.S.R., D.C.M., area secretary, alternate, and chairperson. As delegate, I am getting experience in institutions work. An informed group conscience is aided by our annual mini-conference. — *Terry Leach*

Oklahoma: My area sponsors and funds committees for treatment and correctional facilities, public information, workshops, Grapevine, policy and procedure, and an annual conference. We take meetings weekly to three state mental hospitals, and every state correctional institution. We "sponsor" students from the University of Oklahoma Medical School. We take them to open meetings and supply them with A.A. literature. We hope that when they become doctors and contact problem drinkers, they will refer these patients to A.A. instead of reaching for the prescription pad. We bought 600 Big Books and 50 "Twelve and Twelves" for libraries, schools, and police stations throughout the state. — *LeRoy Belt*

Ontario (Eastern): We formed an area committee at our assembly in October 1977. Eastern Ontario is large, encompassing 8,000 square miles and 350 groups with 7,000 members. For many years, this area consisted of ten districts. Seven of these have divided. I anticipate about 25 districts before this year is out. I have seen our groups and districts more than double. It gives me a great feeling of gratitude and serenity to have been a small part of this. Many more doors of meeting halls have been opened, and many more chairs will be made available for the suffering alcoholic. — *Wilf O'Grady*

Ontario (Northeastern): Six districts, containing 132 groups, make up my area. Each holds an annual convention. Because of growing interest in service, a one-day workshop will precede each assembly, beginning in September. Participants have been offered billeting with members in the host city. In one district, groups take turns sending members, at group expense, 200 miles to carry the message to inmates. Six have started an ex-inmates' A.A. group. An A.A. sits in on each impaired drivers' course (mandatory for those convicted three times of driving while intoxicated). Past offenders lend their assistance. I am the first female delegate in this area. — *Tina Martin*

Ontario (Northwestern): It is gratifying to see new groups flowering in some of our out-of-the-way northern communities. Our assembly has grown so large that we have set aside a separate weekend for it. More people have joined us than we ever dreamed. We have coordinators of public information and insti-

tutions. This year, with our fall assembly, we are having a service workshop. I am chairing our industrial luncheon this year. Members invite people from industry who are concerned with alcoholism. We usually get a good turnout. — *Al Hurley*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Our area held its first three assemblies in 1978, located to be convenient for the maximum number of G.S.R.'s. Some 315 G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, state officers, and members were in attendance. We learned we had numberless G.S.R.'s very well-informed about A.A. structure. Workshops were informational, on the importance of an informed group conscience, problems other than alcohol, Traditions, etc. Everyone went home enlightened. — *Ambrose Mohan*

Pennsylvania (Western): Many new groups are starting in our area, and attendance at older groups is doubling. Since the new member cannot be easily identified in large groups, we may be losing people we should be helping. We are blessed with dedicated G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and committee officers. There are, however, weaknesses: An active D.C.M. may have only one or two groups with any interest in general service, or active groups may have a lethargic D.C.M. We believe the answer lies with the groups. We try to carry the service message through the film-strip "Circles of Love and Service." — *Ian McKenzie*

Quebec (Northeastern): We have 210 groups, eight of them English-speaking or bilingual, the other 202 French-speaking. Area meetings have outstanding attendance, although some G.S.R.'s have to travel 600 miles. The Twelfth Step and public information committees are decentralized. An annual, three-day convention draws 3,500 people. Three district (two-day) gatherings also get a good turnout. Regional bulletins were published in 1978, but failed to be of any help to G.S.R.'s. Our number of groups grew by five percent, but attendance at meetings increased most notably among women and young people. — *Louis Ladouceur*

Quebec (Southeastern): Two months after I joined A.A., my sponsor got me into service. I felt excited until I asked what a steering committee was, and what I was to do. Nobody really seemed to know. We have 150 groups in 11 districts. Most groups hold a monthly business meeting, and more and more members are acquainted with the Third Legacy. Most districts also hold monthly meetings. We have four area committee meetings, one gratitude dinner, and one assembly per year. We held a seminar on public information, and results were excellent. We will start an information program for G.S.R.'s. — *Laurent Biron*

Texas (Northeastern): In Texas, distance must always be considered when anything is planned. Area meetings may be 300 to 400 miles away. Because of traveling expenses, D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s were hard-pressed to attend. Many times, qualified members were financially unable to make these trips. We decided to meet in a central location. Attendance increased. We now have an Institutions Committee, and a C.P.C. chairperson was elected in Dallas. Our biggest concerns are getting group officers active in their district and instituting regular election of officers to serve two years, as suggested in "The A.A. Service Manual." — *Hank Coleman*

Texas (Southeastern): I have seen A.A. grow from a small number of groups in 1954 to thousands today. In the fifties, if 12 or 15 G.S.R.'s came to elections, we were thrilled. We now have 150 or more. Of our nine districts, three sponsor monthly round robins. District meetings hear the delegate's report, and

a monthly sharing session for G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s is popular. Our intergroup office is managed by elected trustees, following the Traditions. Intergroup has such committees as hospitals (25 programs); correctional institutions (21 units, a prison farm, and local jails); court programs; rehab and detox (13 centers); and public communication. — *Dick White*

Utah: We have about 110 groups, with a membership of over 1,200, eight districts with one D.C.M. each, plus an additional D.C.M. for each multiple of ten groups. Our structure adheres very closely to that suggested in "The A.A. Service Manual." The committee meets at least ten times per year, rotating sites. We have spring and fall assemblies, a service conference, a summer outing, and an area anniversary party. Each of our two metropolitan districts has a central office. We hold an open A.A. meeting at the University of Utah Summer School on Alcoholism. — *Frank Buffo*

Virginia: Our immediate past delegate organized the area into seven sections, easy for G.S.R.'s to reach. He announced the dates when he would report on the Conference. He sent me, as alternate, copies of everything! We used forum-style workshops for assemblies, including Conference agenda topics. We are completing a campaign to have Big Books in every library in the state. We distribute a folder to doctors, members of the clergy, law-enforcement officers, and rehab centers. Rural areas find it even more popular than city groups. We introduce intergroups to "A.A. at a Glance" in large quantities for their public affairs speakers. Among our worries is whether to continue free-registration conventions. We have growing awareness of Conference-approved literature, and the importance of not confusing it with other publications. — *Chuck Roberts*

Washington: Our area is divided by the Cascade Mountains, but they are a backyard fence when East meets West for Third Legacy work. Last year, at our annual assembly, we had 318 voting G.S.R.'s from 432 groups. I feel this is a direct result of our "little assemblies" — service gatherings for neighboring districts. Usually, a full day of panels, presentations, and Ask-It Basket time is topped off with a potluck supper and evening meeting. New members are exposed to local service while enjoying fellowship with neighboring groups. Presented in this manner, the service message shows many that service is an available privilege. — *Terry Schemel*

West Virginia: We have ten districts, aligned geographically because of our mountainous terrain. Our greatest problem is communication. Groups either do not want to give G.S.R.'s time to report, or deal exclusively with recovery and tend to ignore service. We have not shown a marked increase in groups or membership in the past few years because, in the past, membership figures were inflated. Members were counted at every meeting they attend, and some groups, with the same members, were listed as two different groups. — *Al Farley*

Wisconsin (Southern): I was sober one year when the delegate, who was from my group, suggested I be elected secretary-treasurer. Two years later, I was G.S.R., then D.C.M. We set up a regular monthly G.S.R. meeting for the district, with presentation by the host group on one of the Twelve Concepts. Any A.A. member was encouraged to attend. I believe communications between districts and groups are very important, so word will get around on how other A.A.'s stay sober, twelfth-step, sponsor, help groups in hospitals and institutions, and cooperate with treatment centers and professionals. — *Mike Kelly*

Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board,

General Service Board

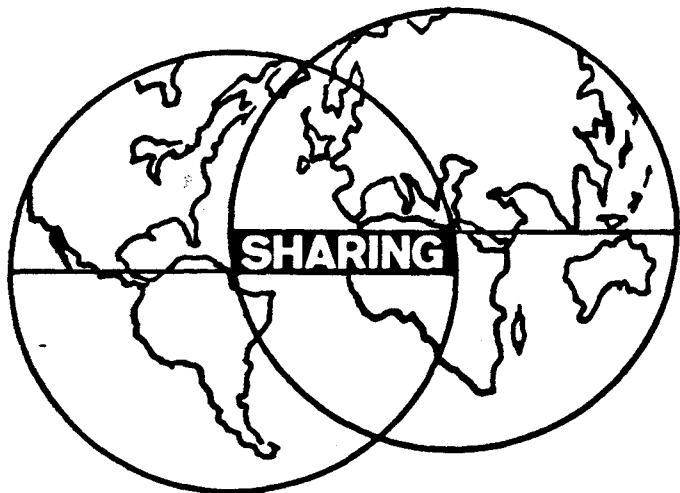
1,600 new groups, 2,000,000 Big Books

Trustees' report: The number of A.A. groups grew by 1,654 in 1978. Sales of Conference-approved literature are going off the charts! After reaching an all-time high in 1978, sales in January 1979 jumped 30% over January of 1978. Big Book distribution passed the two-million mark last October, and could reach three million by late 1981. We don't play the "numbers game" in Alcoholics Anonymous, but these figures indicate the health and vigor of the Fellowship.

I have found my first year stimulating, rewarding, even enjoyable. I have greater appreciation than ever for our remarkable Traditions and service structure. They stand in striking contrast to the operations of most organizations and give A.A. unusual assets for keeping on course in the future.

The board met Saturday afternoon after the 1978 Conference and held long weekend meetings in July, October, and January. These begin with Saturday committee sessions, continue all day Sunday, and climax with the formal board meeting from 9:00 to 12:00 Monday. At dinner Sunday evenings, attended only by trustees, no business is conducted; but for several hours, there is informal sharing about current A.A. concerns and long-term trends and considerations.

Increased participation in the General Service Sharing Session has also pleased me. It is attended by trustees, members of the staffs and boards of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, and some nontrustee committee members. In each of these "town meetings," we focus on a single topic, with input from everyone present. Out of two sessions came reactivation of the International Committee, now a regular trustees' committee. This is timely and important. The Fifth World Service Meeting (W.S.M.) made it clear that A.A. benefits greatly from the shared experience and global perspective gained at such gatherings. The International Committee can extend this benefit to countries which cannot afford to send a delegate to the W.S.M. or do not yet have any service structure.



I participated in the Pacific, Northeast, and West Central Regional Forums, and had the pleasure of meeting many of you

personally at these. The Forums bring all of us trusted servants closer together. They build trust.

It is the aim of the Conference that G.S.O. become self-supporting through group contributions (Seventh Tradition), so the office can become less reliant on income from literature. As this occurs, the cost of A.A. literature can be reduced. Progress is being made. Group contributions picked up in the last half of the year and are running ahead of the same period in 1978. The number of contributions is also growing. Our trustee-at-large from Canada often stresses the benefit to groups and members of greater participation in A.A. affairs. Contributing to A.A. as a whole is basic to this greater participation. G.S.O. is about to begin acknowledging group contributions individually when they are received.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., chairperson

A.A.W.S.

Carrying the message in print at record high

Directors' report: In 1978, the distribution of books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items reached 5,927,800 units. Free literature sent to service groups and to inform the general public about A.A. amounted to 693,000 pieces—inventory value, \$36,700.

Publishing, Reserve Fund: See Finance report, p. 33.

Steps and Traditions wall displays: Window-shade displays were made available at \$20 each, \$35 a set.

Australia: Affairs regarding their publishing problems were not resolved by January 1979, the deadline given by this board. So a letter went to the New South Wales General Service Council informing it the board withdraws permission to reprint A.A. literature, effective April 1, 1979.

Saturday Evening Post: We did not accept its proposal that we pay a professional writer to do an article on A.A., which it would publish.

Taping: To give us better control of our literature being taped and sold elsewhere, we will consider providing tapes ourselves on a nonprofit basis, as a service.

New policy on reprinting the Steps: We adopted a new policy on requests to reprint the Twelve Steps, as follows:

The directors of A.A.W.S. agreed that requests to use, adapt, and/or interpret the Twelve Steps fall into three classifications: (1) fellowships similar to A.A., and self-help groups; (2) A.A. members; (3) professional people (doctors, clergymen, professors, counselors, writers, etc.).

Agreed to handle requests as follows:

1 Requests from fellowships similar to A.A., and self-help groups or writers: (a) A.A.W.S. requests that (1) the Twelve Steps be listed in sequence as written, followed by the proper credit line; (2) adaptations of the Steps may then follow, as well as an interpretation suitable for a particular fellowship or group.

2 Requests from A.A. members: (a) A.A.W.S. requests that (1) the Twelve Steps be listed in sequence as written, followed by the proper credit line; (2) the writer's (speaker's) interpretation of each Step,

or the Steps as a whole, may follow, provided that such interpretation is preceded by a disclaimer stating that the opinions expressed are those of the writer (speaker) only, and not the interpretation of A.A. as a whole; the interpretation accepted by A.A. appears in the books published by A.A.W.S., Inc.; (3) in order to insure that the text is consistent with the disclaimer, A.A.W.S. will request permission to see the manuscript (text) in advance.

3 Requests from professionals: (a) A.A.W.S. requests that (1) the Twelve Steps be listed in sequence as written, followed by the proper credit line;** (2) analysis, interpretation, or studies of the Steps or other aspects of the A.A. program may follow, provided that such interpretation is preceded by a statement that the opinions expressed are those of the writer only, and not the interpretation of A.A. as a whole; the interpretation accepted by A.A. appears in the books published by A.A.W.S., Inc.; (3) A.A.W.S. be given the opportunity to see the manuscript—not for the purpose of making editorial changes or comments, but simply to check the accuracy of factual material.

The board will apply the policies outlined above with respect to the Twelve Traditions and Concepts, as well.

Permission to quote from A.A. books and pamphlets and requests from overseas A.A. offices to reprint will not be affected by the suggestions outlined above.

A.A.W.S. directors: We now have nine. Five are also trustees, including two regionals and one Class A.

John Waterfield, chairperson

*"Permission to use the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous for adaptation granted by A.A. World Services, Inc."

***"Reprinted with permission of A.A. World Services, Inc."
Literature distributed in 1978: See list on inside back cover.

Archives

History lives on at G.S.O. and local centers

Trustees' committee: More than 140 oral histories of early A.A.'s are on tape. Our vast microfilming project goes forward. Two copies of all original material are made. One will be held at a special storage facility for protection; the other, in our archives.

We now provide replicas of special archival pieces. These include nine photographs, mainly from the book "A.A. Comes of Age," and a photocopy of the original Big Book manuscript. A.A.W.S. also has a 29-minute cassette of talks by Dr. Bob and Bill, "Voices of Our Co-Founders."

Since most newspaper and magazine clippings in our archival collection are of a kind and some are over 40 years old, a costly conservation effort is under way, with the help of a well-known restorer/preserver company. The necessarily slow process—which includes bathing, drying, repairing, mounting, and encapsulating—will take years to complete. But further deterioration of our collection will be halted.

Mike Rainbolt, chairperson

Staff report: Throughout the Fellowship, the need to preserve memorabilia of A.A.'s 44-year history seems more clearly understood. Several areas—15 or more—have local archival centers or are setting them up. We're in touch with many, feeling the time has come to share common experience, explore common aims, and establish procedures that will benefit both members and professional researchers.

About 50 audiotapes were rerecorded onto our standard format, and a safety set was forwarded to our permanent storage facility in New Jersey.

About 150 taped "memoirs" were received last year. Many were interviews obtained by Niles Peebles in writing biographies of the co-founders. (The archives have been available to him for research.) Many manuscripts, personal histories, and state and area histories were received.

Using a volunteer with professional equipment, we are gathering as many of Bill W.'s recorded talks as we can. About 150 have been duplicated.

We recently engaged a new employee for in-depth inventory of the collection, including indexing and cataloging.

We are investigating visual aids to show highlights of A.A.'s history particularly appropriate for A.A.'s 45th anniversary year, 1980.

Nell Wing, archivist

Conference

Year-round work leads to annual meeting

Trustees' committee: We review ways of improving the Conference, and consider suggested themes and agenda topics.

The chairperson noted that presentations on finance at the 28th Conference were favorably received. Only half of the groups contribute to the Fellowship in service as well as monetarily, and thereby deprive themselves of the full benefit of the A.A. program. Conversely, the Fellowship is deprived of talent. He suggested the theme of the 29th Conference emphasize the need for participation by all groups and members.

After the 1978 Conference evaluation questionnaire and the post-Conference sharing session, recommendations were made:

- That Friday night be free.
- Some workshops be scheduled during mornings and afternoons, not all in the evening.
- Instead of being part of the Conference Manual, copies of presentations be distributed at the Conference with *Box 4-5-9*.
- We reviewed a preliminary agenda for 1979. In addition to topics suggested by the Conference Agenda Committee, we recommended a presentation/discussion on "The Role of the General Service Trustees and How They Are Elected." Other topics submitted for Conference consideration were referred to appropriate committee, workshop, or Ask-It Basket sessions.
- We suggested that workshop moderators stimulate discussion and in-depth sharing among different areas.

We also recommended that:

- A trustee chair the opening-night A.A. meeting, with three delegates and three staff members (G.S.O. and GV) speaking.
- The film about A.A. be shown at the joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and to the entire Conference that evening, action to be taken during committee reports later.

- Conference members other than G.S.O. staff serve as reporters for workshops.
- Signs identifying the "no smoking" area be posted at the 1979 Conference.

Mac Cheater, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference assumes the leadership responsibility once held by A.A.'s founders and, through its structure, carries the A.A. message. It is also a policy-making body that expresses the group conscience of A.A.

The Conference secretary is a point of contact among all Conference members and all those serving on area general service committees. We now have on our mailing list: 750 past delegates, 1,900 district committee members, 73 area committee chairpersons, 84 area committee secretaries, and 81 area committee treasurers. Others involved in service are also on the list. We receive minutes of most area assemblies and committee meetings, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. This is very helpful to us all in keeping up with A.A. activities.

All A.A.'s are encouraged to send in suggestions for the Conference agenda. This is usually done through the delegates. Suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval. Afterward, they are shared with everyone in the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda mailed to delegates in January.

The Conference secretary is responsible for:

- 1 Collection of items for the Conference theme and agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and trustees' Committee on the Conference.
- 3 Monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference.
- 4 Working with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff on the Conference.
- 5 Routing reports for Conference Manuals, Early Bird edition of Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 6 Preparation of Conference Advisory Actions and summaries of Ask-It Basket questions.
- 7 Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from area committees and D.C.M's.

Phyllis Masback

Cooperation with the Professional Community

A.A. spotlighted at national gatherings

Trustees' committee: At the Annual Forum of the National Council on Alcoholism (N.C.A.) in St. Louis, Mo., in 1978, A.A. participated in a panel on "Treatment Facility Bridges to A.A. Sponsorship." For "How A.A. and Local Councils Cooperate," panel members included our Eastern Missouri delegate, the P.I. chairperson, the chairperson for A.A. central offices, and a past delegate on the area P.I. Committee. Among panelists on "How A.A. Cooperates With Medical and Nursing Schools" was an A.A. from Tucson, Ariz. Your chairperson also attended a seminar on alcoholism sponsored by the Psychiatric Institute

Foundation in Washington, D.C., in October and made a presentation on "A.A. as an Adjunct to Treatment."

At the International Congress on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence, in Poland in September, "Dr. Jack" Norris, chairperson emeritus of our General Service Board, reported on the 1977 A.A. membership survey. A third Professional Exhibit and a professional table-top exhibit, both reflecting information from the 1977 survey, have been completed, and two older exhibits have been refurbished.

After reviewing our pamphlet "Alcoholism Is a Management Problem — A.A. Suggests One Solution," the committee recommended it be discontinued.

A questionnaire was sent to the people on our mailing list for *About A.A.*, our newsletter for professionals. From the responses, the committee was able to suggest ways to clarify the purpose of the newsletter, and recommended that basic information about A.A. be included. The committee also recommended that *About A.A.* be sent with our exhibits to professional conferences, with sign-up cards for those interested.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

Staff report: The C.P.C. Committee and staff carry our message to the still-suffering alcoholic by sharing information about our Fellowship with professional groups and individuals.

Staff, committee, and board members have participated in:

- 1978 Annual Forum of National Council on Alcoholism.
- Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University.
- Summer School of Alcohol Studies, University of Utah.
- Meetings of Advisory Council, National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.).
- National Association of Alcoholism Counselors' Conference.
- 32nd International Congress on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence.
- 29th Annual Meeting of Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America (A.D.P.A.).
- Conference on National Standards for Drinking Driving Cases.
- Mid-Atlantic Seminar on Alcoholism.
- Seminar on alcohol and drugs, Statesboro, Ga.
- Third Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse.
- Visit to Rhinebeck Lodge, Rhinebeck, N.Y.

The G.S.O. staff twice attended sharing sessions with the N.C.A. staff in New York.

Our Professional Exhibit was shown at 20 meetings of national, state, or regional organizations. So far, we have received 1,459 requests for literature from the first 12 of those gatherings.

A G.S.O. committee was formed to gather information on being of better service to the deaf. Delegates, central offices, answering services, and deaf groups have been surveyed. We have also contacted approximately 3,200 agencies for the deaf, asking how to make our literature more meaningful to the deaf, and how we can improve our services. The National Association of Hearing and Speech Action suggested we send our letter to periodicals of, by, and for the deaf. We did write to over 270, and asked them to publish our letter.

Sarah Pierce

New discount packets meet special needs

Trustees' committee: We submitted manuscript and artwork of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" to the Conference committee.

Contents of the Institutions Discount Packages were rearranged to include more recovery literature, but the cost remained the same. An additional package, for younger alcoholics who may be slow readers, is now available.

Although some areas have developed prerelease sponsorship programs, correspondence from local A.A.'s indicates much remains to be done. We suggested that local committees interested in such sponsorship consider workshops, held at the facility, where feasible. These might include facility staff members, as well as "inside" and "outside" A.A.'s. Most prison administrators are eager to cooperate with A.A., but institutions committee people should communicate with the proper level of administration when arranging A.A. activities.

We suggested that the *Institutions Bulletin* continue to share area experience with prerelease sponsorship, and that delegates inform areas about this opportunity for Twelfth Step work.

W. J. Estelle Jr., chairperson

Staff report: We provide services to 1,136 groups in correctional facilities and to 160 institutions committees serving them.

G.S.O. offers correspondence with the correctional facilities staff member, and through our Institutions Correspondence Service. New groups are listed in G.S.O. records, and sent a Group Handbook, a Big Book, complimentary literature, and a yearly updated directory. Each "inside" group receives *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly. Discount packages of literature (English and Spanish) are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees. Each month, the Grapevine gives us back issues, and we pass along copies to groups that need additional complimentary literature. The films "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and the filmstrips "P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service" are available on loan, without charge, to these groups.

We share experience with local institutions committees. Mail indicates a great need for more literature, more A.A. sponsors, more outside speakers, and more outside A.A.'s to participate in the Institutions Correspondence Service.

We also send kits (Guidelines and pamphlets) to new institutions committee members. The Conference and trustees' Committees on Correctional Facilities keep up-to-date on services provided to inside groups and offer suggestions for change or improvement. Highlights of trustee committee quarterly meetings are shared with the Conference Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Treatment Facilities.

G.S.O. services are only a beginning for alcoholic inmates. Their continued sobriety depends largely on local institutions committees' and sponsors' extending the hand of A.A.

Vincina McCarthy

Groups answer call for wider participation

Trustees' committee: At midyear 1978, the committee felt great concern. Contributions were well below budget, actually running behind the same period in 1977! Our goal of broadening the base of group support seemed farther away than ever. G.S.O.'s general manager contacted all groups and shared our concern. Their response was really gratifying. Not only was the decline halted, but enough contributions came in by the end of the year to bring us in just about on budget. Contributions for this year continue at an accelerated rate. Groups do respond when properly informed.

Contributions from groups and A.A. members totaled \$1,081,350 for 1978, compared with \$1,004,600 for 1977, an increase of \$76,750, or 7.6% (we had budgeted for 8.2%).

A.A. growth continued to show in the distribution of literature. Sales for 1978 totaled \$2,696,890—\$313,550 or 13.2% more than reported for 1977. Total G.S.O. income, representing publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest generated by cash flow, was over 1977 by \$260,080 (10.6% over the amount budgeted).

Expenses increased \$224,290 over the previous year (2% under the budget). Cost of the employees' pension fund, formerly funded by book discounts donated (now reverted to the groups) accounts for a substantial share of the expense increase. Net income of all G.S.O. operations totaled \$344,560, compared with a net income of \$308,770 for 1977. Per prior Conference action, \$265,000 of surplus operating income was transferred to the Reserve Fund. The committee is happy to note the reserve is taking us closer to the day when we can further reduce cost of literature to groups.

Both G.S.O. and Grapevine budgets have been reviewed and approved. Allowing for a growing Fellowship, and the higher cost of doing business, both income and expenses are projected to reflect modest increases.

Arthur Miles, chairperson

General Service Sharing Session

Problems of clubs and overseas A.A. studied

Trustees' report: July and October meetings were devoted to A.A. worldwide, based on trips by Bob Pearson, G.S.O. general manager, to Europe, Australia, and New Zealand, and on the experience of our two delegates to the World Service Meeting (W.S.M.) in Helsinki.

Bob emphasized that A.A. works in all countries, all tongues, all cultures. Three factors seem to affect A.A. growth: leadership, literature, and structure, as well as the kinds of A.A. meetings offered. "Dr. Jack" Norris added observations on A.A. in Brazil, Argentina, and Colombia. We concentrated on how our board can be helpful overseas. We discussed translations problems, the value of countries' sharing, and the possibility of service offices to serve clusters of countries.

Our delegates to the W.S.M. shared the excitement and enthusiasm of this great experience. Both emphasized that our board and office can maintain and further develop the quality of our own structure and service, and that we have much to learn as well as much to share. Our structure meets our needs, and theirs will develop to meet their needs.

A W.S.M. delegate from Great Britain attended the midwinter conference in Manitoba, and this idea might be shared with other U.S. or Canadian A.A.'s planning conventions.

Australia's W.S.M. delegate, visiting our session, suggested that if we are to be a wise and mature sponsor for the rest of the world, we have to encourage others to accept responsibility for their own affairs. We have to "let go."

It was suggested we reactivate a trustees' International Committee, and prepare a news bulletin sharing W.S.M. delegates' experience between meetings.

In October, we talked of problems relating to clubs for A.A. members, such as: exclusion of non-club members from A.A. groups meeting in clubs; lack of clear-cut separation of groups that meet in a club from the club itself; accepting money or gifts from outside, as well as public fund-raising drives; playing of games at clubhouses, rather than twelfth-stepping; the perception by the community that the club is A.A.; and the weakness of central offices and general service structure in areas where A.A. activity is club-centered.

Consensus was that clubs are with us to stay. Some serve a useful purpose and enhance A.A. life, as well as creating problems.

Guidelines on Clubs are to be rewritten to emphasize the importance of the separation of A.A. groups from clubs. They might be in two sections: one having to do with the formation and operation of the club, emphasizing positive aspects and listing known pitfalls; the other outlining the autonomous and independent status of groups meetings in clubs. The Guidelines can also emphasize that, even though clubs may not be A.A. entities as such, they are perceived as A.A. by the community. So it is always hoped that clubs will operate within the spirit of the Traditions.

John Waterfield, chairperson

Group services coordinator

Variety of useful materials sent to groups

Staff report: As editor of *Box 4-5-9*, the service coordinator gathers material for each issue and is responsible for *Box 4-5-9* in English, French, and Spanish, sent out to almost 50,000 A.A.'s worldwide. This office also supervises production of all service materials, updating of Guidelines and listings, and distribution of films, literature displays, Group Handbooks, and other A.A. material.

The coordinator conducts a monthly G.S.O. service meeting. Each assignment is discussed, and suggestions for improvement and change are offered.

Group Handbooks (for regular and correctional or treatment



facilities groups) are sent to new groups, plus some complimentary literature. They also receive *Box 4-5-9* and the appropriate regional directory. New French-speaking and Spanish-speaking groups are sent *Box 4-5-9* and complimentary literature in their own languages.

As the need arises, the 13 Guidelines are updated to keep up with current trends. Two 16mm color films, "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," are rented to regular A.A. groups at \$35 per week. Two filmstrips, "P.O. Box 459" and "Circles of Love and Service," may be purchased at \$6.50 each.

We have lists of: deaf groups; tapes for sale, exchange, and correspondence; sources of A.A. books in Braille for blind members; fellowships similar to A.A.; armed forces groups; books and pamphlets in other languages (Foreign Literature Order Form, French Order Form, Spanish Order Form); Loners; Internationalists; overseas offices; and central offices in U.S. and Canada.

Susan Daly

International

New committee plans help for A.A. worldwide

Trustees' committee: The first meeting of this new committee was held in January. We plan to explore ways in which our General Service Board and/or Office may assist in the growth of A.A. worldwide, with particular attention to countries with no service structure. We hope to do this through encouraging and assisting in establishment of G.S.O.'s or literature distribution centers, encouraging countries with established structures to share experience with those attempting to build them, ascertaining ways we might be helpful with literature translations, service experience, and other concerns. We hope to be in touch with A.A. members who travel extensively. A form for the use of travelers will ask about literature distribution, leadership, types of meetings, and structure in the countries visited.

A.A. members in countries without a service office will be encouraged to list their names with embassies and consulates, so

traveling A.A.'s or members moving to such countries can make contacts.

We hope to prepare profiles on A.A. activities in countries without a service structure, so we can get a clearer picture of what is needed and how we can help.

Virginia Hallman, chairperson

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

New Orleans beckons; Forums on second round

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—We recommended as theme for the 1980 International Convention in New Orleans "The Joy of Living"; also, that each state and province be responsible for one alkathon, and that speakers for these be chosen by the 1980 Conference delegates. In states and provinces with more than one Conference area, at least one speaker per area will be chosen. We suggested that no speakers from the 1975 Denver Convention be eligible to speak in New Orleans.

Regarding Al-Anon's financial relationship to the 1980 Convention, we recommended the following policy:

- Money from Al-Anon or Alateen registrants will be credited to Al-Anon.
- Al-Anon will be responsible for its own promotion, planning, Rivergate Convention Center, charges for its meetings, etc.
- Expenses of events attended by both A.A. and Al-Anon members will be charged to Al-Anon on a pro rata basis equivalent to the Al-Anon percentage of the total registrations.
- Al-Anon will be given one complimentary room for every 50 rooms credited to Al-Anon registrations.
- Al-Anon will receive a computer printout of every Al-Anon registration.

We recommended that a directory of hospitality suites be included in the registration kit.

We approved the following list of topics for workshops and special-interest meetings:

Workshops

Intergroups and Central Offices	Anonymity
Loners and Internationalists	Big Book
Grapevine	Twelve Steps
Public Information	Sponsorship
Treatment Facilities	A.A. Newsletters and Bulletins
How A.A. Cooperates With Professionals	Twelve Traditions
Prisons	Twelve Concepts
Archives	Spanish (four)
	French (two)

Special interests

Al-Anon, Alateen	Oldtimers meetings
Young people in A.A.	Marathon meetings
Gays in A.A.	International meetings (four)
International Doctors in A.A.	A.A. for the deaf
International Lawyers in A.A.	

We recommended a registration fee of \$15, which covers the opening dance, big show, shuttle bus service, etc.

We approved the budget of the host Dance Committee for a Mardi Gras Ball complete with floats, balloons, and Mardi Gras ceremony.

We also recommended that a section of the Superdome be reserved for deaf A.A.'s and that a sign-language expert interpret.

Regional Forums—Eleven have been held, and we have read reports on each. Letters from participants say Forums have been well received and informative and have improved communication within the Fellowship.

We have discussed:

- Omitting questionnaire to delegates, but asking them for agenda items and subjects to discuss.
- Sending the "Host Committee Functions" sheet to host-city contact for distribution.
- Spelling out more clearly in *Box 4-5-9* the purpose of Forums (gatherings for service-minded people, not conventions).
- Reminding a host-city taper that G.S.O. no longer buys reel-to-reel tapes, but one set of cassettes will be purchased for our records.

We feel the present system of reporting each Forum is adequate, but workshops can be summarized, eliminating questions and answers, giving only a sense of each meeting.

Suggestions to improve future Forums:

- Staff members might tell what they were like as drinking alcoholics.
- The Ask-It Basket is too full. The number of questions from the floor might be limited, with other answers mailed.
- The area may decide to have one, two, or no workshops.
- We should continue to show at every Forum the filmstrips "Circles of Love and Service" and "P.O. Box 459" and the film "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and add the new A.A. film if it is approved by the Conference.
- We recommend delegates give talks on subjects, not area highlights, to motivate discussion.

Schedule for Forums is:

1979		
August 17-19	Western Canada	Edmonton, Alta.
December	Southwest U.S.	
1980		
March	Eastern Canada	
May	Open	
September	Pacific U.S. (?)	
December	Southeast U.S.	Georgia

Cec Corrigan, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—Our 45th anniversary year will be celebrated in New Orleans, La., July 3-6, 1980. Four A.A. committees are working on the Convention: the trustees', the Conference, the host, and the G.S.O. planning. Al-Anon has equivalent committees. The staff secretary coordinates these and serves as secretary to the A.A. committees.

Buffet lunches and dinners will be served in the Superdome. The caterer can serve 6,000 people per meal. Meal tickets will

be presold with preregistration. Menus and prices will be announced as soon as available.

All major events will be held in the Superdome arena. Panels and workshops will be in the four quadrants of the Superdome. Alkathons will be held in hotel ballrooms. The welcoming Mardi Gras Ball will be held Thursday evening in the Rivergate Convention Center. The Crawfish Crawl (for young people) will be at the same time at a nearby hotel. Headquarters hotel for A.A. will be the Hyatt Regency.

Tulane University has committed dormitory accommodation for 1,200 people. All hotel rooms will be released on a first-come, first-served basis. Registration forms will be mailed September 15, 1979, with October-November *Box 4-5-9*.

Free shuttle bus service will be provided from participating hotels to the Superdome on Friday, Saturday, and Sunday. A past delegates' luncheon and a central office luncheon will be held.

Betty Liddle

Regional Forums—All regions have now held Forums; the second round is under way. The General Service Board has approved four a year, held by invitation of regions, and planned with regional trustee, delegates, and G.S.O. staff. Often, plans are made at Conference regional luncheons.

The coordinator also works with the host-city contact, makes travel and hotel arrangements, sends out regional mailings, arranges Forum boards, sample literature, and service material, and does a summary report of each Forum.

Forums offer personal contact and two-way communication between service-minded people of a region and representatives of the General Service Board, G.S.O., and the Grapevine.

Susan Daly, coordinator

Presentation on 1980 Convention: p. 10

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

Seagoing and isolated A.A.'s start groups

Staff report: We now have 590 Internationalists (seagoing A.A.'s) on our mailing list. They have started groups all over the world, even aboard ships, where 16 are now listed. This service helps these A.A.'s keep in touch with the program through correspondence with one another, with Loners, and with the staff member on this assignment.

The 482 Loners on our mailing list include English-speaking members and those who speak Spanish, French, or German. They are unable to attend meetings, because there are no groups nearby. It isn't easy to start a group, but Loners are encouraged to do so. Until a group is started, Loners stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing via correspondence. Use of tapes among Lone Members is increasing.

Each new Internationalist and new Loner receives a package of

A.A. literature, lists of other Internationalists and Loners, the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* bimonthly, *Box 4-5-9* on alternate months, and a Grapevine order form. A new Internationalist is also sent all four A.A. directories; a new Loner, the directory in which he or she is listed.

Loner Sponsors, now numbering 968, are A.A.'s who correspond with Lone Members. Members housebound because of illness or disability are called LIMs, and we have 25.

When Internationalists no longer go to sea, they may be added to G.S.O. mailing lists as Port Contacts if they wish. Many have started groups in overseas ports.

We now have Loners in Yugoslavia, Taiwan, Saudi Arabia, and Africa, and many in remote parts of the U.S. and Canada. One Loner in the Canadian Arctic started a group called the Arctic A's. Last year, we reported an Internationalist's effort to start A.A. in American Samoa. This seed bore fruit. The Pago Pago Group is now listed at G.S.O.

Helen Turnquest

Literature

Draft of Dr. Bob biography now completed

Trustees' committee: Since the 1978 Conference, we have combined "The Co-Founders of A.A." and "Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders" into "The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous." About 60,000 have been distributed.

The foreword of the second edition of "Alcoholics Anonymous" as it was originally published is now included in the third edition, as of the fourth printing.

The manuscript of the biography of Dr. Bob has been completed. That of Bill's biography will be finished by year's end.

The manuscript of a pamphlet for elderly alcoholics has been completed, to be submitted for Conference approval.

We agreed to delete Lisa's story from "Young People and A.A.," as requested by Lisa, and replace it with a new story, subject to Conference approval.

We recommended that "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends" be printed in the same format as other A.A. pamphlets, and Conference approval be asked.

Principal photography of the A.A. film has been completed. A research firm has been employed to determine whether the film fulfills our goals, and to assure that it is of general public interest.

After evaluating existing tapes of the Big Book, we recommended that A.A.W.S. consider producing a master tape of professional quality for distribution to the Fellowship.

Don Nicolson, chairperson

Staff report: The staff person with this assignment works with the group services coordinator on service material. We distrib-

ute Box 4-5-9 in English and Spanish, and five other bulletins with a combined circulation of 67,750:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
Box 4-5-9 (English)	40,000	6
Box 4-5-9 (French)	1,750	6
Box 4-5-9 (Spanish)	9,100	6
Loners-Internationalists Meeting	2,600	6
P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin	1,700	3
Institutions Bulletin	5,100	3
Quarterly Report	3,600	3*
About A.A.	3,900	2

*The Final Conference Report takes the place of the fourth issue.

Box 4-5-9 (French) is translated and printed by the French Literature Service in Quebec, in cooperation with this office.

The literature coordinator works with editors on updating and revising old pamphlets, and with writers, artists, editors, and printers in the preparation of new pamphlets, displays, leaflets, and other service materials, including audiovisual. "Self-Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan" was completed in December 1978. Publication of the Dr. Bob book is anticipated early in 1980. Publication of Bill's is expected later that year.

We send a letter semiannually to all central offices, intergroup committees, and literature distribution centers in the U.S. and Canada and overseas to keep them informed of anything new in A.A. literature, periodicals, and audiovisual materials.

Lois Fisher

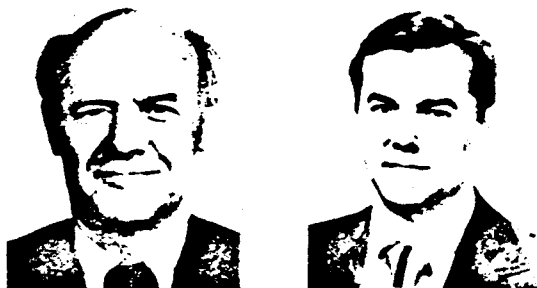
Presentations on A.A. literature: p. 12

Nominating

New trustees, directors, officers named

Trustees' committee: A subcommittee studied the possibility of restructuring Conference regions. It was felt there is no need to restructure at this time.

We approved: John Ryall as general service trustee (New York) to replace Charles Hanson; all candidates for trustee-at-large - Canada and regional trustee from the Northeast and Southwest U.S.; Dr. Kenneth H. Williams for election as trustee to replace Dr. John L. Norris, and Frank Smeal to replace Arthur Miles as board treasurer—all nonalcoholics; Louis Kraus as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.; George Dorsey, to replace John Waterfield on the A.A.W.S. board after the April meeting:



Named as Class A trustees: Frank Smeal (left), Kenneth Williams, M.D.

Jeanne Conway and John Williams as directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

We recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1979 Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Gordon M. Patrick
John D. Bealer, M.D.	Frank P. Smeal
W. J. Estelle Jr.	Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.	

Class B

Cecil E. Corrigan	Martin Le Boutillier
Jerry A. Danzig	Don Nicolson
George E. Dorsey	John Ryall
Virginia C. Hallman	Edward J. Small
Ruth K. Hartshorn	Samuel E. Smith
Fernand Ippersiel	
One regional trustee - Northeast U.S.	
One regional trustee - Southwest U.S.	
One trustee-at-large - Canada	

We approved the following as officers of the board:

Chairperson	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
First vice-chairperson	John D. Bealer, M.D.
Second vice-chairperson	Gordon M. Patrick
Secretary	Don Nicolson
Treasurer	Frank P. Smeal
Assistant treasurer	Dennis I. Manders
Assistant secretary	Cora Louise Belford*

We recommended that this slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1979 Conference:

Cora Louise Belford*	Martin Le Boutillier
John Bragg	Don Nicolson
Jerry A. Danzig	Robert G. Pearson
George E. Dorsey	Jacquelyn Solomon
Louis Kraus	

We recommended to the Conference as Grapevine directors:

Jeanne Conway	Mary Phelps
Cecil E. Corrigan	John Ryall
Donald F. Daly	Fred J. Sengstacke
Retha Gresham	Edward J. Small
Virginia C. Hallman	John Williams
Austin MacCormick	

In addition, we asked that the role of and procedure for election of general service trustees (New York) be placed on the 1979 Conference agenda.

Charles Hanson, chairperson

*To be replaced at rotation time (9/1/79) by Phyllis Masback

Overseas, World Service Meeting, Spanish correspondence

A.A. linkage stronger among more countries

Staff report:

Overseas—A.A. membership outside the U.S. and Canada is now 149,336, in 8,737 groups.

The staff member on this assignment corresponds with overseas general service offices and literature distribution centers—24 in all. Members in these countries are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.'s. Groups in such countries are no longer listed with us; travelers contact those G.S.O.'s. We work closely with overseas A.A.'s to help establish literature distribution centers.

To protect A.A.'s copyright, care is taken in granting reprint permissions. Translations are checked by bilingual A.A.'s. No permission is needed simply to *translate* Conference-approved literature. But before the project of printing a translation begins, G.S.O. explores the way the material will be financed and distributed, and it is then presented to A.A. World Services, Inc., for reprint permission.

Here are some overseas highlights:

- In Bombay, India, the intergroup is developing into a national office for the entire country.
- On Trinidad and Tobago in the Caribbean, a national structure is also being developed.
- An English-speaking intergroup for Central Europe is located in West Germany.
- A.A.'s in Poland and Italy are translating some basic A.A. pamphlets.
- The Big Book in Japanese is nearing production.

World Service Meeting—Thirty-four delegates from 17 countries attended the Fifth World Service Meeting (W.S.M.) in Helsinki, Finland. The sixth will be in New York in June 1980, so delegates may participate in the International Convention.

One highlight of the W.S.M. was the recommendation to establish a European information center. Initial responsibility was accepted by United Kingdom delegates, and the center is in operation in London.

Spanish correspondence—We have 245 Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S., Canada, and Puerto Rico. Correspondence is mostly

in Spanish. Cities with Spanish intergroups are Newark, N.J., New York, Chicago, Los Angeles, San Francisco, Washington, and San Juan.

G.S.O. prints some Spanish literature for groups in the U.S. and Canada. "The A.A. Service Manual" is being translated into Spanish. Meantime, the manual printed in Guatemala is nearest to ours.

There are nine overseas Spanish-speaking general service offices: Argentina, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Mexico, Nicaragua, and Spain. (Brazil, Portuguese-speaking, also has a G.S.O.) Most print and distribute Conference-approved literature, and A.A. in most of these countries has a structure patterned after ours.

Beth Kuhlmann

Public Information

Local committees both receive and give help

Trustees' committee: A news release was sent to major daily newspapers announcing Milton Maxwell's election as chairperson of our board. Also, a feature article on John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris's 27 years of service to A.A. was released to a major wire service and medical journals.

We reviewed radio announcements made by the Tennessee P.I. Committee and recommended they not be distributed through G.S.O. They deal more with alcoholism than with A.A., and are adaptations of National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism announcements, so affiliation might be implied.

Dr. Jack reported on the 1977 membership survey to the International Congress on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence in Poland. A news release on it was sent to major newspapers, wire services, news magazines, and medical and psychiatric journals. It was sent to local P.I. committees in advance.

The Northern Florida P.I. Committee reported on its project for reaching doctors, sponsored in part by the trustees' committee. From 2,919 letters mailed (to a list from the state medical society), 99 requests for literature and 13 for personal contact were received; 46 doctors agreed to place literature in their waiting rooms; 45 stated they would refer patients to A.A. More than half the members who participated felt the project was worthwhile.

The committee, seeking to serve local P.I. committees better, sent them a questionnaire. Responses indicated the greatest need of local committees is to interest more A.A. members in P.I. work. We recommended that: *Box 4-5-9* run an article on P.I./C.P.C. work; *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* report results of the questionnaire and carry articles on speaking at non-A.A. meetings and on P.I. workshops; and local P.I./C.P.C. committees continue to share their experience with us.

In the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity," the sentence "When speaking as an A.A. member at non-A.A. meetings, use full name if you wish and request that no pictures or last names be used in the press, radio, TV, or films" was changed to "When speaking as A.A. members at non-A.A. meetings, usually use first



name only." This reflects current experience shared at the 1978 Conference. It was approved by the Conference P.I. Committee. A similar change was made in "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."

The committee reviewed a letter to the General Service Board, stating that new and revised pamphlets tend to liberalize the concept of the principles of anonymity; that members are being encouraged to be less anonymous both inside and outside A.A.; and that too much focus is placed on Tradition Eleven and not enough on Tradition Twelve in our literature. The letter said reinterpretation of any Tradition is, in effect, an amendment of it.

We recommended the board respond that changes in P.I. literature are never made with the intention of reinterpreting Traditions, but are designed to reflect what is believed to be current A.A. practice.

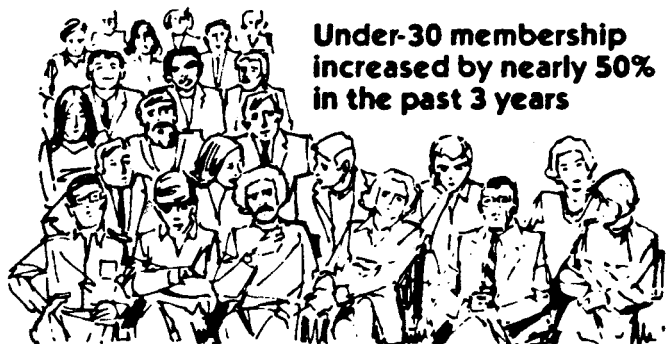
A subcommittee is revising the P.I. Kit as recommended by the 1978 Conference. This developed into a project far more extensive than anticipated, but it is expected to be ready this summer.

The committee will consider using selected material from the new A.A. film for new TV spots, once we know the Conference recommendation on the film and the Conference P.I. Committee recommendation on TV spots.

Jerry Danzig, chairperson

Staff report: In 1978, we answered 8,308 requests for information about A.A. from students, teachers, nurses, doctors, members of the clergy, family members, and others. We processed clippings of 4,476 newspaper stories about A.A.

We distributed 118 TV spots and 159 radio tapes to local P.I. committees. One area P.I. committee bought radio and TV spots for every radio and TV station in the state. We supplied 145 table-top displays for state and local health fairs—the new one, reflecting the 1977 survey results. The new display and



pamphlet based on these figures are both called "The A.A. Member." Over 250,000 copies of "A.A. at a Glance" were given to alcoholism agencies requesting them and to local P.I. committees, for giveaways at non-A.A. meetings.

We provided information about A.A. to many publications, among them *Home Life*, *Bookview Magazine*, *Patient Care*, *Scholastic Magazine*, *Newsweek*, and *McCall's*.

There are currently 264 P.I. committees and 425 contacts listed at G.S.O. New P.I. chairpersons receive these items free: the P.I. Kit; assorted P.I. pamphlets; Guidelines on Public Information and on Forming Local Committees on Cooperation with the Professional Community. Three times yearly, P.I. contacts and chairpersons receive the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, a sharing of local committees' activities.

Betty Liddle

Staff coordinator

Staff days filled with letters, trips, visits

Staff report: Ten A.A.'s are G.S.O. staff members. Each has a specific assignment; some assignments are combined; and some involve responsibility for the preparation of special service bulletins. Work is apportioned as follows:

Conference	<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Conference issue); <i>Conference Report</i> ; secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee
Cooperation with the professional community	<i>About A.A.</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i> ; secretary, trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees
Correctional facilities	<i>Institutions Bulletin</i> ; <i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i> ; secretary, trustees' and Conference Correctional Facilities Committees
Group services coordinator, A.A. regional forums	<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English, Spanish, and French); co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee
Literature coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees
Loners, Internationalists, LIMs	<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i>
Overseas, World Service Meeting, Spanish correspondence	<i>World Service Meeting Report</i> ; secretary, World Service Meeting; secretary, trustees' International and Nominating Committees and Conference Committee on Trustees
Public information	<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i> ; secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee
Staff coordinator	<i>Quarterly Report</i> ; assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Service Sharing Session and Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions
Treatment facilities	<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i> ; secretary, trustees' and Conference Treatment Facilities Committees

Basic responsibility of the staff is to answer correspondence. During 1978, over 22,017 letters were answered individually. The staff coordinator makes sure mail is answered promptly without interruption during vacations, sickness, or absences, or when a staff member is involved with a special project. Each staff member also answers A.A. group mail from a specific region. Folders containing correspondence, as well as publications and clippings, are circulated to all staff members.

An exciting aspect of G.S.O. staff service is invitations to A.A.

conventions, assembly meetings, and get-togethers. In the past year, we made about 60 such trips. These provide the staff opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.'s all over the U.S. and Canada, to inform them about G.S.O. services, and to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

In 1978, more than 1,069 visitors came to G.S.O. Each may take a tour. These visits also provide chances to exchange information.

Cora Louise Belford

Treatment Facilities

New pamphlet to replace 'A.A. in Hospitals'

Trustees' committee: We discussed updating the Guidelines on Institutions Committees and possibly covering treatment facilities activities in separate Guidelines. It was felt that more experience is needed, so preparation has not started.

We recommended a presentation and workshop at this Conference on sponsorship needs of potential members coming to A.A. from treatment facilities.

We reviewed the draft of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" (to replace "A.A. in Hospitals") and will now ask the Conference committee for comments.

Problems that can occur when A.A. members employed in a treatment facility coordinate A.A. activities were examined. We recommended that Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field be sent to new treatment facilities groups.

To explore carrying the message to senior citizens' homes or retirement places, a subcommittee was appointed.

Ed Small, chairperson

Staff report: We had 1,285 groups in treatment facilities as of March 1, 1979, a growth of about 235 since 1978. This indicates many more alcoholics are being referred to A.A. from

treatment facilities. Because of the overwhelming flow in some areas, G.S.O. has prepared material sharing how some areas cope with the influx from these centers. Several areas have formed treatment facilities committees during the past year. However, there have long been committees carrying the message into hospitals, rehabs, etc.

Correspondence shows that committees and individuals actively assume responsibility for follow-up sponsorship, but more A.A.'s are needed in this Twelfth Step work. We hope that the presentation on this subject will be helpful.

A new directory of *A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities* will be ready in the fall of 1980. Many regular groups are now meeting in treatment facilities, with A.A.'s in the community welcome to attend. These are listed as regular A.A. groups in the appropriate directory, rather than in the directory for treatment facilities. Listing in the latter indicates that the meeting is for "inside" members only.

The flyer "Where Do I Go From Here?" was designed for the patient leaving a facility, to make it clear that A.A. on the "outside" is willing to help. Space is left for local A.A. contact information. In 1978, 150,000 were distributed.

G.S.O. provides the following services to carry the message to those in treatment facilities:

- Correspondence with the staff member on this assignment, and with interested outside A.A.'s.
- New groups are added to our mailing list, and sent the Group Handbook, complimentary literature, and updated directories.
- Each such group receives *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly.
- A discount package of A.A. literature is available to these groups.
- The filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service" and the 16mm films "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" are lent free to A.A. groups in treatment centers.
- Experience is shared with local committees and groups.
- Conference and trustees' Committees on Treatment Facilities keep up-to-date on services provided, and suggest improvements or changes.

Beth Kuhlmann

Reports From the A.A. Grapevine

At 35-year mark, Grapevine plans a new book

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is a separate, non-profit corporation wholly owned by the General Service Board. The Grapevine board conducts the magazine's business, oversees publication, insures adherence to the Traditions, and plans the budget. Two regional trustees, one from the U.S. and one from Canada, were added to the Grapevine board in July.

Circulation reached 100,000 in March 1978, and by year end

was 108,744—an 11.5% increase over 1977. Since the new Grapevine representative (GvR) program got under way in June 1977, a 17% increase in circulation has been realized. GvRs submitted 5,800 subscriptions in 1978. Miscellaneous-item sales were up by 24%; Christmas gift subscriptions increased 1,300 over 1977.

Effort is being made to find more efficient ways of processing orders and reducing costs. Changes in the all-groups mailing resulted in a cost savings of \$7,000, and over \$20,000 income

was realized. Net income of \$16,260 for 1978 was realized. The sum of \$35,550, the increase in subscription liability for 1978 plus a \$10,000 contribution, was transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

Our GvR program had over 3,000 GvRs and 79 Grapevine committees at the end of 1978, compared with 53 committees and 900 GvRs one year before. Only 12 of the 91 delegate areas have not yet established Grapevine committees. We are particularly grateful to delegates who established GvRs in groups as recommended by the 27th Conference.

Charles Hanson, chairperson

Staff report: The past year has been exciting. By March 31, 1979, circulation was 113,000. June 1979 marks our 35th anniversary. Our celebration issue reprints a piece from a soldier who received the Grapevine overseas in World War II and presents a new article based on reminiscences of Bill W.'s half sister, the first paid Grapevine employee.

We plan to produce a new book that may be called "The Best of the Grapevine," from material published in our first 35 years. A.A.'s have long asked for this.

Our magazine deals mostly with sober living, the chief interest of A.A. members who share with us. Our goal is to reflect present-day A.A. and offer something for all our readers. In 1978, 25 pieces were on Steps and Traditions; 35, on sober living. Others were on basic A.A., spiritual insight, service, A.A. history, and humorous topics.

Our Editorial Board of ten meets bimonthly in an advisory capacity, to help originate ideas and carry out assignments. In the May issue, "A Different Kind of Meeting" shows Editorial Board sessions are similar to regular A.A. meetings.

Retha Gresham, managing editor

Presentations on the Grapevine: p. 16

Questions Call Forth Well-Considered Answers

Conference members wishing to bring up questions of general A.A. concern were invited to write them down and slip them (unsigned) into the Ask-It Basket. At four sessions, experience and information were shared. Here are some of the questions and answers.

Addictions other than alcohol

Q Should A.A. members start self-help groups for drug addicts alone?

A In some instances where drug-addicted individuals have attempted to join A.A., the group has successfully helped the drug addicts to start their own group with its own purpose.

Central offices

Q Should a central office or intergroup be listed as "Alcoholics Anonymous" on the directory in the lobby of the building in which it has office space?

A In accordance with the principle of local autonomy, customs vary from area to area and town to town. At 468 Park Avenue South, the directory shows "A.A. World Services, Inc.," and "General Service Board of Trustees of A.A."

Conferences and conventions

Q The trustees' report on approved meetings for the 1980 International Convention includes a number of special-interest meetings. Some of these include gay, doctors, lawyers, etc. I realize that this subject has been discussed many times before, but not in the context of the International. Can we get a sense of the Conference on the special groups at the International?

A The report of the trustees' 1980 International Convention Committee, which included a number of special-interest sessions at that Convention, was accepted by the entire Conference body.

Q Do professionals appearing at conferences, conventions, etc., receive, in addition to their expenses, their normal consultant or professional fees? Case in point: the doctor's presentation on the sponsorship of potential members coming to A.A. from treatment facilities. [See p. 21 of this report.]

A No fee is paid to such participants.

Q Please define "get-together" as used in item 4, p. 55 of "The A.A. Service Manual," 1978 edition.

A Because of the varying names used to designate gatherings of A.A.'s, a general term was used to allow latitude for local interpretation.

Q What is the feeling of this meeting on large conventions that continue to have the A.A. directories (provincial) on table-top display for sale at these conventions? (The directories referred to are local meeting lists, with group contacts.)

A Where this is done, caution must be exercised to avoid having such directories fall into the hands of individuals who may misuse them. However, one delegate pointed out that when a person is determined to obtain any A.A. directory, he usually manages to do so.

Directories

Q Should a Bible study group of A.A. members be listed as an A.A. group or meeting?

A No.

Finance

Q If certain roundups, cruises, and conventions are not A.A., how can we accept contributions at G.S.O. or area or intergroup? We do not accept from clubs or retreats.

A It is the policy of G.S.O. to accept contributions from A.A.'s and gatherings of A.A.'s.

Q I would appreciate a thorough discussion and a sense of the meeting on the use of chances, lotteries, etc., to finance various A.A. functions.

A Sense of the meeting: This is not a good practice.

Q Some people have been upset by their returned checks from G.S.O. being endorsed with "A.A." Could this be changed?

A The General Service Office endorses its checks with a rubber stamp reading "World Services, Inc." The Grapevine now endorses its checks with "The Grapevine, Inc."

Q Will some of the areas that hold two- and three-day assemblies explain how expenses of participants (G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, etc.) are met?

A In some instances, groups are asked to contribute toward the expenses of their G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s. Expenses for area officers are covered by the area treasury.

Q Would it be possible to have contributions to G.S.O. listed in the Canadian directory in terms of Canadian funds rather than U.S., as the exchange rate makes it confusing to the Canadian members?

A This matter surfaced at the sharing session. G.S.O. will take steps to see that the convention from Canadian to U.S. dollars is clarified on future statements.

Q Does 60-30-10 completely cancel out Penny-a-Day? Is it an alternative suggested in the hope of increasing contributions? Are the birthday and anniversary contributions entirely separate?

A The "60-30-10" pamphlet supersedes the "Penny-a-Day" pamphlet. The Penny-a-Day Plan was suggested by the 1973 Conference as a yardstick for individual contributions. The 60-30-10 formula is a suggested means of dividing excess funds at the group level. The Anniversary Plan is being phased out and will no longer be mentioned in A.A. literature.

General Service Board

Q What are our chances of ever having an alcoholic chairperson of the board?

A There is nothing in our policy that specifies that the chairperson must be nonalcoholic. The 1978 Conference reconfirmed that the chairperson should be Class A, but each Conference is free to decide what it wants.

Q Why are such large numbers of trustees voting in the trustee elections? Does this not put them in the rather odd position of selecting their own successors?

A Three-quarters of the voters on regional trustees are delegates, and one-quarter are trustees. This is explained in the Conference Charter. See pp. 24-25 in the 1978 edition of "The A.A. Service Manual."

Q Can our Legacy of Unity be better served if local service opinion is sought before the nomination of Class A trustees?

The right of decision, of course, remains with the board.
A The Conference agreed it would be a good idea to talk with some of the active local A.A.'s before nominating a candidate.

General Service Conference

Q What is being done to try to equalize the delegate areas so that all A.A. members (groups) have more equal representation at the General Service Conference?

A We do not have a representative system. Once you are chosen to serve, you serve the body that you are assigned to. The General Service Conference asks the groups to contribute funds and to contribute people to serve on the various committees. If you are chosen as a delegate, you are elected as a "people" contribution to the Conference. We do not represent anything. We may ask our areas to give us their thinking and their opinions on a particular matter or problem, but we have the responsibility to come here, express our thinking, give our leadership, and make our own decisions.

Q How do Regional Forums fit into the Conference plan? Are Forums contrary to the service structure? Is the Conference structure being weakened as a result of Regional Forums?

A Regional Forums take no action at any time. They are sharing sessions held to stimulate service work. (In a show of hands regarding acceptance of the Regional Forum concept, there were no negative votes.)

Q What do you do with old, used, former delegates?

A "Try to keep them quiet" was the first suggestion. At the 1978 Conference, it was suggested that they become Grapevine representatives. In any event, it would be a mistake not to use them for workshops, seminars, get-togethers, and so on. Areas should make good use of their experience.

Q How is the size of the Conference governed? Delegates vs. the rest of the Conference?

A A 1979 Conference Advisory Action (44, p. 48) answered this question.

Q In how many areas does the delegate usually become area chairperson? In how many areas does the area chairperson usually become delegate?

A In 23 areas, the delegate becomes chairperson; in 14 areas, the chairperson becomes delegate.

Q My alternate delegate is allowed to let his name stand for a second consecutive term in the same capacity. Is this not contrary to the principle of rotation at all levels of service?

A "The A.A. Service Manual" states, "The Conference is on record in its attitude toward delegate rotation. . . . Strongly recommends limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term." As for the alternate delegate and other area officers, although rotation is recommended, it would be up to the voters to make the final choice.

General Service Office

Q What criteria are used for the hiring of G.S.O. staff members in terms of length of sobriety, education, experience, background? How are these criteria applied in hiring?

A Four years of sobriety are required. Good *quality* of

sobriety is important, and in general, an applicant's emotional maturity, compassion, and commitment to A.A. are more important than his or her education and business experience. A standard application form is used. Although there is nothing rigid in writing, applicants' qualifications are very carefully considered during a thorough screening process.

Q When G.S.O. staff members attend alcoholism schools and seminars, is the tuition paid from the General Fund, or do they pay their own?

A When staff members are sent to such seminars by G.S.O., tuition fees are paid from the General Fund. Usually, this is done as part of a staff member's preparation for the C.P.C. assignment.

Q Why does it take so long to get G.S.R. and committee kits? We elect them in the fall, and they get their kits in March, six months later.

A It should not take this long. When G.S.O. learns of a new group, a group-information form is mailed to the contact. When the completed form is returned, the G.S.R. is notified of the group service number by first-class mail, and literature is sent by third-class mail (which can take as long as three weeks). Listing of a new group is speeded up when new group information is received at G.S.O. separately from other matters, such as contributions, literature orders, minutes of meetings, etc. The responsibility for notifying G.S.O. varies from area to area, and it is recommended that the appropriate trusted servants be reminded of this responsibility from time to time. G.S.O. will be happy to send a supply of new group and group change forms on request.

Grapevine

Q What is the possibility of reprinting "A.A. Today," which is referred to so often in Bill's reader?

A This was originally published by the Grapevine as a Convention souvenir and was not considered to be of ongoing interest. If the Conference felt a need for it, "A.A. Today" could be reprinted, although it would be quite expensive in hard cover. The economics of a soft-cover edition can be investigated. A show of hands indicated that the majority of the Conference members were interested in such a facsimile.

Group affairs

Q We have a few groups that hang up pictures of our co-founders in the meeting rooms, and one member asked if that was contrary to the Tradition of "principles before personalities." I would like to know if there are other such experiences. What if they also hang up pictures of members who are still alive?

A It has long been a custom to hang pictures of our co-founders. However, the group conscience should prevail with regard to hanging any portraits.

Q Is the speaker meeting (as opposed to the discussion-type meeting) declining in popularity? ("Speaker meeting" means the traditional three- or four-speaker meeting without floor discussion.)

A Yes, the trend seems to be in this direction.

Q How can we allow individuals and minorities to express

their opinions without monopolizing committee meetings and assemblies?

A At the outset, get a sense of the meeting on time limitation per speaker, and the number of times each speaker may address the subject.

Q What are G.S.O.'s and the Conference's attitudes toward open Step meetings?

A This, of course, is a matter of local autonomy. In some areas, all Step meetings are closed meetings. In others, open Step meetings have worked very well and have carried the message.

Q Could we have a show of hands? How many area assemblies have G.S.R. schools or workshops?

A Not unanimous, but many do.

Q In meetings, the Twelve Concepts never seem to be mentioned or discussed, nor is service work. What suggestions do you have to get people interested, involved, and informed?

A One area holds workshops on the Concepts, three at a time, at its assemblies. Another encourages inclusion of the Concepts with Steps and Traditions discussions, giving examples of how the Concepts apply in service work. Still another rotates its monthly assemblies, and the host city provides two G.S.R.'s to discuss one Tradition and one Concept in workshops. Delegates might include a word or two on service work whenever they speak to A.A. audiences.

Q In my area, it is a custom in 90% of the groups to read from the book "Thought, Prayer, and Meditation." This is not a Conference-approved book. Is this wrong? What can be done?

A This is a matter for the groups to decide for themselves.

Q Groups in our area frequently run social functions (dinners, etc.) included in a speaker meeting. It is the sense of our assembly that these meetings be open to everyone and the charge be only for food, etc. How can it be made clear that there should be or is no charge for the meeting?

Q Are we breaking Traditions when funds that are contributed at meetings (by people other than members of that group) are used to have an anniversary party, food, dancing, etc.? Can a group use these funds for any purpose?

A (to both questions above) Ultimately, it is a matter of group autonomy. One delegate noted that where social functions take place in his area, the members bring the food, the cost is divided by the number of people in the group, and each is asked to contribute accordingly.

Q What would be the consensus about an A.A. group that does not want a G.S.R. or anything to do with G.S.O.?

A Since each group is autonomous, there is little that can be done. It is unfortunate, however, when groups that have discovered a good thing do not wish to share it. Delegates were urged to persevere by occasional attendance at meetings of such groups.

Q In the past when you went to an A.A. meeting, vulgar language was not allowed. Now, when people come from treatment, vulgar language seems the common thing. Is this the "new way," and how could it be corrected?

A Experience seems to indicate that this problem eventually solves itself as new members grow in the program. It was pointed out that alcoholics should be allowed to say anything necessary to express themselves.

Literature

Q I am against this "degenderizing" of our literature. Who said that G.S.O. should do that? Did that action receive prior Conference approval? If not, why not? Could we have a sense of the meeting on this?

A The matter of exclusively masculine language in A.A. pamphlets was reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee in 1977, and rewording was accepted by the Conference Literature Committee and by the entire Conference body.

Q Will G.S.O. circulate the filmstrips "Circles of Love and Service" and "P.O. Box 459" to the central offices for distribution to groups?"

A Both of these filmstrips have been offered at no charge to central offices for this purpose. They are also on the order form, and G.S.O. will be happy to fill any orders for them.

Q Would you tell us the preliminary and/or final results of the "outside A.A." survey done by the contract agency to inform us whether the film meets the objectives it was meant to? How was the survey conducted?

A Overall audience reactions to the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" were very favorable. Specifically, the film did an excellent job of communicating information about A.A. to the public and, most important, had a significant positive impact on the public's *attitude* toward A.A. Analysis of both the qualitative and quantitative data indicated that, except for some negative reaction to the length and pacing of the film, the overall impression created was very positive. For instance, prior to the film, 31% of the audience stated that if they knew someone with a drinking problem, they would definitely tell him or her to contact A.A., whereas after seeing the film, that proportion increased to 49%.

Q The people in the A.A. film whose stories we hear—i.e., the construction worker, the runner, the housewife, the artist—are very recognizable if one already knows them. Inside the Fellowship, this is not really important. But anyone outside A.A. (if the film is shown on TV) in the same community or profession would be able to recognize these people if they already know them, but don't know they are alcoholics. And so the film has broken their anonymity. How is this justified?

A This film is produced within the Eleventh Tradition. The argument above would also apply to recognition of an A.A. member's story in the Grapevine, the Big Book, or other A.A. literature. It was pointed out that one of the active participants in the film was present at a recent Regional Forum where the film was shown, and *none* of the Forum-goers recognized her.

Q Did Lois Wilson approve the pictures of Bill in the film?

A The approval of Bill's and Dr. Bob's families was neither sought nor given for this specific use. However, the photos used in the film are the property of the A.A. archives, and the families have agreed to their use outside the Fellowship. Since the co-founders are deceased, the Eleventh Tradition no longer applies.

Q Why can't we have a spiritual-guidance book prepared by G.S.O. and Conference-approved, since the "24-hour book" is too religious and "As Bill Sees It" does not fill the need?

A This matter will again be reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee.

Q Has Hazelden been given permission to quote from our Steps, Traditions, and the Big Book? If not, why not?

A The book "Twenty-Four Hours a Day" did not originate with Hazelden. Hazelden is scrupulous about obtaining proper permission for other reprinting of portions of A.A. literature.

Q Why was "The A.A. Way of Life" changed to "As Bill Sees It"?

A The original title contained both phrases. They were reversed several years ago, because "As Bill Sees It" better expresses what is in the book. Incidentally, this change resulted in an immediate increase in sales, which continues to this day.

Q On p. 78 of the 1977 edition of "The A.A. Service Manual" under "Who Votes?" we need a definition of "committee members and officers." Does this mean the ten committees mentioned on p. 72? Does this mean the district committee members and officers? Whom is this referring to? Please take to General Service Conference this April and have it explained.

A The committee members referred to on p. 78 under "Who Presides? Who Votes?" are district committee members. Those mentioned in Chapter VII (p. 72 of the 1977 edition) are members of the standing Conference committees (Conference Agenda Committee, Conference Finance Committee, etc.).

Q What are the literature publishing problems in Australia that are referred to in the A.A.W.S. report?

A As in many places, A.A. in Australia began with a Loner, then a group, then more groups, and eventually a service structure. Each state formed its own service office, similar to our central or intergroup offices. Australian states operate much more independently than the states and provinces in this part of the world. One state service office requested and was granted permission to reprint A.A. literature and did so for many years. Finally, a General Service Office was established. Where this has happened in other countries, the central office with the reprint permission has yielded this right to the new general service office. This, however, did not happen in Australia, with the result that the two offices were, in effect, competing with one another. A.A.W.S. was requested by the Australian General Service Conference to rescind the reprint permission given to the state service office. This situation has now been resolved, and it is hoped that, in the long run, the resolution will contribute to A.A. unity.

Q In Step Ten, could the word "daily" be added between the words "take" and "personal," i.e., "Continued to take daily personal inventory and when we were wrong promptly admitted it"?

A A 1976 Conference Advisory Action (Report and Charter Committee) states: "It is resolved by the 1976 General Service Conference that those instruments requiring consent of three-quarters of the responding groups for change or amendment would include the Twelve Steps of A.A. should any such change or amendment ever be proposed." (See p. 27 in the 1978 edition of "The A.A. Service Manual.")

Q The 1972 Conference suggested facilities clearly separate Conference-approved literature from other literature. What is the best action to take if a local alcoholism rehab now buys all literature from Hazelden (including A.A. items) and says they buy them together because it's easier and cheaper, so why not show them together? Hazelden really solicits.

A G.S.O. must by law sell its literature to anyone who orders it. What Hazelden or other agencies do is beyond our control. However, *within* the Fellowship, it is recommended that A.A.

literature be displayed separately from other literature.

Public information

Q What would be the reason for an A.A. member's using his full name while representing A.A. at a public information or a C.P.C. meeting?

A One reason might be to provide a contact for someone in the audience who might have a need for A.A.

Q In some high schools and colleges, an official inquiry (by a university) revealed that 14.2% of the boys and 3.3% of the girls are alcoholics. What should we do for them?

A Speaking at schools is a prime activity of the 264 P.I. committees. If your area does not have such an activity, it was suggested that a speakers' committee be formed to supply speakers for local junior and senior high schools. It was also recommended that an opportunity be provided for individual students to speak privately with the A.A. member afterward.

Twelve Traditions

Q If there is a question of interpretation between the long and short forms of the Traditions, which takes precedence?

A Bill W. wrote both of them. One does not take precedence over the other, although some feel the long form does.

Q (1) What precisely is an A.A. event? (2) Does selling tickets to an A.A. event violate Tradition Seven if such tickets are purchased by non-A.A. members? (3) Are we really self-supporting through our own contributions when we sell tickets to an A.A. event?

A There are no set answers to these three questions. (1) Except for group meetings and service meetings, there is no such thing as an "A.A. event." There are events held for A.A. members. Social events were very much a part of A.A. life in Akron when the first groups were formed. The problem has not been solved in 44 years. (2) This is difficult to answer. Indirectly, it may violate the self-support Tradition when solicitation outside the Fellowship takes place. However, if tickets are given away free of charge, you are supporting an outside agency. (3) Usually when tickets are sold, the price of the ticket covers rent, food expenses, etc. Excess funds are generally used to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Although every group ought to be self-supporting, groups in institutions cannot be. (This question led to so much discussion at the staff meeting that it was the group conscience that the Conference Agenda Committee be asked to include it on the agenda for 1980.)

Q Is it breaking the Traditions to advertise an A.A. dance on radio and in the press stating entrance fee, name of band, etc.? This dance was open to the public.

A Most A.A. groups do *not* advertise dances and other social events except within the Fellowship. Decision on these matters is traditionally left to the local group conscience.

Recommendations Offered on 68 Points

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to the actions introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Conference committees. (Members and officers of the 1979 committees are listed on p. 56.)

Floor Actions

1 It was recommended that the names of "alcohol and pills" groups not be listed in the A.A. directories.

2 It was recommended that simultaneous translation services (depending on foreign registration) be provided free of charge at the 1980 International Convention.

3 It was recommended that the method of electing trustees-at-large—U.S. and Canada be referred to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

4 It was recommended that a study committee composed of delegates, trustees, and staff be appointed to study the advisability of, and the procedures for, having literature and service material distributed by G.S.O. Conference-approved.



5 It was recommended that the following trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board: Class A (nonalcoholic)—Frank P. Smeal, Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.;

Class B—Stan N. Cameron, trustee-at-large—Canada (four years), LaVelle M. Clifford, Southwest U.S. (four years), Richard J. Driscoll, Northeast U.S. (four years), John Ryall, general service trustee (four years).

Presentations related to Floor Action 1: p. 17. Workshop: p. 25
Presentation related to Floor Action 2: p. 10
Presentations related to Floor Action 4: p. 12. Workshop: p. 25
Floor Action 5: brief biographies of new trustees on pp. 58-59

Agenda

6 It was recommended that the theme for the 1980 General Service Conference be built around "Participation — the Key to Recovery."

7 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1980 Conference consist of one leader and five speakers: three delegates and two staff members (one G.S.O. and one Grapevine). It was further recommended that the format of the meeting should be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

8 With regard to the committee's recommendations for presentation/discussion topics (among them: "Working With Others"; "The Role of the Alternate at All Levels of Service"; "The Cornerstone of Structure — the G.S.R."; "Where There Is Good Service Structure, There Is Growth in A.A. Membership"; and "Let's Not Squander Our Inheritance"), the Conference retain the general idea of the topics, but that the Conference Agenda Committee make additional suggestions.

9 At the 1980 General Service Conference, there be three workshops: two structured and one unstructured. It was further recommended that one of the workshops be on the topic "Working With Others."

10 During the roll call at the 1980 Conference, Conference members should stand when their names are called.

11 In response to a request from members of one of the workshops, a discussion on "How are expenses for service workers at all levels of service met in your area?" be included on the agenda of the 1980 General Service Conference.

Cooperation with the Professional Community

12 It was recommended that A.A. members, through their C.P.C. committees where feasible, assume the responsibility for communicating with treatment facilities and court programs, letting them know which meetings are available for prospective members, including beginners meetings, where possible. Each group's autonomy should be kept in mind. It was further suggested that sponsorship be made available for those new members coming from treatment facilities. [The committee noted that it did not want to detract from the help provided to alcoholics by the professional community, but wished to be of maximum service through cooperation in helping the alcoholic get involved in group life and understanding of the A.A. program.]

13 The 1976 Conference C.P.C. Committee's recommendation

be reaffirmed: "That in order to improve communication between A.A. and the professional community, we encourage A.A. members to become active on C.P.C. committees. Where there are existing public information and institutions committees, encourage cooperation among members of all committees, keeping always in mind that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Specific suggestions: (a) Sponsor your doctor; (b) sponsor your clergyman; (c) sponsor your employer; (d) communicate with the academic world; (e) hold workshops at all service levels."

14 "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends" continue to be available as an A.A.W.S. reprint of a Grapevine article.

15 "Problems Other Than Alcohol" be Conference-approved.

Presentations related to cooperation with the professional community: pp. 17, 20. Workshop: p. 25

Correctional Facilities

16 It was recommended that mail-poll approval of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be confirmed.



Preliminary sketch for new pamphlet pictures a prison A.A. group.

17 A booklet aimed at the alcoholic inmate is not warranted at this time, and further recommended that this subject be considered by the 1980 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

18 "Where Do I Go From Here?" and "A.A. at a Glance" be added to the institutions discount packages and that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities further explore rearranging the contents of the packages when "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" becomes available.

19 The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities explore the feasibility of producing a filmstrip based on "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and report its findings to the 1980 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

Finance

20 It was recommended that, in line with the principle of broadening the base of group support, emphasis should continue to be placed on group contributions. However, it was further recommended that (a) the limit on individual contributions should be increased from \$300 to \$500 to compensate for the inflationary factor since the last increase; and (b) bequests should be subject to the same limit as on individual contributions and be on a one-time-only basis and not in perpetuity.

Workshop touching on finance: p. 25

Grapevine

21 It was recommended that, when feasible, groups consider bulk orders as a means of making the Grapevine available at the group.

22 Grapevine representatives recommend to their groups that they sponsor subscriptions, where possible, for institutions, treatment facilities, and professionals being "sponsored."

23 The Grapevine office make available Grapevine prepaid gift certificates.

24 Delegates continue their efforts in using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

25 No changes be made in magazine format.

Presentations on the Grapevine: p. 16

Workshop on related topic: p. 25

1980 International Convention

26 It was recommended that the report of the trustees' International Convention Committee be accepted as read.

27 The staff report on the 1980 International Convention be accepted as read.

28 The number of non-A.A. speakers to be invited to participate in the 1980 International Convention remain the same (21) as at previous International Conventions.

29 Three commercial taping organizations be invited to establish guidelines and submit bids for providing the equipment to tape the 1980 International Convention. It was further recommended that the services of A.A. volunteers be utilized to do the actual taping within the guidelines established by the firm providing the equipment. It was felt that this procedure would cut the retail cost of the tapes to about 50% of the cost of tapes from the 1975 International Convention.

30 Box 4-5-9 publish information on: (a) Convention services for deaf A.A. members; (b) Convention policy regarding travel agencies and their handling of registration and reservation

forms; (c) when registration and reservation forms will be available.

31 The 1980 International Convention include showing(s) of the films "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View."

32 The general manager of G.S.O. personally inform area delegates of invitations to A.A. members in their respective areas to chair major functions of the International Convention prior to issuance of the invitation.

Reports on the Convention: pp. 10, 35

Literature

33 It was recommended that in response to a request to discuss amending the Scope to state that this committee deals with recovery literature only, the Composition, Scope, and Procedure of the Conference Literature Committee be retained as is.

34 The pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be expanded to include previous Conference Advisory Actions recommending that A.A. groups should not be named after institutions in which they meet or for persons either living or deceased, and that the word "family" should not be part of the name of the group.

35 Jo's story be substituted for Lisa's story in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." when it is next reprinted.

36 The Twelve Steps of A.A. be included in the pamphlet "Too Young?" when it is next reprinted.



37 A voice-over be added at the end of the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View," repeating that film techniques have been employed to protect the anonymity of A.A. members. With this addition, the committee recommended that the film be approved by the Conference. [The Conference also stipulated that sound-track audibility be improved.]

38 With regard to the distribution of the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View":

a A.A. World Services retain ownership of the film and control the distribution of each copy.

b During its first year, the film be released only to those with an expressed, direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, and that the area delegate be notified of *all* requests from his or her area for the film.

c Priority for distributing the film would be: (1) A.A. service entities, such as public information committees, institutions committees, etc.; (2) those with an expressed, direct interest in helping the sick alcoholic, such as treatment programs, professional groups, etc.; (3) schools, churches, service clubs, etc.

d Although the film is intended *primarily* for use outside A.A., prints be made available on a rental basis to any A.A. entities wishing to show it.

e With the exception of one or two selected test areas, the use of the film on television be delayed for one year to give the General Service Conference an opportunity to gain real experience with the reaction of the Fellowship and the public to the film.

f Anyone involved in showing the film during the coming year be asked to submit a brief evaluation on a prepared form to G.S.O.

g The results of the evaluation and the distribution policy be reviewed by the 1980 Conference Public Information Committee.

39 The pamphlet for the older alcoholic be approved by the Conference with the title "Now It's Time to Start Living" and the subtitle "Stories of those who came to A.A. in their later years."

40 No pamphlet or booklet concerning the Fourth Step be considered at this time, because this information is provided in the books "Alcoholics Anonymous" and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."

41 The biographies of Dr. Bob and Bill W. be published as separate books rather than as a joint biography.

Presentations on A.A. literature: p. 12

Policy/Admissions

42 It was recommended that Item 7 of the 1979 Conference questionnaire include a choice of free night or nights.

43 Directors-elect not attend the Conference as observers prior to their election, as they will attend as Conference members for four years after taking office.

44 No arbitrary ceiling be set on the number of G.S.O./GV staff eligible to vote, but that the delegates *never* have less than 66-2/3% of the total Conference votes. If more staff members are added, some method of rotation of staff eligible to vote may be necessary. In response to a request that delegates

represent not less than 75% of voting Conference members, this was considered an unrealistic figure. The committee pointed out that office personnel (exclusive of staff) assisting at the Conference are not participants in Conference sessions. Observers have no voice and no vote; they do not participate in Conference deliberations.

45 The committee reaffirmed previous action that two non-trustee members of each trustees' committee may attend as observers for one-half of one day with no voice and no vote.

46 The Conference Committee on Trustees always have at least nine members so that there will always be enough to constitute one-half of the committee votes in regional elections.

47 When delegates are polled prior to the Conference, they be asked to give their number of years in general service work as well as age and length of sobriety.

Presentations related to Advisory Actions 44, 45, 46: pp. 19, 22

Public Information

48 It was recommended that the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved as read, with the exception of the phrase "to reflect current A.A. practice" as used in the following paragraphs:*

"The committee recommended that the board respond that changes made by the P.I. Committee in P.I. literature are made *to reflect what is believed to be current A.A. practice and experience*. Changes in the 'Understanding Anonymity' and 'Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings' pamphlets are also responsive to the 1978 Conference comment.

"The committee further recommended that the board's reply should state that the intention when making changes in P.I. literature has never been to reinterpret A.A. Traditions, but again *to reflect current A.A. practice*."

—Because the phrase "to reflect current A.A. practice" is not specific enough in either definition or application to deal with the very important matter of changes in our A.A. literature.

49 The trustees' P.I. Committee and the General Service Office staff begin production on new television and radio spots at the earliest possible date.

50 The trustees' P.I. Committee and the General Service Office staff begin production on Spanish-speaking television and radio spots.

51 All the TV spots be "signed" for the deaf or have subtitles.

52 After reviewing and approving the model for the new P.I. Kit:

a A statement of the purpose and scope of a public information committee be included in the introductory element of the Public Information Kit.

b The anonymity letter to the media be included in the kit

with the suggestion that local P.I. committees take it to their local newspapers.

c Grapevine subscription forms be included in the kit with the suggestion that they be used to give subscriptions to local libraries, doctors, members of the clergy, etc.

d Definitions and special information be indicated by being printed in bold type.

e When available, the new P.I. Manual be mailed to all persons on the P.I. chairpersons list at G.S.O.

53 The mail-poll approval given for the changes made in the pamphlets "Understanding Anonymity" and "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to reflect the 1978 Conference indication that most A.A. members use first names only when speaking at non-A.A. meetings be reaffirmed.

54 The pamphlet "Too Young?" be included in the P.I. discount package.

55 The suggestion to make a syndicated column about A.A. available to local P.I. committees for local distribution be rejected.

*Condensed in the report on p. 39



Report and Charter

56 It was recommended that Article 2, p. 23, of "The A.A. Service Manual" (1978 edition) be amended to read: "*Composition*: The Conference (U.S. and Canada) shall be composed of area delegates, the trustees of the General Service Board, directors of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, and staff members of the Grapevine and General Service Office."

57 The following sentence be included in "The A.A. Service Manual" in an appropriate place other than under *Composition* (of the Conference): "Foreign visitors as the Conference may wish to invite may attend as observers only."

58 Article 10, paragraph 1, be changed to read "may" in place

of "will." The sentence would then read: "For trustees-at-large in the U.S. and Canada, the board may specify certain business or professional qualifications."

59 The revised and expanded index be included in the next printing of "The A.A. Service Manual."

60 All six directories print the season (spring, summer, fall, winter) and the year in which each directory is finally printed and distributed.

61 Listings contained within the *International A.A. Directory* for overseas general service offices, central offices, and inter-group offices be in a different color print or bracketed so that they can be more easily recognized.

62 The suggestion that a survey be mailed through *Box 4-5-9* concerning the combination of the *Canada, Eastern U.S.*, and *Western U.S. A.A. Directories* into a single volume be rejected.

Treatment Facilities

63 It was recommended that the Conference approve the pamphlet "How and Why A.A. Members Carry the A.A. Message In to Treatment Centers" (formerly "A.A. in Hospitals") with revisions.

64 Reaffirmation of the previous Conference actions adopted in 1976, which are: "(a) Establish greater communication between the referral sources and local A.A. groups; (b) recognize the necessity of meeting the new member where he presently is; listen to him; try to determine what he really knows about the A.A. program; (c) see that specific programs are set up for sponsoring people from treatment centers into local A.A. groups."

65 With regard to the hospital discount package, adopted trustees' committee recommendation that the contents of this package remain unchanged. When local areas have special needs, it is their responsibility to make up their own packages.

Presentations related to treatment facilities: p. 20. Workshop: p. 25

Committee on Trustees

66 It was recommended that the following persons be elected as trustees of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 37; Conference and board approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; and that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 37; slate of officers also approved].

67 The Statement on Restructuring Trustee Regions be accepted. (The statement recommended no restructuring at this time.)

68 The committee reaffirm that if a trustee candidate withdraws after the January 1 deadline, that area may not submit another candidate.

Presentations on general service trustees: p. 19

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1978

INCOME	1978	1977
Net sales, after book discounts waived of \$74,092 in 1977	\$2,696,888	\$2,383,334
Less: Cost of printing	771,597	677,503
Royalties	315,852	296,957
Gross profit from literature	1,609,439	1,408,874
Contributions — A.A. groups and members	1,081,347	1,004,608
Interest income	23,478	40,699
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>2,714,264</u>	<u>2,454,181</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	991,038	954,842
Pension expense	108,409	—
Rent	114,061	110,046
Box 4-5-9	48,177	49,510
A.A. directories	46,319	57,780
Other service printing	76,809	57,096
Shipping and mailing	249,661	209,561
Other office expenses	189,869	213,355
Insurance and payroll taxes	114,502	100,052
Professional services	25,300	27,344
Board, committee and staff meetings	48,199	43,723
1978 World Service Meeting	31,829	—
Writing, research	44,946	22,551
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	41,622	24,558
General Service Conference	93,315	76,166
E.D.P. system development	51,245	166,882
Regional Forums and other expenses	27,213	31,947
Film project	67,191	—
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>2,369,705</u>	<u>2,145,413</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR	<u>344,559</u>	<u>308,768</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 664,331	\$ 546,590
General Fund — General Service Board	<u>(319,772)</u>	<u>(237,822)</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$1,756,418	\$ 480,737
Transfers from: A.A. World Services, Inc.	265,000	835,400
A.A. General Service Board — General Fund		282,000
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	10,000	103,835
Investment income	<u>147,708</u>	<u>54,446</u>
Balance, December 31	<u>2,179,126</u>	<u>1,756,418</u>
() denotes red figures.		

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1978

Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees, and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., are amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1978

Financial statements

	1978	1977
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$608,042</u>	<u>\$541,798</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$ 79,093	\$ 69,696
Printing	143,147	116,847
Mailing – Service	42,476	37,957
– Postage	34,496	26,379
Other printing costs	12,557	4,350
Calendar costs	21,892	19,264
Occupancy costs	10,384	10,117
Telephone	1,436	1,603
Office supplies and expenses	3,211	1,769
Other editorial expenses	1,539	2,471
Office cleaning	<u>2,824</u>	<u>2,614</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>353,055</u>	<u>293,067</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	88,630	81,923
Data processing costs	29,200	23,559
Stationery and supplies	5,498	4,650
Occupancy costs	10,384	10,117
Telephone	1,436	1,603
Other office expense	5,864	4,730
Selling expense – Regular	21,177	24,883
– GvR program	8,003	2,589
Postage	25,733	14,770
Office cleaning	2,824	2,614
Bad debts	<u>933</u>	<u>418</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>199,682</u>	<u>171,856</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Transition salaries	–	13,494
Consultant fees	4,323	4,500
Insurance	6,879	5,138
Legal and accounting	7,300	5,700
Payroll taxes	11,592	10,150
Meetings and conferences	3,566	962
Furniture and equipment	2,018	1,445
Contribution to Retirement Plan	<u>3,500</u>	<u>3,500</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>39,178</u>	<u>44,889</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>591,915</u>	<u>509,812</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	16,127	31,986
Interest earned	<u>–</u>	<u>22,393</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR	<u>16,127</u>	<u>54,379</u>

(continued)

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1978

	December 31, 1978		December 31, 1977	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash – checking accounts	\$ 123,477	\$ 133,368	\$ 130,839	\$ 153,673
Savings accounts and certificates	563,874	–	576,420	207,677
Investment (Note C)	–	388,395	–	114,198
Accounts receivable	26,907	2,326	64,599	1,271
Due from Grapevine	3,363	–	2,334	–
Inventories	578,665	3,949	446,602	6,673
Prepaid expenses	52,986	20,718	49,766	16,403
Total Assets	1,349,272	548,756	1,270,560	499,895
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	256,931	22,126	183,178	11,985
Due Reserve Fund	265,000	–	339,600	–
Prepaid subscriptions	–	423,940	–	388,395
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	–	5,798	–	8,750
Total Liabilities	521,931	451,864	522,778	409,130
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	747,782	90,765	1,556,414	140,221
Net income for year	344,559	16,127	308,768	54,379
Transfer from (to) Reserve Fund	(265,000)	(10,000)	(1,117,400)	(103,835)
Total Net Worth	827,341	96,892	747,782	90,765
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$ 770,328		\$ 690,769	
General Fund – G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds – as above	827,341		747,782	
Reserve Fund	2,179,126		1,756,418	
Total Net Worth	3,006,467		2,504,200	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 500		\$ 27,182	
Savings accounts and certificates	189,170		622,045	
Due from A.A.W.S.	265,000		57,600	
Due from General Fund	–		282,000	
Due from A.A. Grapevine	45,545		274,197	
U.S. Treasury obligations	1,883,643		653,700	
Government agency and corporate bonds	159,949		210,297	
Accrued interest	59,259		17,792	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(423,940)		(388,395)	
Balance, December 31, 1978	2,179,126		1,756,418	

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

Note B – After transfers of \$319,772 in 1978 and \$237,822 in 1977 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C – Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund – \$423,940, less amounts pending transfer, \$35,545, resulting in a net investment of \$388,395 at December 31, 1978.

The financial statements and foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1979 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$3,021,300. Allowing for a continuing trend, and taking the growth of the Fellowship into consideration, the net increase in sales over 1978 is expected to be 11.8%. During 1979, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 281,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 140,500 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – regular edition, 35,400 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – pocket edition, 19,800 "A.A. Comes of Age," 31,600 "As Bill Sees It," 127,800 booklets, and 6,000,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$1,299,200 – the cost of producing the literature and the royalties paid on book sales – the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$1,722,100. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$1,740,100.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$1,070,400. Including employee retirement costs, no longer funded by discounts donated, total expenses are budgeted to be 12.2% higher than 1978. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$669,700.

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

Income: Against the cost of servicing groups, contributions have been budgeted at \$1,189,600. Because 1978 contributions showed signs of improvement, the increase has been set at an optimistic 10% over the previous year.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are charged against group contributions, are expected to be \$1,313,500. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$86,500. Total service expenses are budgeted to be \$123,900 greater than contribution income. This deficit will be funded from net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$191,500, less the interest earned on a day-of-deposit-to-day-of-withdrawal account. These expenses represent the cost of the quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Public Information Committee and the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, the cost of Regional Forums, legal and auditing expenses, plus other special projects such as the film project, and archival expenses. This net expense, totaling \$183,500, will also be funded out of the income from the publishing operation.

After budgeted deficits in the amount of \$307,400, the total net income for the General Service Office is anticipated to be \$362,300. After satisfying operating requirements, the balance of this net will be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1979 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Estimated income, from magazine and other sales, is budgeted at \$655,000. This represents an increase of \$46,600, or 7.6%, over 1978.

Total expenses: Editorial and printing costs are budgeted \$36,400 higher than 1978; circulation and business expense, \$20,500 higher; and general and administration expenses, \$2,000 higher than 1978. All expenses totaled are expected to be \$651,000, an increase of 10%.

Income from operations is budgeted at \$4,000. After satisfying operating needs, the balance of the net income will be transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

1979 G.S.O. Budget

Financial statements

The budget for 1979 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$3,021,300*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	1,299,200
Gross profit from sales	1,722,100
Interest income	18,000
Total income	\$1,740,100

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	669,700
----------------------------	---------

*Based on the sale of:

- 281,000 books – "Alcoholics Anonymous"
- 140,500 books – "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
- 35,400 books – "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
- 19,800 books – "A.A. Comes of Age"
- 31,600 books – "As Bill Sees It"
- and
- Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,189,600
---------------	-------------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	1,313,500**
----------------------------	-------------

**Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$86,500

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 8,000
----------	----------

TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	191,500***
----------------------------	------------

***Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, film project, etc.

The publishing activity will contribute \$307,400 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1979 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$ 655,000
Total costs and expenses	651,000
Net income from operations	4,000

Contributions

1978 Contributions From Groups—by Delegate Area

Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Total Group contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per capita	Area #	General Service Conference Area	Total # of Gps.	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Total Group contrib.	No. of Members	Contrib. per capita
1. Ala./N.W. Fla.		160	95	59.3%	\$ 6,022.38	2,187	\$2.75	63. S.Dak.		113	52	46.0%	\$ 3,483.85	1,659	\$2.09
2. Alsk.		66	44	66.7	2,863.58	752	3.94	64. Tenn.		208	118	56.7	6,723.27	2,731	2.46
3. Ariz.		301	131	43.5	11,045.70	4,229	2.61	65. N.E.		194	99	51.0	10,970.73	5,461	2.01
4. Ark.		133	75	56.4	3,513.51	1,869	1.87	66. N.W.		124	72	58.0	5,966.28	2,520	2.37
5. Calif.								67. S.E.		148	78	52.7	9,298.51	4,277	2.17
6. S.		741	347	46.8	28,782.33	29,448	.98	68. S.W.		202	106	52.4	8,230.68	3,718	2.21
7. N. Coastal		748	501	67.0	37,052.59	17,033	2.18	69. Utah		112	71	63.4	4,404.94	1,268	3.47
8. N. Int.		287	145	50.5	7,144.71	5,186	1.38	70. Vt.		65	35	53.8	2,047.63	787	2.60
9. San Diego		262	148	56.5	8,558.91	6,073	1.41	71. Va.		387	269	69.5	20,473.71	6,013	3.40
10. Mid-S.		595	344	57.8	26,774.17	14,500	1.85	72. Wash.		486	280	57.6	20,243.19	6,769	2.96
11. Colo.		279	171	61.3	14,241.71	3,961	3.60	73. W.Va.		101	69	68.3	3,563.26	1,075	3.31
12. Conn.		526	281	53.4	16,996.56	10,035	1.69	74. Wis.							
13. Del.		72	55	76.3	4,166.37	1,096	3.80	75. N.Wis./Upper		293	162	55.2	10,972.37	4,075	2.69
13. D.C.		193	122	63.2	12,585.57	5,703	2.21	76. S.		311	164	52.7	9,945.12	3,955	2.51
14. Fla.								77. Wyo.		55	29	52.7	1,251.90	590	2.12
15. N.		199	113	56.7	7,549.85	2,596	2.91	78. P.R.		86	56	65.1	3,568.60	1,292	2.76
16. S.		515	315	61.2	29,446.57	8,547	3.45	79. Alta./N.W.T.		282	140	49.6	10,541.66	3,364	3.13
17. Ga.		303	234	77.2	16,428.95	4,726	3.48	80. B.C./Yukon		413	219	53.0	17,238.12	5,451	3.16
18. Haw.		105	36	34.3	2,180.17	1,681	1.30	81. Man.		136	66	48.5	6,024.84	2,893	2.08
19. Idaho		73	49	67.1	2,815.87	830	3.39	82. N.B./P.E.I.		138	88	63.7	5,170.99	1,822	2.84
20. Ill.								83. N.S./Nfld./Lab.		162	90	55.5	4,547.53	1,679	2.71
21. Chicago		571	376	65.8	13,812.12	11,833	1.17	84. Ont.		357	175	49.0	20,241.88	6,693	3.02
22. N.		457	257	56.2	17,503.10	7,416	2.36	85. E.		124	44	35.4	4,204.68	1,459	2.88
23. S.		169	90	53.2	5,168.17	2,442	2.12	86. N.E.		58	26	44.8	3,106.13	1,069	2.91
24. Ind.								87. N.W.		330	187	56.7	25,035.88	4,474	5.60
25. N.		256	146	57.0	10,714.86	3,550	3.02	88. Que.							
26. S.		147	86	58.5	7,092.73	2,440	2.91	89. S.W.		370	204	55.1	8,289.49	9,764	.85
27. Iowa		250	130	52.0	9,969.87	4,757	2.10	90. S.E.		145	17	11.7	450.88	2,570	.18
28. Kans.		199	128	64.3	8,761.54	3,683	2.37	91. N.E.		210	35	16.6	1,402.14	4,554	.31
29. Ky.		220	122	55.4	11,544.92	2,937	3.93	92. N.W.		202	39	19.3	1,096.46	4,413	.25
30. La.		192	115	59.8	6,867.57	2,641	2.60	93. Sask.		244	154	63.1	8,849.36	3,263	2.71
31. Me.		141	85	60.2	4,135.67	1,675	2.46	Total U.S./							
32. Md.		360	220	61.1	12,817.73	4,352	2.95	Canada		22,072	12,326	55.8%	\$ 915,823.15*	409,721	2.24
33. Mass.								C.Z.		3	-0-	-0-	-0-	97	-0-
34. E.		570	279	48.9	23,379.55	13,567	1.72	Bahamas		4	1	25.0	100.00	82	1.22
35. W.		87	46	52.8	3,212.04	1,685	1.91	V.I. of U.S.		4	1	25.0	140.00	84	1.66
36. Mich.										22,083	12,328	55.8%	\$ 916,063.15	409,984	2.23
37. Cent.		200	121	60.5	12,899.24	3,918	3.29	Individual anniversary & in-memoriam					31,019.36		
38. S.E.		223	128	57.3	12,263.26	5,628	2.18	Specials					116,959.44		
39. W.		155	96	61.9	8,637.09	2,709	3.19	Total for U.S. & Canada					\$1,064,041.95		
40. Minn.								FOREIGN AND OTHER							
41. N.		260	149	57.3	7,857.63	4,261	1.84	Foreign					4,390.04		
42. S.		430	241	56.0	22,742.93	16,026	1.42	International Doctors in A.A.					300.00		
43. Miss.		95	63	66.3	2,994.41	1,291	2.31	International Lawyers in A.A.					724.00		
44. Mo.								International Advisory Council of Young							
45. E.		223	133	59.6	8,237.26	2,580	3.19	People in A.A.					1,073.88		
46. W.		113	61	53.9	5,282.42	2,130	2.47	Treatment facility groups					7,139.88		
47. Mont.		128	71	55.4	4,564.10	1,349	3.38	Correctional facility groups					223.42		
48. Nebr.		235	140	59.5	10,159.08	3,835	2.65	Internationalists					627.10		
49. Nev.		74	50	67.5	2,688.51	883	3.04	Internationalists groups					61.37		
50. N.H.		135	63	46.6	3,461.84	2,107	1.64	Birds of a Feather					375.00		
51. N.J.								Grand Total					\$1,078,956.64		
52. N.		439	235	53.5	19,528.59	8,345	2.34								
53. S.		136	95	69.8	8,959.33	1,668	5.37								
54. N.M.		114	66	57.8	3,975.75	1,417	2.81								
55. N.Y.															
56. Cent.		218	117	53.6	7,075.12	2,975	2.38								
57. H./M./B.		206	110	53.3	6,763.20	2,542	2.66								
58. S.E.		783	410	52.4	41,277.62	19,221	2.15								
59. W.		124	61	49.1	3,505.04	1,717	2.04								
60. N.C.		343	223	65.0	15,489.31	4,983	3.11								
61. N.Dak.		108	66	61.1	3,233.26	1,444	2.24								
62. Ohio															
63. Cent. & S.E.		170	85	50.0	5,101.22	2,369	2.15								
64. N.E.		394	130	33.0	10,272.38	9,538	1.08								
65. N.W. Ohio/S.E.															
66. Mich.		105	62	59.0	4,476.85	1,363	3.28								
67. S.W. Ohio/N.															
68. Ky.		150	84	56.0	6,052.09	2,205	2.74								
69. Okla.		179	164	91.6	11,815.88	2,205	5.35								
70. Oreg.		193	120	62.1	7,260.25	2,373	3.06								
71. Pa.															
72. E.		417	249	59.7	25,737.39	8,431	3.05								
73. W.		269	162	60.2	11,904.29	4,053	2.94								
74. R.I.		97	56	57.7	4,985.65	1,347	3.70								
75. S.C.		123	85	69.1	6,128.71	1,720	3.56								

COMPARISON - 1978-1977

	# Gps. re-ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. & Canada 1978	22,083	12,328	55.8%	\$ 915,823.15	409,984	\$2.23
U.S. & Canada 1977	21,332	12,038	56.4	839,434.03	403,590	2.07
Increase (Decrease)	751	290	(.6%)	\$ 76,389.12	6,394	\$.16

*Group contributions reported on this schedule represent only those received directly from individual groups within Conference areas and do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and anniversary.

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alabama	128	78	60.9%	\$ 5,158.43	1,836	\$2.81
Alaska	66	44	66.7	3,049.53	752	4.05
Arizona	297	128	43.1	12,026.08	4,131	2.91
Arkansas	134	75	56.0	4,122.51	1,921	2.14
California	2,644	1,488	56.3	125,368.91	72,878	1.72
Colorado	278	173	62.2	16,473.35	3,942	4.17
Connecticut	529	281	53.1	19,585.81	10,051	1.94
Delaware	72	55	76.4	4,301.45	1,096	3.92
District of Columbia	77	56	72.7	5,754.24	2,388	2.41
Florida	747	446	59.7	53,445.62	11,585	4.61
Georgia	304	234	77.0	16,943.95	4,748	3.56
Hawaii	105	36	34.3	3,843.88	1,674	2.29
Idaho	91	57	62.6	3,396.96	1,052	3.22
Illinois	1,197	723	60.4	41,902.43	21,709	1.93
Indiana	411	239	58.2	22,137.13	6,086	3.63
Iowa	248	131	52.8	11,855.22	4,721	2.51
Kansas	199	128	64.3	11,141.54	3,683	3.02
Kentucky	216	118	54.6	12,265.02	2,896	4.23
Louisiana	193	116	60.1	6,926.22	2,657	2.60
Maine	132	81	61.4	4,822.87	1,584	3.04
Maryland	472	285	60.4	21,575.50	7,547	2.85
Massachusetts	670	334	49.9	29,327.18	15,503	1.89
Michigan	677	391	57.8	40,859.83	13,404	3.04
Minnesota	687	386	56.2	41,131.22	20,019	2.05
Mississippi	95	63	66.3	3,064.41	1,291	2.37
Missouri	336	194	57.7	14,293.76	4,714	3.03
Montana	129	71	55.0	5,222.64	1,359	3.84
Nebraska	234	139	59.4	10,900.38	3,818	2.85
Nevada	72	49	68.1	4,193.01	853	4.91
New Hampshire	136	64	47.1	3,613.92	2,122	1.70
New Jersey	575	330	57.4	29,165.00	9,970	2.92
New Mexico	114	67	58.8	4,296.20	1,420	3.02
New York	1,333	679	50.9	61,611.43	25,900	2.37
North Carolina	343	223	65.0	15,846.31	4,983	3.18
North Dakota	108	66	61.1	3,694.26	1,441	2.56
Ohio	801	354	44.2	28,849.29	15,347	1.88
Oklahoma	180	164	91.1	12,427.84	2,210	5.62
Oregon	194	119	61.3	8,747.93	2,384	3.66
Pennsylvania	701	421	60.1	42,321.54	12,653	3.34
Rhode Island	92	56	60.9	5,493.69	1,271	4.32
South Carolina	122	86	70.5	6,926.71	1,710	4.05
South Dakota	113	52	46.0	5,696.47	1,633	3.48
Tennessee	209	117	56.0	7,712.77	2,742	2.81
Texas	669	355	53.1	42,031.70	15,855	2.65
Utah	112	71	63.4	4,414.94	1,280	3.44
Vermont	64	36	56.3	2,255.51	775	2.91
Virginia	392	274	69.9	21,802.60	6,146	3.54
Washington	454	267	58.8	23,074.10	6,378	3.61
West Virginia	102	71	69.6	3,834.11	1,086	3.53
Wisconsin	520	284	54.6	18,354.63	7,014	2.61
Wyoming	55	29	52.7	1,351.90	601	2.24
Commonwealth of P.R.	86	56	65.1	3,610.60	1,301	2.77
Canal Zone	3	-	-	-0-	97	-0-
Bahama Islands	4	1	25.0	100.00	82	1.22
Virgin Islands of U.S.	4	1	25.0	140.00	84	1.66
TOTAL for U.S.	18,926	10,842	57.3%	\$912,462.53	356,383	\$2.56

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alberta	264	132	50.0%	\$ 10,558.88	3,197	\$3.30
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	104	66	63.5	3,837.48	1,199	3.20
Nfld. & Lab.	47	25	53.2	1,092.38	444	2.46
Nova Scotia	115	65	56.5	3,785.61	1,253	3.02
Prince Edward Island	44	28	63.6	1,874.65	718	2.61
British Columbia	427	225	52.7	21,480.60	5,555	3.86
Manitoba	136	66	48.5	7,121.58	2,881	2.47
N.W. Territories	10	3	30.0	120.98	96	1.26
Ontario	840	427	50.8	57,480.68	13,507	4.25
Quebec	922	294	31.9	33,670.49	21,390	1.57
Saskatchewan	244	154	63.1	10,442.76	3,272	3.19
Yukon Territory	4	1	25.0	113.33	89	1.27
TOTAL for CANADA	3,157	1,486	47.1%	\$151,579.42	53,601	\$2.82
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	22,083	12,328	55.8%	\$1,064,041.95	409,984	\$2.59

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Foreign	4,390.04
International Doctors in A.A.	300.00
International Lawyers in A.A.	724.00
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.	1,073.88
Treatment facility groups	7,139.88
Correctional facility groups	223.42
Internationalists	627.10
Internationalists groups	61.37
Birds of a Feather	375.00
GRAND TOTAL	\$1,078,956.64

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1978-1977

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. 1978	18,926	10,842	57.3%	\$912,462.53	356,383	\$2.56
U.S. 1977	18,382	10,509	57.2	808,141.85	352,807	2.29
Increase (Decrease)	544	333	.1%	\$104,320.68	3,576	\$.27
Canada 1978	3,157	1,486	47.1%	\$151,579.42	53,601	\$2.82
Canada 1977	2,950	1,529	51.8	183,654.44	50,783	3.61
Increase (Decrease)	207	(43)	(4.7%)	(\$ 32,075.02)	2,818	(\$.79)
U.S. and Canada 1978	22,083	12,328	55.8%	\$1,064,041.95	409,984	\$2.59
U.S. and Canada 1977	21,332	12,038	56.4	991,796.29	403,590	2.46
Increase (Decrease)	751	290	(.6%)	\$ 72,245.66	6,394	\$.13

1979 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

*Bob Gadoury, R.I.
 **Bill Geoghan, Del.
 Lloyd King, N.B./P.E.I.
 Lew Lee, Wyo.

Lucetta De Young, S. Calif.
 Ken Himes, Cent. Mich.
 Louis Ladouceur, N.E. Que.
 Terry Leach, N.E. Ohio

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Conference Report and Charter

Helen Harmon, Man.
 **Bill Hopkins, Kans.
 Nick Krebs, S. Dak.
 *Gene Loomis, N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.
 Mickey Boynton, Ala./N.W. Fla.
 Herman Halm, N. N.J.
 Ruth Jagodzinski, Nev.
 George Van Dyke, W. Mo.

Secretary: Susan Daly

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Angelo Carpentier, N.W. Que.
 Roger Gleason, Nebr.
 *Barbara Marsh, Vt.
 **Smoky Woodson, W. N.Y.

Neil Dobbins, N.C.
 Hank Coleman, N.E. Tex.
 Chico Cortez, S. Fla.
 Lois Jacobson, N. Coastal Calif.

Secretary: Sarah Pierce

Correctional Facilities

Dick Juelson, Alsk.
 Pierre Prenoveau, S.W. Que.
 **Ken Savaloja, Oreg.
 *Jan Williamson, N.W. Tex.

Tom Devereux, Chicago
 Tina Martin, N.E. Ont.
 Ambrose Mohan, E. Pa.
 Wayne Parks, Ark.

Secretary: Vincina McCarthy

Finance

**J. D. Higginbotham, Miss.
 Goldene Lahann, Mid-S. Calif.
 *Bob Morris, Ariz.
 Duffy Salvog, N. Minn.

Frank Buffo, Utah
 Jack Ford, B.C./Yukon
 Leo Kelly, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
 Ken Winegarner, S.E. Mich.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

**Ramon Acevedo, P.R.
 John Maloney, W. Mass.
 *Ivan Strome, Alta./N.W.T.
 Michael Thies, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.

Laurent Biron, S.E. Que.
 Jim Cooney, D.C.
 Louise Holsten, N. Ind.
 Lou Mobley, N. Fla.
 Chuck Roberts, Va.

Secretary: Retha Gresham

Literature

**Joe Clements, Idaho
 Annette Fiel, N. Int. Calif.
 *Al Hergott, Sask.
 Skeeter Shillings, S.W. Tex.
 Jane Story, S. N.J.

Dan Byrne, Iowa
 Bill Geer, La.
 Wilf O'Grady, E. Ont.
 Elma Stone, E. Mo.

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Conference Policy/Admissions

Ed Edwards, Md.
 **Mark Peterson, Me.
 *Keith Strickland, Ga.
 Orville Young, W. Ont.

John Callaghan, Conn.
 Hershell Hood, S. Ill.
 Jo Kugel, S.E. N.Y.
 Ian McKenzie, W. Pa.

Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

Public Information

**Nada Butz, N.Dak.
 Ed Flanagan, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire
 Bill Killebrew, Tenn.
 Ruth Peterson, N. Ill.
 *Al Siska, W. Mich.

Robert Bisanz, S. Minn.
 Al Farley, W. Va.
 Terry Schemel, Wash.
 Herb Weatherwax, Haw.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Treatment Facilities

*Buck Bruner, S. Ind.
 **Thurman Dunn, N.M.
 Cliff Locke, San Diego
 Leon Richards, Ky.

LeRoy Belt, Okla.
 Dave Buckley, Colo.
 Anna Diggs, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
 Al Hurley, N.W. Ont.

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Committee on Trustees

Frank Stewart, S.C.
 **Bob Tapola, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.
 Marvin Wilson, Mont.
 *Woody Wooldridge, N.H.

Judd Black, Cent. N.Y.
 Michael Kelly, S. Wis.
 Glenice Sheehan, E. Mass.
 Dick White, S.E. Tex.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann



New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Committee

Conference Agenda
 Conference Report and Charter
 Cooperation with the Professional Community
 Correctional Facilities
 Finance
 Grapevine
 Literature
 Conference Policy/Admissions
 Public Information
 Treatment Facilities
 Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Kenneth Himes, Cent. Mich.
 Ruth Jagodzinski, Nev.

Lois Jacobson, N. Coastal Calif.
 Tina Martin, N.E. Ont.
 Jack Ford, B.C./Yukon
 Louis Mobley, N. Fla.
 Dan Byrne, Iowa
 Josephine Kugel, S.E. N.Y.
 Terry Schemel, Wash.
 Dave Buckley, Colo.
 Glenice Sheehan, E. Mass.

Alternate

Terry Leach, N.E. Ohio
 Herman H. Halm Jr., N. N.J.

Chico Cortez, S. Fla.
 Wayne Parks, Ark.
 Frank Buffo, Utah
 Charles J. Roberts, Va.
 Elma Stone, E. Mo.
 Ian McKenzie, W. Pa.
 Herb Weatherwax, Haw.
 Anna Diggs, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
 Dick White, S.E. Tex.

Committee on the 1980 International Convention

*Chairperson
 **Alternate chairperson

Judd Black, Cent. N.Y.
 *Bill Geer, La.

Al Hurley, N.W. Ont.
 Lois Jacobson, N. Coastal Calif.

Terry Leach, N.E. Ohio
Secretary: Betty Liddle

1979 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Mike Rainbolt, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
Fernand Ippersiel
Mary Phelps
John Waterfield
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Nell Wing, *archivist*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Mac Cheater, *chairperson*
John Bragg
George Dorsey
Retha Gresham
Virginia Hallman
Ruth Hartshorn
Don Nicolson
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Gordon Patrick, *chairperson*
John Bealer, M.D.
John Bragg
Donald Daly
Hal Marley
Martin Le Boutillier
Mike Rainbolt
Samuel Smith
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Sarah Pierce, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
Cecil Corrigan
Timothy Danaher
William Dunkin
Lucas Gonzalez
Virginia Hallman
Fernand Ippersiel
Ray Leary
John Ryall
Vincina McCarthy, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Arthur Miles, *chairperson*
John Bealer, M.D.
John Bragg
Martin Le Boutillier
Edward Small
Michael Alexander, *consultant*
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Robert Pearson, *secretary*
Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Arthur Miles, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
Mac Cheater
Donald Daly
George Dorsey
Martin Le Boutillier
Don Nicolson
Fred Sengstacke
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *secretary*

General Service Sharing Session

Membership includes all trustees
(see following pages).
John Waterfield, *chairperson*
Austin MacCormick
John L. Norris, M.D.
Cora Louise Belford, *secretary*

International

Virginia Hallman, *chairperson*
Mac Cheater
Ann Macfarlane
Hal Marley
John L. Norris, M.D.
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Cecil Corrigan, *chairperson*
Jerry Danzig
Virginia Hallman
Ruth Hartshorn
Samuel Smith
John Waterfield
Susan Daly, *co-secretary*
Betty Liddle, *co-secretary*

Literature

Don Nicolson, *chairperson*
Charles Hanson
Fernand Ippersiel
Jack Morley
Tad Mosel
Gordon Patrick
Mary Phelps
Samuel Smith
Jacquelyn Solomon
Lucy Warner
Janet Graves, *consultant*
Barry Leach, *consultant*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Nominating

Charles Hanson, *chairperson*
Cecil Corrigan
Jerry Danzig
George Dorsey
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Gordon Patrick
Mike Rainbolt
Jacquelyn Solomon
John Waterfield
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

Public Information

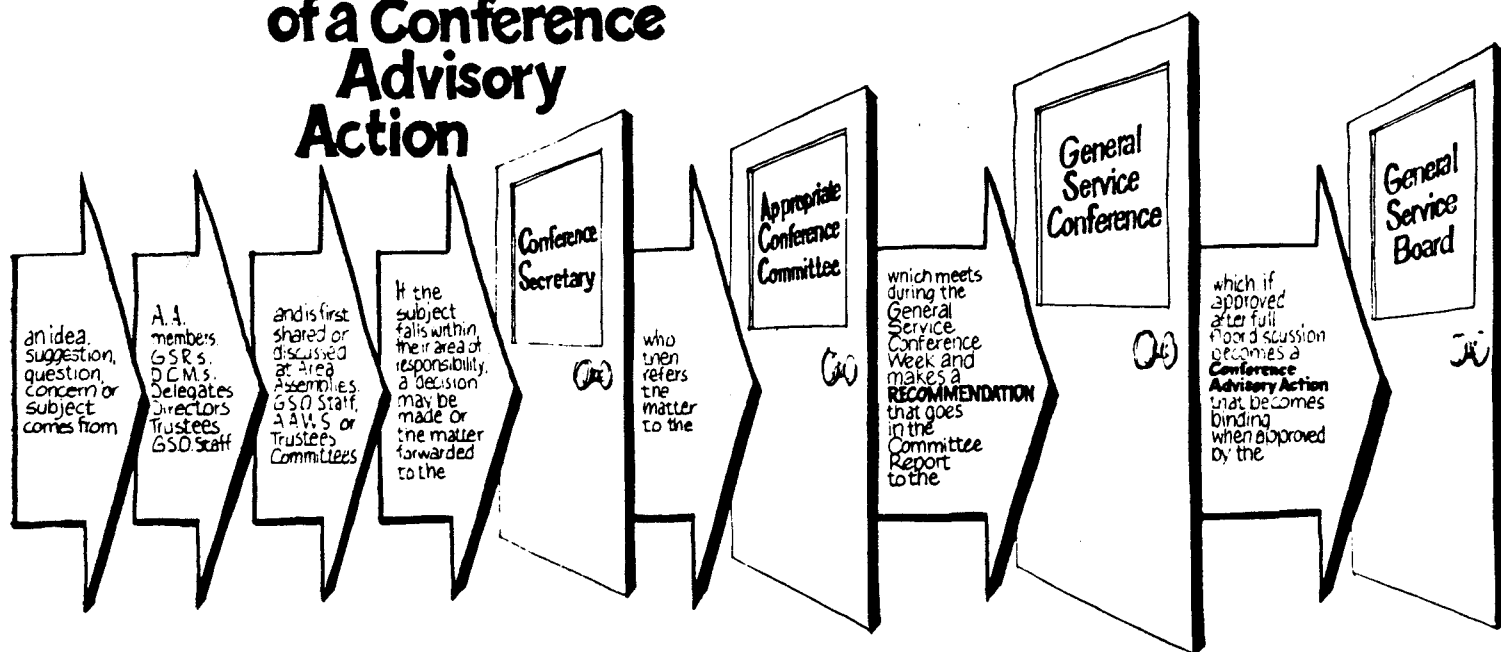
Jerry Danzig, *chairperson*
William Blanton
William Croke
Denison Demac
Janet Graves
Robert Gulian
Charles Hanson
Ruth Hartshorn
Edward Small
John Bragg, *consultant*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *consultant*
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Edward Small, *chairperson*
Mac Cheater
Hal Harmon
Frank Herzlin, M.D.
Henry Hudson
Ray O'Keefe
Robert Pope
Emily Rayford
Robert Stuckey, M.D.
John Williams
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



"Were it not for Committees, it is doubtful that any Conference could get over a fraction of the ground it now covers. As the Conference has grown in size and influence the Committees' importance has grown even more."
...from the A.A. Service Manual, p. 72

1979 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (25 Bacchus Ct., 3300 Carpenter Rd. S.E., Olympia, WA 98503), was elected to the board in April 1971 and became its chairperson in 1978. Before his retirement in 1975, he was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A.

Michael Alexander (150 E. 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. He is a member of the Archives and Finance Committees and nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

John D. Bealer, M.D. (3639 Emerson Cir., Bethlehem, PA 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is assistant corporate medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John is a director of A.A. World Services and serves on the Committees on Finance, Employee Retirement, and Cooperation with the Professional Community.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He was born in Indiana and educated in California, where he began his career in corrections in 1952. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Jim has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice correction, and services to children and youth. He is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Nominating Committee.

***Arthur J. Miles** (Dime Savings Bank of New York, Fifth Ave. and 48th St., New York, NY 10017) was elected to the board in 1970. He is an executive vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and is on the board of trustees of the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He is chairperson of the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees and of the Reserve Fund Investment Policy Subcommittee and treasurer of the General Service Board.

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is president of Gordon Patrick Associates, a firm of consultants specializing in occupational alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism and serves the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America as vice-chairperson of its Occupational Program Section. Gordon is chair-

person of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and also serves on the Literature and Nominating Committees.

****Frank Smeal** (Goldman Sachs & Co., 55 Broad St., New York, NY 10004) began service as treasurer of the General Service Board in April 1979. He is partner and member of the management committee of an investment banking firm, after 30 years with Morgan Guaranty Trust Company, New York, where he had been executive vice-president and treasurer. He has degrees from Pennsylvania State University, the Harvard Graduate School of Business Administration, and New York University Law School. Besides four professional societies, Frank belongs to the board of Boy Scouts of America (Greater New York), and is a trustee of the Citizens' Budget Commission, Inc.

****Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.** (104 Glen Haven La., Pittsburgh, PA 15238), joined our board in 1979. He was a guest speaker at A.A.'s 1975 International Convention in Denver, Colo. He teaches psychiatry and internal medicine at the University of Pittsburgh School of Medicine, and previously taught at the Yale University and Washington University Schools of Medicine. He is consultant physician to a halfway house and to a Salvation Army program for alcoholics, and belongs to five professional societies.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

****Stan N. Cameron** (P.O. Box 1201, Saskatoon, Sask. S7M 2X4, Canada) became Canadian trustee-at-large in 1979 after almost ten years' sobriety. He was a Panel 26 delegate after service as a G.S.R., intergroup representative, and roundup and public information chairperson. Stan helped set up two A.A. central offices. He is chairperson of a halfway house and member of an occupational alcoholism association, as well as several civic clubs. He has had governmental and union experience, and is now president of a mobile-home firm.

***N. M. ("Mac") Cheater** (5 Frost Ave., Winnipeg, Man. R3K 0E1, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large—Canada in 1975. He had his last drink in 1956. A Panel 12 delegate, Mac introduced Big Book study sessions in his province. Mac is sales manager of a television station. He serves on the Finance, International, and Treatment Facilities Committees and was a delegate to the World Service Meeting, 1976 and 1978.

****LaVelle Clifford** (228 Maricopa, El Paso, TX 79912) had her last drink in 1962, was a Panel 22 delegate, and was elected to the board in 1979 as Southwest U.S. regional trustee. Locally, she had served as group secretary, treasurer, program chairperson, intergroup secretary, and G.S.R. She helped organize the El Paso Central Office. She has served on two non-A.A. alcoholism bodies in her community, and retired from business life in 1972.

Cecil ("Cec") E. Corrigan (12-12th St. E., Prince Albert, Sask. S6V 2L9, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in 1976, with 24 years' sobriety. He was a Panel 8 delegate. Cec has had two decades of experience in management of women's wear and fur businesses, and also has interests in real estate. He chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee, is co-chairperson of the Correctional Facilities Committee, and serves on the Nominating Committee and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jerry A. Danzig (993 Park Ave., New York, NY 10028), after ten years' sobriety, became a general service trustee in April 1977. Since 1972, he has been a director of A.A.W.S. He serves as chairperson of the Public Information Committee and a member of the Nominating and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees. He served the New York Intergroup P.I. Committee for two years. Jerry has been officer of a broadcast network and special assistant to two New York governors. He is a partner in a management consultant firm.

George Dorsey (4761 Paradise Dr., Tiburon, CA 94920), sober since 1961, was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1978. He was a Panel 25 delegate and chairperson of the 1976 Conference Finance Committee. George had previously served as a G.S.R., D.C.M., and alternate delegate. Prior to general service activities, he served for several years in various capacities for the San Francisco Bay Area Intercounty Fellowship. George is vice-president and director of an insurance corporation. He serves on the Conference, Finance, and Nominating Committees.

****Richard J. Driscoll** (129 Rhinebeck Ave., Springfield, MA 01129) was named Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1979 after 19 years' sobriety, during which he served as G.S.R. and chairperson for his group, on P.I., C.P.C., institutions, and area committees, and at an intergroup. He is still active in C.P.C. and P.I. Besides belonging to various health and civic societies, Dick does volunteer work for two local non-A.A. alcoholism agencies. A certified public accountant, he is now an officer in a bank and trust company.

Virginia C. Hallman (4304 N. Alpine Ave., P.O. Box 11507, Shorewood, WI 53211) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1977, after 24 years' sobriety. She was secretary of the Milwaukee Central Office four years and was a delegate (Panel 23). She has also been active as a volunteer in behalf of a recovery home for women and a local alcoholism council. She is office manager of a manufacturing firm. Virginia serves on the Conference, Correctional Facilities, International, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees and was a 1978 World Service Meeting delegate.

***Charles H. Hanson** (42 Puritan Rd., Fairfield, CT 06430) was elected general service trustee in 1975. He is chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Nominating Committee, and serves on the Public Information and Literature Committees. Chuck had his last drink in 1966. He is a frequent Grapevine contributor, and is president of an advertising agency.

Ruth K. Hartshorn (190-18 89th Ave., Hollis, NY 11423) was elected trustee-at-large—U.S. in 1977 after 17 years of sobriety. She became a G.S.R. in 1961, has worked on all state and local conventions since 1963, was a Panel 23 delegate, and helps local intergroups. She operates an antiques and collectibles store, and is treasurer of a realty company. Ruth serves on the Conference, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Public Information Committees.

Fernand Ippersiel (1025 Sherbrook E., #1504, Montreal, Que. H2L 1L5, Canada) was chosen Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1978, after 17 years of sobriety. He was a Panel 18 Conference delegate and became editor of *La Vigne A.A.* in 1969. He was one of the translators of the Big Book and the Twelve Concepts into French. Fernand is a television director and a member of the Archives, Correctional Facilities, and Literature Committees.

Martin Le Boutilier (1165 Fifth Ave., New York, NY 10029) started his general service trusteeship in April 1977, after 12 years of sobriety. He is a former president of New York Intergroup. He has been a director of A.A.W.S. since 1974, and serves on the Finance, Cooperation with the Professional Community, and Employee Retirement Committees. Martin is an officer of a large Wall Street firm.

Don Nicolson (One Riverside, #602, Moorhead, MN 56560), elected West Central regional trustee in 1976, had his last drink in 1948. He was a Panel 12 delegate. He lectures in the alcoholism treatment unit of a hospital. Don is president of a fast-food company operating in three states. He serves on the Conference and Finance Committees and is chairperson of the Literature Committee and a director of A.A.W.S.

***Mike Rainbolt** (P.O. Box 248, Cordell, OK 73632) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 28 years' sobriety. He was a Panel 15 delegate and later chaired his state P.I. Committee. Mike has a background in real estate and land titles and is a petroleum landman, operating his own oil and gas exploration firm. He serves on the Cooperation with the Professional Community and Nominating Committees and chairs the Archives Committee.

****John Ryall** (31 Garden Ave., Carle Place, NY 11514) was elected general service trustee in 1979 after 14 years' sobriety and three years as a Grapevine director. Besides filling all group offices, John has been a Conference delegate (Panel 21) and assembly treasurer. He has served on the trustees' Literature and Correctional Facilities Committees and chaired the Second Northeast Regional Delegates Conference. He is a member of the Westbury Group, is active in the local community theater, and is in the telephone business.

Edward J. Small (P.O. Box 582, Cooper Union Sta., New York, NY 10003) was elected general service trustee in August 1976. Ed had his last drink in 1965. After stints at all group jobs, including G.S.R., Ed served New York Intergroup and became a regular Grapevine contributor. He is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Employee Retirement and Public Information Committees, and is chairperson of the Committee on Treatment Facilities. Ed directs a health program for a large publishing firm and belongs to several professional societies interested in alcoholism.

Samuel E. Smith (820 N.W. 87 Ave., Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126), 12 years sober, was elected from the Southeastern Region in April 1977. Active in the Third Legacy since 1968, Sam served as a delegate on Panel 25. He has also twice been chairperson of a gratitude dinner and his local intergroup banquet, and has been active in local P.I. He has been an attorney 25 years. Sam is a member of the Cooperation with the Professional Community, Literature, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

***John E. Waterfield** (2900 Adams Mill Rd., N.W., Washington, DC 20009) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 18 years' sobriety. John was a Panel 23 delegate. He set up a one-to-one "sponsorship" program for informing medical students about A.A., and originated the mini-conference idea. John has his own creative advertising and marketing business. He is chairperson of A.A.W.S. and the General Service Sharing Session and a member of the Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees.

1979 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

John Waterfield, <i>chairperson</i>	Martin Le Boutillier
John Bealer, M.D.	Don Nicolson
Cora Louise Belford	Robert Pearson
John Bragg	Jacquelyn Solomon
Jerry Danzig	

A.A. Grapevine directors

Charles Hanson, <i>chairperson, president</i>	Virginia Hallman
Retha Gresham, <i>secretary, vice-president</i>	Austin MacCormick
Donald Daly, <i>treasurer</i>	Mary Phelps
Cecil Corrigan	John Ryall
	Fred Sengstacke
	Edward Small

General Service Office staff

Robert Pearson, <i>general manager</i>	Beth Kuhlmann
Frank Mauser, <i>administrative assistant</i>	Betty Liddle
Cora Louise Belford	Phyllis Masback
Susan Daly	Vincina McCarthy
Lois Fisher	Sarah Pierce
	June Russell
	(on sick leave)
	Helen Turnquest

Grapevine staff

Retha Gresham, <i>managing editor</i>	Tom Neary, <i>associate editor</i>
	Lucy Warner, <i>associate editor</i>

Others attending Conference (*not as voting members*)

Donna Berkowitz, *office manager*
Norman Bradley, *supervisor, Data Control*
Charles Clark, *supervisor, Mail Department*
Charles Columbia, *assistant controller/internal auditor*
Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager, supporting departments*
Shirley Grant, *personnel manager/interdepartmental coordinator*
Janet Graves, *production, Conference Report*
Robert Hughie, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*
Barry Leach, *editor, Conference Report*
Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
John L. Norris, M.D., *chairperson emeritus, General Service Board*
Mary Anne O'Dea, *editorial assistant*
Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference secretary*
Nell Wing, *archivist*

Two observers (*nonvoting*) from each of the following may also attend:

Trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community
Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
Trustees' Finance Committee
Grapevine Editorial Board
Trustees' Literature Committee
Trustees' Public Information Committee
Trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 29th Conference includes Panel 28 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 29 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	29	Mickey Boynton, 1034 S. Old Corry Field Rd., Pensacola, FL 32507
Alaska	2	28	Dick Juelson, P.O. Box 286, Kodiak, AK 99615
Arizona	3	28	Bob Morris, 2880 N. El Burrito, Tucson, AZ 85705
Arkansas	4	29	Wayne Parks, 1120 W. Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756
California	5	29	Southern - Lucetta De Young, 119 California St. #26, San Gabriel, CA 91776
	6	29	Northern Coastal - Lois Jacobson, 102 Village Circle, Novato, CA 94947
	7	28	Northern Interior - Annette Fiel, 6346 N. Van Ness, Fresno, CA 93711
	8	28	San Diego - Clifford L. (Cliff) Locke, 1232 30th, San Diego, CA 92102
	9	28	Mid-Southern - Goldene Lahann, 4360 Watkins Dr., Riverside, CA 92507
Colorado	10	29	David I. (Dave) Buckley, 1422 Kern St., Colorado Springs, CO 80915
Connecticut	11	29	John A. Callaghan, 62 Forest Dr., Wethersfield, CT 06109
Delaware	12	28	William F. (Bill) Geoghan, Rte. 1, Box 379-D, Seaford, DE 19973
District of Columbia	13	29	Jim Cooney, 10013 Sidney Rd., Silver Spring, MD 20901
Florida	14	29	Northern - Louis W. (Lou) Mobley, P.O. Box 474, San Mateo, FL 32088
	15	29	Southern - Carlos F. (Chico) Cortez, 1308 E. Libby Dr., West Palm Beach, FL 33406
Georgia	16	28	Keith Strickland, P.O. Box 262, Nahant, GA 31553

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel
Hawaii	17	29	Herb Weatherwax, 272 Iliha St., Kailua, HI 96734	Mississippi	37	28 J. D. Higginbotham, 614 Meeks St., Tupelo, MS 38801
Idaho	18	28	Joe Clements, P.O. Box 573, 400 Third Ave., Twin Falls, ID 83310	Missouri	38	29 Eastern – Elma F. Stone, 3411 Hinkson Creek Rd., Columbia, MO 65201
Illinois	19	29	Chicago – Tom Devereux, 2328 N. Normandy, Chicago, IL 60635		39	29 Western – George Van Dyke, 6038 Truman Rd., Kansas City, MO 64126
	20	28	Northern – Ruth E. Peterson, 30 N. Broadview, Lombard, IL 60148		40	28 Marvin Wilson, Box 758, Helena, MT 59601
	21	29	Southern – Hershell Hood, 711 St. Maud, Cahokia, IL 62206	Montana	41	28 Roger H. Gleason, Box 55082, Sta. B, Omaha, NE 68155
Indiana	22	29	Northern – Louise C. Holsten, 508 High St., Fort Wayne, IN 46808	Nebraska	42	29 Ruth Jagodzinski, 2934 S. Lindell Rd., Las Vegas, NV 89102
	23	28	Southern – O. S. (Buck) Bruner Jr., O. S. Bruner Agency, Inc., 3901 N. Meridian St., Suite 450, Indianapolis, IN 46208	Nevada	43	28 David (Woody) Wooldridge, 8 Wallis Rd., Portsmouth, NH 03801
Iowa	24	29	Dan Byrne, 2900 19th Ave., Marion, IA 52302	New Hampshire	44	29 Northern – Herman H. Halm Jr., 329 Hillside Pl., South Orange, NJ 07079
Kansas	25	28	William G. (Bill) Hopkins, P.O. Box 18093, Wichita, KS 67218	New Jersey	45	28 Southern – Jane R. Story, 4A4 Arbor Green, Edgewater Park, Beverly, NJ 08010
Kentucky	26	28	Leon Richards, 750 N. 23rd St., Paducah, KY 42001	New Mexico	46	28 Thurman Dunn, 1100 Canyon Rd., Alamogordo, NM 88310
Louisiana	27	29	Bill Geer, 317 Peake St., Lake Charles, LA 70601		47	29 Central – Judd H. Black, 725 Lake Shore Blvd., Rochester, NY 14617
Maine	28	28	Mark Peterson, Box 68, Sinclair, ME 04779		48	28 Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Edward W. (Ed) Flanagan, 13 Rapple Dr., Albany, NY 12205
Maryland	29	28	Everett E. (Ed) Edwards, 4718 Meise Dr., Baltimore, MD 21206		49	29 Southeastern – Josephine (Jo) Kugel, 34-24 82nd St., Jackson Heights, NY 11372
Massachusetts	30	29	Eastern – Glenice M. Sheehan, 365 Chandler St., Tewksbury, MA 01876		50	28 Western – Al (Smoky) Woodson, 514 S. Division St., Buffalo, NY 14204
	31	28	Western – John F. Maloney, 13 Fairdel St., Springfield, MA 01108	North Carolina	51	29 Neil Dobbins, P.O. Box 7585, Asheville, NC 28807
Michigan	32	29	Central – Kenneth Himes, 1521 Pine Valley, Ann Arbor, MI 48104		52	28 Nada Butz, 138 28th St. S.W., Minot, ND 58701
	33	29	Southeastern – Ken Winegarner, 1144 Lakeview, Detroit, MI 48215	North Dakota	53	29 Central & Southeastern – Anna M. Diggs, 1312 E. Broad St., Columbus, OH 43205
	34	28	Western – Albert H. (Al) Siska, 1410 Henderson Dr., Kalamazoo, MI 49007	Ohio	54	29 Northeastern – Terry Leach, 7009 Columbia Rd., Olmsted Falls, OH 44138
Minnesota	35	28	Northern – Garfield (Duffy) Salvog, 322 N. 9th, Brainerd, MN 56401		55	28 N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – Robert C. (Bob) Tapola, 1817 Brownstone Blvd., Apt. 911, Toledo, OH 43614
	36	29	Southern – Robert S. Bisanz, 13 Crocus Hill, St. Paul, MN 55102			

1979 Conference Members

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel
Ohio	56	28	S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Michael Thies, 3431 Todds Run Rd., Williamsburg, OH 45176	Wyoming	76	28 Lew Lee, Box 244, Lander, WY 82520
Oklahoma	57	29	LeRoy Belt, 2529 Cummings Dr., Oklahoma City, OK 73107	Puerto Rico	77	28 Ramon Acevedo, Calle Ambar #19, Villa Blanca, Caguas, PR 00625
Oregon	58	28	Ken Savaloja, Rte. #4, Box 724, Astoria, OR 97123	CANADA		
Pennsylvania	59	29	Eastern – Ambrose Mohan, 507 Corinthian Ave., Hatboro, PA 19040	Province	Area no.	Panel
	60	29	Western – Ian McKenzie, 105 Siefert Rd., Coraopolis, PA 15108	Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	28 Ivan Strome, Box 6729, Fort St. John, B.C., Canada V1J 4J2
Rhode Island	61	28	Robert H. (Bob) Gadoury, 21 Irene Lane, Coventry, RI 02816	British Columbia/ Yukon	79	29 Jack Ford, 3094 W. King Edward, Vancouver, B.C., Canada V6L 1V5
South Carolina	62	28	Frank B. Stewart, Rte. 1, Box 130, Silverstreet, SC 29145	Manitoba	80	28 Helen Harmon, P.O. Box 391, Melita, Man., Canada R0M 1L0
South Dakota	63	28	Nick Krebs, 601 Third Ave. W., Lemmon, SD 57638	New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	81	28 Lloyd King, R.R. #1, Charlotte- town, P.E.I., Canada C1A 7J6
Tennessee	64	28	William C. (Bill) Killebrew, P.O. Box 40067, Nashville, TN 37204	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	82	29 Leo Kelly, 2 Sanspeck Rd., Cornerbrook, Nfld., Canada A2H 4R2
Texas	65	29	Northeastern – Hank Coleman, 2602 Wooddale, Wichita Falls, TX 76301	Ontario	83	29 Eastern – Wilfred J. (Wilf) O'Grady, 1107-465 Richmond Rd., Ottawa, Ont., Canada K2A 1Z1
	66	28	Northwestern – Jan K. William- son, 3208 Lamplighter Pl., El Paso, TX 79925		84	29 Northeastern – Tina Martin, 409 Duke St. W., North Bay, Ont., Canada P1B 6E9
	67	29	Southeastern – Dick White, 201 Winding Way, Lake Jackson, TX 77566		85	29 Northwestern – Allen (Al) Hurley, 113 Huntington Ct., Thunder Bay, Ont., Canada P7C 2B5
	68	28	Southwestern – M. D. (Skeeter) Shillings, P.O. Box 408, Port Lavaca, TX 77979		86	28 Western – Orville Young, R.R. #4, Creemore, Ont., Canada L0M 1G0
Utah	69	29	Frank Buffo, 155 East 600 North, Spanish Fork, UT 84660	Quebec	87	28 Southwestern – Pierre Prenoveau, 7736 St-Denis St., Montreal, Que., Canada H2R 2E8
Vermont	70	28	Barbara Marsh, 35 S. Summit St., Essex Junction, VT 05452		88	29 Southeastern – Laurent Biron, 1700 O'Reilly, Sherbrooke, Que., Canada J1C 1C1
Virginia	71	29	Charles J. (Chuck) Roberts, P.O. Box 84, Gainesville, VA 22065		89	29 Northeastern – Louis M. Ladouceur, 1617 Ranvoyze, Ste- Foy, Que., Canada G1W 3K1
Washington	72	29	Terry Schemel, 609 Wood Pl., Apt. 2106, Everett, WA 98203		90	28 Northwestern – Angelo Carpen- tier, 143 Deschamps, Apt. 4, Vanier, Ont., Canada K1L 5Z5
West Virginia	73	29	Alfred E. (Al) Farley, P.O. Box 523, Charleston, WV 25322	Saskatchewan	91	28 Albert J. (Al) Hergott, Box 1030, Humboldt, Sask., Canada S0K 2A0
Wisconsin	74	28	N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan – Gene Loomis, 612 Third St., Marshfield, WI 54449			
	75	29	Southern – Michael J. Kelly, 217 N. Spring St., Sparta, WI 54656			

Literature distributed — 1978

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	246,490
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	125,060
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	31,900
A.A. Comes of Age	17,810
As Bill Sees It	29,840
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish edition	3,797
As Bill Sees It — Spanish edition	808
A.A. Comes of Age — Spanish edition	1,119
Total	456,824

Booklets

Living Sober	71,800
Came to Believe	38,340
Living Sober — Spanish edition	1,926
Total	112,066

Pamphlets

A.A. — a Community Resource (discontinued)	67,900
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	62,400
A.A. and the Armed Services	21,400
A.A. and the Medical Profession	30,200
A.A. for the Woman	145,000
A.A. — 44 Questions	267,500
The A.A. Group	69,900
A.A. in Hospitals	30,100
A.A. in Prisons	7,400
A.A. in Your Community	123,600
The A.A. Member (new)	48,000
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	131,800
The A.A. Service Manual	15,800
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	45,000
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	20,200
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem (discontinued)	59,400
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	203,900
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	43,300
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous (new)	38,900
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous (old — discontinued)	35,000

Do You Think You're Different?	192,400
G.S.R.	41,900
How A.A. Members Cooperate	36,800
How It Works	175,000
If You Are a Professional	67,100
Inside A.A.	74,300
Is A.A. for You?	429,800
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	166,800
It Happened to Alice	69,700
The Jack Alexander Article	75,700
The Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders (discontinued)	12,600
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	47,800
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	107,800
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	116,700
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	36,000
Problems Other Than Alcohol	96,800
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	152,200
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	29,800
This Is A.A.	343,300
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	33,900
Too Young?	132,800
Twelve Concepts for World Service	6,500
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	47,600
Understanding Anonymity	102,900
What Happened to Joe	77,300
Young People and A.A.	183,300
Foreign translations	118,900
Total	4,442,400

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards — two-fold	660,400
Wallet cards — I Am Responsible	110,200
Wallet cards — Anonymity	65,600
Parchment — scrolls	4,600
Placards	600
A.A. Guidelines	62,200
Group Handbook	3,800
Wire racks	1,000
Cassettes	900
A.A. Public Information Manual	2,000
Hanging displays	800
Fact Files	4,500
Total	916,600

Grapevine circulation — geographical breakdown

Circulation 4/1/79 — 113,000; circulation 4/1/78 — 100,500; increase for period — 12,500

U.S.	No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease		No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease		No. GvRs		Circulation		% In-crease
	3/78	3/79	4/1/78	4/1/79			3/78	3/79	4/1/78	4/1/79			3/78	3/79	4/1/78	4/1/79	
Ala.	12	24	835	901	8	Mont.	7	25	565	655	16	P.R.	1	3	130	164	26
Alsk.	2	3	242	265	9	Nebr.	12	39	1,078	1,296	20	U.S. Poss.			129	150	16
Ariz.	6	45	949	1,145	20	Nev.	3	5	350	366	5		1,886	2,875	85,505	702	13
Ark.	103	98	741	812	10	N.H.	5	9	625	649	4	Increase for period—11,197					
Calif.	204	247	8,997	10,037	12	N.J.	31	46	2,613	2,956	13						
Colo.	3	9	1,149	1,307	14	N.M.	18	20	568	598	5						
Conn.	6	23	1,728	1,862	8	N.Y.	84	159	6,800	7,579	11	Canada					
Del.	3	21	285	336	18	N.C.	41	55	1,953	2,138	9						
D.C.	27	68	673	710	5	N.Dak.	17	27	682	731	7	Alta./N.W.T.9	28		1,614	1,897	18
Fla.	78	123	3,428	3,967	16	Ohio	126	210	3,280	3,811	16	B.C./Yukon 7	29		2,275	2,205	—
Ga.	13	33	1,649	1,758	6	Okla.	12	32	1,411	1,515	7	Man.	20	26	1,136	1,243	9
Haw.	53	53	289	320	10	Oreg.	23	30	925	990	7	N.B./P.E.I. 4	13		538	584	9
Idaho	26	26	478	575	20	Pa.	50	78	2,822	3,250	15	N.S./Nfld./					
Ill.	47	62	3,961	4,352	10	R.I.	7	32	522	560	7	Lab.	3	15	993	1,050	6
Ind.	22	55	1,514	1,698	12	S.C.	8	18	842	957	13	Ont.	108	211	5,055	5,850	16
Iowa	53	56	1,409	1,572	12	S.Dak.	6	10	730	811	11	Que.	7	6	703	750	7
Kans.	8	24	1,345	1,485	10	Tenn.	121	133	1,158	1,398	20	Sask.	4	30	1,206	1,222	1
Ky.	15	33	884	973	10	Tex.	45	84	3,728	4,106	10		162	358	13,520	14,801	9
La.	21	30	935	1,166	25	Utah	52	52	418	429	3	Increase for period—1,281					
Me.	2	13	535	628	17	Vt.	3	7	320	368	15						
Md.	13	56	1,555	2,004	29	Va.	160	202	2,159	2,511	16						
Mass.	25	51	3,750	4,367	16	Wash.	14	26	2,194	2,438	11	Foreign					
Mich.	121	136	3,121	3,548	14	W.Va.	34	35	567	681	20		4	14	1,475	1,497	14
Minn.	58	104	3,839	4,569	19	Wis.	32	73	2,247	2,684	19	Increase for period—22					
Miss.	2	13	579	630	8	Wyo.	47	45	286	319	11						
Mo.	4	14	1,533	1,605	5				85,246	96,388	13	Total	2,052	3,247	100,500	113,000	12

Circulation increase 4/1/77 - 4/1/79—24%